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The Linguo-cultural Analysis of Pre-election and Victory Speeches

(On the Basis of the US Presidential Speeches)

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Introduction

In the modern globalised world, political discourse has become a powerful tool for shaping public opinion and influencing societal values. The language used by political leaders not only reflects but also actively constructs cultural and ideological realities (Bystrov, 2024). It is thus becoming more and more relevant and crucial to study the multifaceted connection between language and culture to identify its influence on the persuasive and manipulative

power of such a socially meaningful domain of public life. This study aims to analyse political discourse through the lens of linguistic and cultural approach.

In contemporary society and the developing digital environment, political discourse plays a critical role in influencing public opinion, attitudes, and beliefs by affecting how audiences perceive political realities. Among the various forms of political communication, presidential speeches hold a particularly significant position due to their profound impact on social, political, economic, and cultural spheres of everyday life (Awawdeh, 2021). Consequently, these speeches constitute the primary focus of the present research.

As highlighted by Almahasees & Mahmoud (2022), political leaders strategically employ a wide range of culturally-loaded stylistic devices aimed at impacting listeners' perceptions in accordance with the objectives of political campaigns. These linguistic tools are deliberately implemented to frame ideologies that resonate with prevailing societal values and cultural norms. Within the scope of this study, culturally-loaded linguistic features are considered as language units that evoke specific cultural contexts and shared meanings (Bystrov, 2024).

The research concentrates on two distinct kinds of presidential speeches – pre-election and victory speeches, delivered by three prominent U.S. presidents of the 21st century during their second terms: Donald John Trump, Barack Hussein Obama, and George Walker Bush. Each of these leaders governed within unique cultural, political, and economic environments, which have significantly influenced their rhetorical styles and communicative strategies (Liu & Zhang, 2018). This diversity offers a rich comparative framework for examining how language reflects and responds to changing socio-political contexts.

Language, as a powerful communication tool, enables speakers to structure utterances that profoundly influence audience perspectives (Humă,

2023). However, an overview of the existing research field focusing on the linguistic and cultural analysis of political speeches reveals a notable gap: while numerous studies address linguistic and cultural features in political discourse, there remains a lack of comprehensive investigation into certain frequently employed stylistic devices within presidential speeches. For example, Tian (2021) points out that linguistic units such as irony, phraseological units, and specific rhetorical strategies have not been thoroughly examined in this context yet. In addition, the analysis of the studies on the topic has demonstrated that there is no extensive empirical data that would reflect a holistic representation of all the peculiarities of the linguistic choices made by a political figure expressed within different language layers that would shed light on how cultural background of the speaker influences or explains these choices.

Therefore, the major aim of this research is to address this gap by systematically examining the use of culturally-loaded linguistic units that have been understudied in previous studies. Further on, the study's another crucial goal is to reveal and analyse all linguistic features that carry cultural connotations or significantly intensify the emotional density and manipulativeness within the selected speeches.

This comprehensive approach is grounded in the linguistic and cultural analytical paradigm, which emphasises the need to pay attention to "all socio-ideological and cultural processes reflected in the language" (Shaklein et al., 2019, p. 1464). The application of this framework in the given study is needed to conduct a full-encompassing examination of the linguistic features employed by the presidents, taking into consideration that each of them is a representative of a certain culture and unique social experiences.

Accordingly, the study seeks to answer the following research questions:

- What culturally-loaded linguistic features are employed in political discourse, and what primary functions do they serve?

- How do these features vary between different types of presidential speeches, specifically pre-election and victory speeches?
- How do these features differ between three presidents with diverse backgrounds?
- In what ways do these speeches reflect cultural values, societal attitudes, and the political and economic realities of the country through linguistic means?

These questions are explored through a comprehensive literature review that lays the foundation for the subsequent practical analysis of the transcribed presidential speeches.

As for the hypothesis of this study, it is initially assumed that political discourse is characterised by distinct culturally-specific linguistic units and rhetorical strategies that encapsulate underlying societal values and political ideologies. Moreover, the hypothesis suggests that cultural backgrounds of the speakers and the differences in communicative contexts of two types of speeches significantly influence the occurrence of particular devices and persuasive strategies.

In order to achieve the stated research aims, the study first establishes a comprehensive theoretical overview of literature that comprises a thorough description of the nature and different frameworks to the application of linguistic and cultural analytical approach, the essence of political discourse, and the use of specific culturally-loaded linguistic units within its paradigm. Then, the research applies a mixed-methods research design, utilising critical discourse analysis, content analysis, and comparative analysis methods to examine the transcribed speeches through the linguistic and cultural perspective. This methodology enables the identification of the frequency of occurrence, functions, and effects of the rhetorical strategies and culturally-loaded linguistic units on the perception of the utterances. Based on the quantitative content analysis method, the revealed features are displayed in the forms of visualised

graphs and tables, featuring all the examples of the peculiar use of language detected in the presidents' speeches. By comparing the speeches of the three presidents based on the outlined statistics, the research reveals how the individual backgrounds of the speakers, alongside the political, historical and cultural contexts, shape their linguistic choices.

The findings of this research significantly contribute to the existing research field on the linguistic and cultural features represented in political discourse. They provide insights into how language operates as a culturally-resonant tool for influencing public opinion and constructing political realities, thereby enriching the overall understanding of the intersection between language, culture, and politics.

Theoretical Part

1.1. Linguo-culturology and Cultural Linguistics

To begin with, it is important to state that language is a complex phenomenon that emerged in human society. It represents the interaction of opposite concepts as a system and an anti-system, a final product and the activity itself, comprising both random and structured elements that define it (Maslova, 2001). Due to this variable nature, the language is not stagnant and can change.

One clear example of language's interactive capability is its influence on the creation and evolution of culture, which plays a crucial role in the development of personal identity (Vorobyev, 2006). (Vorobyev, 2006). The concept and definition of linguistic personality provided by Karaulov (1987) indicate that a person's abilities and characteristics are determined by the linguistic cognition of one's nationality. Further, it is these characteristics expressed in culture that are the basis for the beginning of spiritual

communication between people, as well as the possibility of understanding and cooperation between them.

With the development of international relations and the mixing of nationalities, the problem of the interconnection between language and culture led to the creation and further development of separate approaches to its research and study. One of them was linguo-culturology. This scientific discipline is based on a holistic and systematic consideration of language and culture as a set of units (linguo-cultureme) that form field structures (Vorobyov, 2006). According to this approach, the analysed objects are considered as systems of acquired and transmitted cultural values, which are directly reflected in the language.

Supporting the idea of the influence of language on humans, linguo-culturology is also based on the hypothesis of linguistic relativity that was initiated by Edward Sapir and his follower Benjamin Lee Whorf in the 1930s. According to this theory, the structure of language and the systemic semantics of its units have a formative effect on the structure of thinking and ways of cognition of the external world by a particular nationality. Thus, representatives of ethnic groups who speak different languages have clear differences in how they perceive the same categories of the world around them. For example, the concepts of property, time and position in society. In addition, it is also crucial to note that representatives of different linguistic groups evaluate and react in radically different ways to both everyday events and phenomena, as well as to more rare or extraordinary ones, such as presidential elections.

The Sepir-Whorf hypothesis also presents the idea that people who combine several language structures (regardless of the reasons, for example, natural and artificial bilinguals) are able to simultaneously use different systems of thinking and ways of world cognition. For this reason, these individuals can

use approaches that are unusual for one ethnicity, but natural for another, in order to establish spiritual communication between people.

Overall, in the research, language is considered to be a utility that can be implemented in the interpretation of reality, and therefore is deemed as a way to get closer to the essence of the modern mentality of separate nations, as well as preserved representations of historical events and phenomena in the format of proverbs, phraseological units, and other units.

However, it is crucial to disclose the fact that the idea of studying the interconnection between language and culture is not unified and is divided into two main approaches: linguo-culturology (post-Soviet approach) and cultural linguistics (Western approach). Peeters (2019) believes that this kind of separation of terms is an example of a common phenomenon of terminological variation. Moreover, according to the author, these two scientific disciplines have the same basis and objectives, and using different names to address one approach can lead to misunderstandings among scientists and is a manifestation of terminological indifference.

At the same time, Mizin and Korostenski (2019) argue that linguo-culturology and cultural linguistics are not two names of the same scientific discipline, but two similar yet not identical approaches to the study of the relationship between language and culture. The authors claim that both methods appeared at approximately the same time, and that the Western approach, similar to the post-Soviet one, was based on the theory of linguistic relativity by Sapir-Whorf. Nevertheless, the further development of scientific disciplines does not coincide. Maslova (2001) reveals that it is not possible to periodise the emergence and full emergence of relatively new sciences, such as linguo-culturology and cultural linguistics, due to the subjectivity of the assessment and the lack of clearly defined criteria for conducting this work.

With the continuation of the process of parallel development of linguo-culturology and cultural linguistics, as well as due to the lack of

unification of research and work among these fields, there has been a radical differentiation between post-Soviet and Western approaches. This is reflected not only in variations in the proposed specifications and classifications of the analysed units, namely language and culture, but also in the goals and objectives of research in these disciplines (Mizin and Korostenski, 2019).

- Linguo-culturology, as a scientific discipline, studies not just the relationship between language and culture, but language as a cultural phenomenon (Maslova, 2001). This definition of the very essence of the approach implies considering language as a way of expressing a certain national mentality.
- Cultural linguistics, as an interdisciplinary field of research, explores the relationship between language, culture, and conceptualisation (Sharifian, 2017). This approach has integrated both cognitive studies and cognitive anthropology, as it considers cultural models that are directly related to language.

In order to obtain the most extensive theoretical base, both scientific disciplines, namely linguo-culturology and cultural linguistics, are to be considered in the paper, as well as the basic concepts and classifications of both are to be identified.

To derive a comprehensive definition of the term linguo-culturology, it is first necessary to point out what culture is and what its main functions are (Vorobyev, 2006). Naik et al. (2023) state that culture includes many aspects of people's lives, such as traditions, values, worldviews, and behaviors. At the same time, culture undoubtedly encompasses various fields of human activity, namely religion, education and language. Supporting the latter, Sepir (1993) considers “culture” as what a society does and thinks, and language as how it does things and thinks. Considering the main functions of culture, Makarychev & Yatsyk (2017) also add that culture is primarily a semiotic system, the main task of which is the accumulation and further preservation of information.

Based on the derived ideas about the functions of language and culture, Vorobyev (2006) argues that linguo-culturology is a synthesising type of science, which in fact is located at the intersection of cultural studies and philology or linguistics. Maslova (2001) highlights that this branch of linguistics is a way of considering language as a system of interpretation and realisation of cultural values of ethnic groups. Malkhazova (2015) presents a more modern view of linguo-culturology, stating that this science focuses on the analysis of thought processes, as well as cultural and psychological characteristics that represent different nations. This is done to determine their cultural values and the peculiarities of the separation of the material and non-material world. The latter is based on the works of Humboldt, according to which material and immaterial (spiritual) culture take a certain place in language.

The main objective of linguo-culturology is the systematic study of both the relationship and the interaction of culture and language in the process of their functioning and implementation (Vorobyev, 2006). The author also highlights the importance of interpreting this kind of interaction exclusively as a single unified system. At the same time, Maslova (2001) emphasizes as the main task of linguo-culturology not the interpretation of interaction, but the study of the ways in which language remembers, stores, and later translates a particular culture. The fundamental goal of linguo-culturology is also considered to be the study of changes in language and its units that are caused by changes in culture, as well as in its functioning system (Urayimova, 2022).

As for the basics of linguo-culturology, Vorobyev (2006) substantiates the essence of the central triad of this science, on the basis of which the main problems of the discipline are considered, and further solved. It consists of:

- *language* - defines thinking and unites individuals in a community;
- *nation (national personality)* - formed under the influence of territorial community and language, as well as internal creation;
- *culture* - dynamic, so that it develops within a nation or people;

It is possible to see that each aspect is connected with the following one, and cannot exist in isolation. A change in one component under external or internal influence will undoubtedly affect the others.

The theory of the triad of linguo-culturology has its origin in the works of Humboldt (1956), where a similar three-step relationship is presented:

- personality (a person with a mindset);
- language;
- culture;

It is important to note that in Humboldt's triad (1956), language is not in the first place for ideological reasons. The scientist identified that this aspect has an “intermediate” position between human and the world, and also serves as a boundary established by the personality between the cognition of the inner and outer worlds. For this reason, by learning different languages, it is possible to describe people’s mentality, behaviour, as well as their main characteristics.

Maslova (2001), based on the object of the study, also identifies 9 main units of research in linguo-culturology. The choice of these aspects is determined by their “cultural significance” and how “culturally-loaded” they are.

- **Culturally-loaded words and expressions;**

These are culturally determined linguistic units that are unique in their meaning and do not have equivalent phrases or expressions in other languages, *e.g. “to feel under the weather”, “to take tea with someone”*.

- **Mythologised linguistic units that are fixed in the language;**

These are units that are based on mythologems, these are important situations and characters for a particular myth. Myths are usually based on an archetype, which is a stable unit recognisable at the cultural level. For example, phraseological units with a component such as "tea" are based on the archetype of tea as a symbol of comfort, warmth, and community, *i.e. “to spill the tea”, and “not my cup of tea”*.

- **Paremiological fund of language;**

These are proverbs and sayings that have their origin in the national consciousness and are interconnected with the history of a particular people or ethnic group, as well as their culture. For example, the proverb *"Every dog has its day"*, which means that every person (the idea is conveyed through the archetype of the dog) will one day have a period of luck, power and success. The history of this proverb dates back to Elizabeth I, when the queen used this phrase in a letter to her brother as she was asked to describe herself.

- **Phraseological fund of language;**

This is a way to reflect the main aspects of the culture, history and mentality of a particular nation. Some of the examples are *"to lose one's head" and "servant of Melpomene"*.

- **Standards, stereotypes, symbols;**

These three aspects reflect not only the way a nation perceives the world, but also how they decode the information obtained. Thus, symbols are nationally labeled units. Further, standards are interconnected with criteria for measuring peace in accordance with criteria established by societies, for example, in the format of stable expressions. The opposite is stereotypes, which, although they also evaluate, do so unconsciously. For example, *"proud as a peacock" and "as wise as an owl"*.

- **Metaphors and images of language;**

These two aspects have the most important linguistic essence. Thus, image is an ideological reproduction of information about the subject with which it is correlated. It is also important to reveal the essence of the inner form of such words, which make their meanings motivated. Further, the inner forms correspond to the literal meanings conveyed by the metaphors. The existing associations with images, as well as the connotations that create internal forms, make such words culturally loaded. Some examples are *"heart made of stone" and "a sub-branched beach"*.

- **Stylistic structure of language;**

This aspect is related to the consideration of the dialectal stratification of the language. The relationship between the formal (literary) and informal (spoken) languages is also explored, as they reflect the cultural history of society. Despite the fact that the normative and stylistic structure of society reflects the culture of the people to a lesser extent in comparison with lexical units, it is still crucial for creating a unified image of society.

- **Speech behavior (verbal behaviour);**

This term refers to both speech and any other behavior that is inherently fixed in nominative, grammatical, and stylistic units. This is due to the fact that the cultural identity of a certain nationality and its verbal communication develop based on particular factors, which shape not only the variations in how information is transmitted and its functions, but also the way it is organised. The mentioned factors inherently have a various basis and history of creation, but at the same time they are essentially interrelated with linguistic psycholinguistic aspects.

- **Speech etiquette.**

This term can be described as the rules and norms established by a certain society for the formation of speech behavior in accordance with the status and communicative goal of the speaker. In other words, speech etiquette is a culturally normative behavior of a person.

Overall, all of the above-mentioned 9 aspects identified by Maslova (2001) explore the connection between certain linguistic expressions used by both certain people and society in general with the culture and mentality of the nation, as well as with their cultural cognition, accepted speech norms, customs and traditions. It is also crucial to state that this list contains only the most important units to be analysed in regard with linguo-culturological approach.

Based on the above mentioned definitions, in this paper linguo-culturology is considered as a synthesizing type of science aimed at

studying the speech, mental and cultural characteristics of different ethnicities (Vorobyev, 2006; Maslova, 2001; Urayimova, 2022). Therefore, the main objectives are the systematic study of the interaction of language and culture, as well as ways to preserve and further translate cultural units, taking into account the dynamics of culture.

Moving to cultural linguistics, it is also necessary to consider different approaches to the definition of this scientific discipline. According to Sharifian (2017), it is a sub-discipline of linguistics that has a multidisciplinary origin and that explores interconnection between language, culture and conceptualisation. The latter is analyzed with special attention, since its meaning is directly related to cognitive linguistics, on which cultural linguistics is based. Dobrova et al. (2018), while maintaining the importance of this aspect, points out that all knowledge, including language, acquired by a person during their lifetime is the result of conceptualization and categorization of the surrounding world. In addition, Rahimova (2024) argues that when analyzing cognitive processes, which are the basis for using language and building thoughts and ideas with their further transmission, it becomes possible to systematize the structure of human thinking. Considering the fact that cultural linguistics aims to improve the overall understanding of the cultural conceptualization of human experience, this discipline is considered more promising in comparison with cultural linguistics (Peeters, 2019).

To fully understand the objectives of cultural linguistics, it is first necessary to analyze the concept of category. According to Maslova (2019), this is any group of linguistic elements that have been separated based on similarities, which are essentially parameters or criteria.

Further, the main purpose of cultural linguistics is the systematic and detailed analysis of cultural conceptualizations using methods such as cultural schemas and cultural categories that are directly related to cognitive sciences and cognitive linguistics (Sharifian, 2017). Vorobyev et al. (2020) also point out

that the use of framing and cognitive models in studying the world around a person and their mentality can allow a more “detailed" analysis. This is due to the fact that only such an approach to better analysing a person's mentality and reality is able to reveal the full ideological component of existing words and terms that are mental categories (Vorobyev et al., 2020).

Fatkullina (2017) also defines the following functions as fundamental in such a scientific discipline as cultural linguistics:

- *epistemic;*

Considering language as a specific method of storing knowledge about an individual's environment.

- *cognitive;*

Considering language as a method of cognition of the surrounding world by a person.

Continuing revealing the essence of cultural linguistics, cultural conceptualization and its impact on cultural cognition, which is also the focus of the study of the abovementioned scientific discipline, Sharifian (2017) identifies the following model:

- cultural cognition ->
- cultural conceptualization (cultural schemas, cultural categories, and cultural metaphors) ->
- language (morphosyntax, semantics, and pragmatics).

This model highlights the relationship between the three mentioned aspects, also emphasizing their connection with language. Overall, cultural schemes allow people to convey cultural meanings, while cultural categories have a completely opposite function and are embedded directly into the grammatical system of the language. The last aspect is cultural metaphors, which are related to the cognitive conceptualization of one area in relation to another.

Based on the above mentioned definitions, cultural linguistics in this paper is considered as a sub-discipline of linguistics that has a multidisciplinary origin and that explores the interconnection between language, culture and conceptualization (in its interconnection with cultural cognition and categories), based on cognitive linguistics that is its foundational framework. Therefore, the main objective is to consider cultural conceptualization expressed through cultural schemes, categories and cultural metaphors.

Further, the paper is to utilise key aspects of both linguo-culturology and cultural linguistics, as well as their functions and methods. The main purpose of applying both aspects for the implementation of further work is to obtain the most comprehensive results.

1.2. Political Discourse

Political discourse is a complex sociocultural phenomenon that influences various areas of public life (Cap, 2023). While rhetorical analysis of political speech dates back to the time of Aristotle first works on the significance of the delicate use of language in politics, political discourse as a separate field of study began to emerge in the mid-twentieth century (Gerasimov & Ilyin, 2002). According to the authors, early approaches stem from traditional rhetorical studies and political communication research, focusing primarily on persuasive techniques and propaganda analysis. These initial investigations examined political speeches as isolated texts, often separated from their broader social contexts. During the decades of the 1970s and 1980s, however, such scholars as Van Dijk (1986) and Fairclough (1992) expanded this view, studying the specifics of how political discourse represents ideological principles within the public sphere and providing analytical frameworks to the examination of the relationships between language, politics and socio-cultural environment.

In contemporary society, it has become an incredibly powerful tool used to persuade, inform, and manipulate individuals framing political ideologies and

actions, as well as reflecting the essence of societal values, beliefs, and norms with the use of language, which plays a critical role in shaping perceptions and attitudes within political discourse. This part reviews the existing theoretical background on the basic approaches and theories to the study of political discourse. In addition, this chapter aims to provide a detailed analysis of this field's structural components, defining its key features and characteristics.

First and foremost, it is of paramount importance to highlight the fundamental view on political discourse that has been further used and developed in contemporary studies. Classical rhetorical theory outlined by Aristotle (4th century B.C.) distinguishes three forms of oratory that remain relevant to understanding the essence of political discourse: judicial, deliberative, and epideictic. The former type focuses on past actions and events, aiming to establish justice by arguing about the legality of those events (Frost, 2002). It is typically employed in legal settings, such as courts, where the goal is to convince judges of the guilt or innocence of a party based on evidence. The quality of judicial rhetoric depends heavily on the orator's professional skill and ability to manage the attention of the audience through logical reasoning and emotional engagement. As Reisigl (2008) states, the deliberative genre relates to different views about political decisions in the public sphere, usually accompanied with advising or persuading an audience about future actions or policies, while the epideictic genre focuses on the verbalisation of political values, usually praising or blaming political agendas and achievements.

While this classical framework helps determine the communicative goal of political speeches, contemporary scholars (Fairclough, 2012; Wilson & Boxer, 2015; Sukhanov, 2018; et al.) argue that it is insufficient for understanding the dynamics of modern political texts, extending it with the use of other scientific disciplines. A transdisciplinary approach combining rhetorical theory, political science, linguo-cultural approach and discourse analysis is

necessary for a comprehensive analysis of the language employed in political discourse to transmit hidden meanings.

Next, it is necessary to outline various frameworks on the definition of the political discourse presented in the research field, as it is a polysemantic concept comprising a variety of approaches (Beaugrande, 1997). It encompasses the language used in political contexts, including speeches, debates, and media representations. According to the author, political discourse contains particular structures and activities that utilise specific collections of words to reflect human thought and social reality. From this perspective, the connection between language and societal and cultural constituencies is emphasised.

Isabela Fairclough and Norman Fairclough (2012), developing the ideas of Norman Fairclough's first publication, define political discourse as a form of social practice where language is used to demonstrate power, construct ideologies, and maintain dominance. According to this view, political discourse is not neutral, but reflects and reinforces power structures. The Fairclough approach to political discourse analysis integrates critical discourse analysis (CDA) with argumentation theory, offering a transdisciplinary method for examining political texts and practices. Their approach later expands on Norman Fairclough's (1992) earlier CDA framework, which analyses political discourse through three interconnected dimensions:

1. **Text analysis:**

- Linguistic analysis of vocabulary, grammar, metaphors, and rhetorical strategies;
- Examines linguistic cues that are used to construct ideological positions and persuade audiences (e.g., stylistic devices, expressive means of language, rhetorical appeals, etc.).

2. **Discourse practice (analysis):**

- Focuses on text production, distribution, and consumption by the audience.

- Analyses intertextuality (how texts reference other discourses) and interdiscursivity (mixing of genres or styles).
- Examines the texts' or speeches' relation to other texts or speeches, i.e. identifies hidden meanings, backgrounds, references, emotional density.

3. **Social practice (analysis):**

- Investigates how discourse reproduces or challenges power structures.
- Connects linguistic choices to broader societal ideologies and interactions, cultural norms and activities, political statements and ideologies.

Another viewpoint on political discourse implies that understanding a nation's political discourse requires an examination of its political culture, and it is crucial to study socio-cultural context when analysing discourse, since it is impossible to differentiate between the actual and hidden meanings of the utterance if a viewer is isolated from the cultural context (Bystrov, 2024). It is interesting to note that some of the key features that characterise American political discourse are outlined by the author, including societal heterogeneity and a pronounced degree of political contention. As Guan and Zhao (2016) states, a human uses language as a communicative tool and the members of society utilise the meaning of words to communicate with each other according to the sociocultural model of the nation. This perspective is necessary to take into account when conducting the analysis of political speeches, since they are directly related to the cultural and political events happening in the country, and are aimed at persuading and affecting the listeners' mindset and thoughts.

Almahasees & Mahmoud (2022) define political discourse as inherently ideological, serving as a tool for the expression of power relations negotiated through language. They also support the Fairclough approach highlighting the role of Critical Discourse Analysis (CDA) in uncovering these underlying ideologies.

Political discourse is a paramount element of each society that shapes public opinion, impacts policy-making and facilitates the communication between the politicians and citizens (Kannan, 2020). Therefore, it is necessary to pay attention to its key functions and goals. First of all, the persuasive function is to be presented. The study conducted by Almahasees & Mahmoud (2022) suggests that the primary goal of political discourse is to persuade audiences, manipulate viewpoints, and frame policies with the use of particular techniques (linguistic, rhetorical, etc.). Second of all, political discourse plays an essential role in shaping politicians' social identities and a preferable image that fits societal views and norms (Reyes, 2015). Next, political discourse aims to resolve conflicts and soften the real state of things by framing issues in a way that fosters agreement or understanding among differing parties (Reyes, 2015). Last but not least, it is important to mention the function of public engagement. Political speeches include various linguistic clues (e.g., questions, emotional appeals, call to action statements, manipulation, public addresses) that promote discussions on policies and governance, as well as encourage public participation and create the sense of involvement into the democratic processes (Renwick & Fieldhouse, 2023).

Having covered different approaches to defining political discourse and its main functions, it is also vital to outline the key elements that are employed in political speeches in order to make the functions perform their main goals. Political discourse appears in both written and oral forms, each with distinct characteristics and impacts. The former includes government reports, policy documents, and articles, while the latter comprises speeches, debates, interviews, and other public addresses (Bystrov, 2024). Contemporary political discourse is also extending to digital media platforms. For instance, online discussion forums and social media posts, which have transformed and expanded the ways of how political utterances are conveyed and received (Fairclough & Fairclough, 2012).

A political speech is a formal address delivered by a political figure, activist, or leader to influence public opinion, advocate for policies, or mobilise support for a cause or candidate (Atkinson, 1984). In general, the classification of political speeches varies depending on the sphere within which they are delivered (Reisigl, 2008). The author explains that each political activity can be accompanied with particular types of speeches that are appropriate for the communicative goal of the activity. For instance, the utterances produced by the parties and governmental bodies (e.g., the congress or parliament) can be classified into their election campaigns, debates, conferences, announcements, formal discussions, and interviews each with distinct communicative situations. What is more, according to the outlined classification, public demonstrations, processions, banners and slogans are another type of political texts and speeches.

Among the main types of presidential speeches in political discourse, which are the main units of this study's analysis, scholars (Fanani, et al., 2019; Hann, 2024) point out election speeches that outline the politicians' vision and goals; campaign speeches that are aimed at persuading voters during elections, transmitting policy proposals or criticising opponents. Additionally, the authors outline policy speeches as a separate type of presidential speeches within the political discourse that focus on clarifying and defending specific legislation or governmental agendas, and finally, victory and concession speeches that are delivered post-election to accept defeat or celebrate victory, emphasising shared achievement, unity and reinforcing presidential position.

Regarding the features of political speeches, the authors (Fanani et al., 2019) highlight, first of all, persuasive rhetoric as a distinct and significant part of each of the mentioned types of speeches in political discourse. According to the authors, political leaders implement pathos, ethos, and logos to establish a close and credible connection with the audience, and intensify the emotional impact. Second of all, the importance of a structured and thoroughly constructed

narrative and storytelling techniques is emphasised. Political speeches often capture personal stories, anecdotes, historical and cultural references (allusions) to make arguments relatable and persuasive. Third of all, the authors claim that the shifts between inclusive ('we', 'the people') and exclusionary ('us against them') language are worth paying attention to, since these tools construct certain political identities or succinctly promote political policies. Finally, these types of speeches are characterised by symbolic representations of power and authority, as well as by framing devices used to construct particular interpretations of reality and manipulate public opinions.

Further on, the peculiarities of pre-election and victory speeches are to be examined in detail since they are the subject of the given study. Pre-election speeches serve as persuasive tools through which candidates present their vision and seek electoral support (Zakoyan, 2014). Analysing this aspect, Antonova (2011) outlined distinct characteristics that pre-election speeches share. First and foremost, pre-election speeches contain special etiquette phrases, i.e. formal greetings and expressions of appreciation to the audience. Another important feature is the prognostic character of such speeches, meaning that they typically focus on the future with the emphasis on the candidate's vision and plans. Next, the author states that promise (i.e. commitments about future actions if elected) is a central communicative goal in pre-election speeches. Thus, such speeches usually have numerous grammatical and lexical repetitions, as well as appeals to emotions and references (allusions). Last but not least, these speeches include persuasive segments (manipulative microtexts) designed to impact voters' behaviour.

As for the victory speech, Raesky and Novitri (2023) define it as a formal address delivered by a political candidate or leader after winning an election. Its primary purpose is to celebrate success, unify supporters, and outline a vision for future governance. Moving on, the authors point out victory speeches serve as a tool of emphasising gratitude, humility, and collective purpose to foster the

winner's mandate and reinforce national or communal unity through the actions and language used to transmit them. Additionally, the authors outline conciliatory tone, high emotional density, inclusive language and symbolic gestures as distinct characteristics of the victory speeches.

Political discourse encompasses both linguistic and extralinguistic dimensions, functioning as a complex system of socially significant meaning-making. Political actions and the language used to transmit them are under the study of Political Discourse Theory (PDT) that is a framework for analysing how language and communication shape political realities, identities, and power relations (Böhm et al., 2010). It is rooted in the idea that social and political phenomena are not fixed or given, but are constructed and made meaningful through discourse and the ways people talk about and interpret the world and culture around them. Political Discourse Theory (PDT) considers discourse as a comprehensive structure that includes both language and actions accompanying the utterance (Glynos et al., 2009). This perspective emphasises that political discourse is not merely a text but also encompasses context, actions, and social interactions that collectively generate meaning.

Political Discourse Theory is characterised by several core principles (Böhm et al., 2014). Firstly, social and political objects (institutions, identities, policies) are constructed under the influence of discourse. Truth or reality in politics are the result of ongoing processes of meaning-making by individuals and groups. Secondly, political meanings and social structures are not fixed, as they are dependent on historical and contextual factors. This means that what is considered 'normal' in politics can change over time. Thirdly, language is the primary tool through which people make sense of political life. PDT examines how political leaders use language to frame issues, legitimise their authority, and justify policies. Political speeches are seen as key elements where such framing occurs, shaping public perceptions and political realities. Furthermore, PDT draws attention to rhetorical strategies in political speeches, such as

emphasising ‘our’ positive actions and ‘their’ negative actions, which are used to persuade, polarise, or unify audiences (Van Dijk, 2006).

In conclusion, political discourse is a dynamic and complex phenomenon that simultaneously reflects and shapes society's ideological, cultural and social dimensions. The interrelation of language, power, and cultural context highlights the necessity of a transdisciplinary approach for its analysis, as no single theoretical perspective can fully capture the complexity and effectiveness of political utterances. The analysis of political discourse is essential to understanding the processes by which political realities and ideologies are created and affected with the use of language and cultural connotations embedded in it in the modern world.

1.3. Linguistic and Cultural analysis

Based on the established definitions of both linguo-culturology and cultural linguistics, as well as their objectives and main units under study, it becomes possible to proceed directly to the analysis that is carried out within the framework of these two scientific disciplines. To begin with, it is necessary to explore the essence of the analysis within each of the approaches, as well as their methods and features.

Linguo-cultural analysis examines units that have acquired a certain symbolic meaning and that are culturally-defined as a result of their process of formation and further development (Butenko, 2008). Maslova (2001), considering the internal structure of this approach to analysis, also highlights the importance of cultural universals. These are the same or common to all cultures, regardless of historical differences, fundamental structures or approaches in certain areas of human life (Petrova & Petrov, 2025). For example, the presence of language as a way of expressing thought and spiritual aspects, myths, legends, and others. The relevance of focusing on cultural universals is also

identified by the fact that they serve as a base for the creation of ideological references in regard with different epochs (Maslova, 2001).

For a full-fledged comprehension of the nature of the analysis within the framework of the linguo-culturology, it is crucial to understand that the studied linguistic units may be different in the way they embody symbolic information. Based on this idea, Telia (2005) argues that such units can be of two types:

- *denotative;*

This is a definition that, according to the approach, is associated with the designation of concepts of material, spiritual and social culture.

- *connotative.*

This is an additional evaluative definition that reflects a culturally determined meaning.

Therefore, within the framework of linguo-culturology, both aspects are considered, since they have a direct impact on the transmission of cultural meaning (culturally determined symbolic meaning). At the same time, in the process of analysing a connotative meaning, it is also important to take into account the context of the use of the linguistic unit.

Considering culturally-loaded linguistic units, the study of which is the main objective of linguo-cultural analysis, it is significant to note some aspects of their representation in discourse (Maslova, 2001). Namely, that the studied units have the following forms, regardless of the speaker's communicative goal:

- separate words and expressions;
- phrases;
- proverbs and sayings;
- phraseological units;
- set expressions.

In total, there are 9 main units that are under research in the linguo-cultural approach (see Appendix, Table 9.), but all of them (which are

linguistic units rather than systems of using a certain type of discourse and stylistic device of speech) have one of the established forms.

Vorobyev (2006), discussing linguo-cultural units (i.e. individual signs and the meanings they have) in the process of their functioning in speech, noted the importance of studying not only speakers who transmit and load linguistic units with a certain meaning, but also those who decode these messages. This point of view, which emphasises the importance of interpretation and correct decoding, is supported by the structure of the semiotic analysis of signs and systems in general. Overall, there are 3 stages or levels of this kind of analysis (Lantsevskaya, 2022):

- *syntactic;*

At this level, the relationship between signs and the ways they are introduced into discourse is explored, depending on the communicative task.

- *semantic;*

At this level, the meaning, content, and information that a sign can convey are explored.

- *pragmatic.*

This level examines the relationship between the author, who has given a sign a certain meaning, and the listener or reader who interprets this message.

Butenko (2008) supports the idea proposed by Vorobyev (2006) about the importance of considering the semantic content of the studied units and the contextual relations, in other words, the pragmatic aspect. This is due to the fact that with the implementation of this integrated approach it becomes possible to obtain maximum knowledge about the cultural meanings that have been embedded in the symbolic system of linguistic units.

Further, moving to the cultural aspect of the analysis, Maslova (2001) denotes the importance of studying the following notions:

- **social rules and norms** (those that take place in real life and are transmitted, and those that are only expected to take place);

- **social values** (they are formed under the influence of religion, politics and social spheres of society).

On the basis of these two components, the discourse is evaluated or qualified as “worthy or unworthy”, as well as “accepted or not accepted" (Maslova, 2001).

Fatkullina (2017), debating about the importance of correctly defining the essence of the cultural aspect in linguo-cultural analysis, puts forward a theory about 3 variations of the manifestation of this phenomenon. In particular, these are:

- *culture* is a special social environment that is created by a person in the course of historical development;
- *culture* is a manifestation of the collective creative activity of human communities, namely certain nations;
- *culture* is a symbolic system, the separate units of which are objects and phenomena of both material and immaterial nature (which give meaning to certain social groups).

In addition, based on the key characteristics of culture, the author argues that there are 2 most extensive areas where it is possible to note a correlation between language utilised and the cultural heritage or background of the speaker. For this reason, they are an integral part of the linguo-cultural analysis. These are the following aspects:

- **analysis (presence) of a cultural background;**

These are nominative units, namely words and phraseological units, which denote events from historical and social life relevant to a particular cultural and linguistic community.

- **analysis (presence) of a "cultural memory".**

These are associations that are set by a specific linguistic unit and are related to the historical use of the unit, creating a new modern meaning.

Taking into consideration all of the abovementioned, linguo-cultural analysis is the study of linguistic units that have acquired their symbolic meaning, as well as culturally-defined meaning as a result of social development. A separate part of the study is the interpretation of these units, taking into account both the context and other external factors (for example, to whom the letter is addressed, cultural background of the speaker, and others). Cultural universals are also under the focus of the analysis, as they convey a certain symbolic meaning (Vorobyev, 2006; Butenko, 2008; Maslova, 2001).

Continuing with cultural linguistics, it is important to note that this approach to analysis is more extensive in its scope, since it is associated with the study of cognitive aspects of language. For this reason, this scientific discipline has a number of features that affect the research process (Rahimova, 2024).

Starting with the definition, cultural linguistics analysis explores broader lexical units and is aimed not just at decoding the transmitted message, but at systematizing the “speaker-audience” chain in relation to various images (Gao & Feng, 2014). Langacker (1994) also argued that the analysis conducted within the framework of this approach is based not only on lexical units, but also on facets of grammar. This approach was reflected in the work of Sharifian (2017), who claimed that the use of certain grammatical structures is directly related to cultural conceptualizations and is a reflection of the speaker's cultural background.

According to Gao & Feng (2014), the study of the role of images in general is one of the priorities of cultural linguistics, since words acquire commonly accepted meanings as a result of their correlation with images. The founder of the idea of this interconnection was Palmer (1996), who proposed the theory that language as a phenomenon is only a “game” of verbal or speech symbols based on imagery. At the same time, the author emphasises that the notion of imagery is not limited only to the visual component, but also has a

phonetic component. Moreover, this concept also includes such aspects as (Palmer, 1996):

- patterns of images;
- social scenarios;
- cognitive models.

The latter is also highlighted by Gao & Feng (2014), arguing that the process of words acquiring their meanings is part of the interpretation of the obtained information in the framework of the cognitive model, which is formed under the influence of a certain social and cultural environment.

Discussing image analysis, Palmer (1996) emphasises that since cultural linguistics is a synthesis of cognitive and anthropological linguistics, it is possible to apply the methods of its constituent approaches within the framework of the analysis conducted within this scientific discipline. Thus, the following analysis system is distinguished, which consists of 3 key stages:

1. 3 main approaches in anthropology ->

- boasian linguistics

This approach considers language as a reflection not only of culture, but also of the mentality of representatives of certain nations (Salamh & Maalej, 2018). According to the authors, it also proposes the idea that the representation of experience in languages varies, which creates linguistic categories. The latter have a direct impact on the way people think in regard with their language groups and cultures. In fact, this idea of “language-culture” chain became the basis for further studies conducted by such scientists as Edward Sapir and Benjamin Lee Whorf.

- ethnosemantics

This approach considers language as a reflection of culture in connection with the characteristics inherent in a particular ethnic group (Leavitt, 2014). Therefore, it examines how ethnicity can affect the perception of information, world cognition, as well as influence the idea of imagery. In addition, according

to the author, this approach analyses not only how people organise and structure knowledge depending on their nationality, but also how approaches to assigning meaning to a word differ.

- ethnography of speaking

This approach examines the relationship between representatives of a certain ethnic group and the culturally determined ways of speaking they use (Tarasova, 2018). By the latter, the author means both the choice of certain linguistic means and grammatical structures. In this regard, it is relevant to note that Hymes (1962), whose research served as the basis for the further development of the ethnography of speaking, noted the importance of communicative competence in creating social relationships. The latter includes both the ability to correctly convey an idea or thought, and interpret messages based on who the author is, in what historical and time period it is done, and who is the recipient.

2. Cognitive linguistics ->

Cognitive linguistics uses a variety of analytical tools from various related disciplines, such as cognitive sciences (Sharifian, 2017). One of the most prominent examples is the concept of schemas, which are considered to be an abstract phenomenon that determines the presence of blocks of cognition that are used to store, organise, and subsequently interpret transmitted information (Bartlett, 1932; Rumelhart, 1980). At the same time, patterns of images are considered as repetitive cognitive structures that have a direct impact on the formation of structures of thinking, understanding information and reasoning (Sharifian, 2017). The author adds that cognitive structures inherently have different ways of representation, including conceptual metaphors. With the use of the latest, it becomes possible to conceptualise and understand the essence of one conceptual area through the use of another. Palmer (1996) argued that conceptual metaphors are based on cultural characteristics, and therefore unique to each nationality. For example, such metaphorical phrases as “thin-skinned”

and “thick-skinned" use conceptual metaphors in the meaning of skin as a person's armor or protective layer.

3. Cultural linguistics.

Palmer (1996) highlighted that integrating cognitive linguistics with anthropological frameworks enriches cultural linguistics’ analytical approach and expands its interdisciplinarity Sharifian (2017) further supported the idea that the discipline’s qualitative methodologies enhance its effectiveness in such contexts as intercultural communication and political discourse analysis, where culturally grounded conceptualizations are numerous.

Taking into consideration all of the abovementioned, cultural linguistics analysis is the study of language as a system of symbols and images that are directly related to both the process of thinking and cognitive structures in their various manifestations (for example, conceptual metaphors). Moreover, the examination organised within the framework of this approach focuses on both lexical units that have a culturally determined meaning and grammatical structures, the use of which is justified by social norms and established rules in society.

For the analysis to be the most extensive in its scope and detailed, this paper is to implement a synthesis of linguo-culturology and cultural linguistics - linguistic and cultural approach or linguistic and cultural analysis. This implies the integration of basic analytical tools and techniques, as well as a combination of the research items, namely linguistic units with culturally-loaded meanings, conceptual metaphors as a way to reveal cultural identity, and the use of certain grammatical structures in order to reflect social norms and rules established by society. It is important to note that the analysis includes not only verbal variations of speech, but also non-verbal cues implemented by speakers.

Developing the idea of why verbal and non-verbal methods of transmitting information come under study within the framework of a linguistic and cultural approach, it is important to note that they are both ways of

communication. Moreover, these methods are among the most complex and crucial cognitive processes that take place in the human mind (Mammadzada, 2023). Thus, their analysis makes it possible to trace not only how thinking formed within the framework of one ethnic group affects the methods of interaction used, but also to trace the cultural background of the speaker. The presence of the latter is due to the fact that the unit of interaction in the verbal method of communication is language, which is a representation of changing social norms (Jiang, 2017). In the case of non-verbal ways of transmitting information, it is necessary to investigate the so-called “hidden” meaning, which is a reflection of culture in language, as well as in the existing norms of behavior (Jiang, 2017; Hui & Luchinskaya, 2024; Touaoula, 2017).

Having a generalised understanding of the two main types of communication, it is possible to consider each separately and identify the main techniques used within each of them. Starting with the verbal way of interaction, Khasanova (2015) argues that this method is information delivery through the use of language as a system of signs and meanings. Sinelnikova (2022) clarifies that this transfer can be expressed by the exchange of thoughts, ideas, and no less importantly by the emotional components of the speaker (such as happiness, doubts, and insecurities). At the same time, Aripova (2023) notes that direct communication or the process of information exchange is the final stage in the verbal communication model, which has the following structure:

- **information;**

Under the influence of human cognitive activity, a message is transformed into a specific code (word) and transmitted in the format of a discourse or text. At the same time, each language has a number of ready-made codes, the use of which varies depending on the communicative task. It is important to note that such combinations do not convey strictly loaded information units, since their use is conditioned by the formal norms of society. For instance, welcome and farewell phrases. In addition, it is also essential to identify that different messages may

also have various communicative structure and load. One of such cases is when messages with a high information load have a complex language or the terminology. Due to that reason it is necessary to have additional knowledge about the realms in order to correctly decode the idea being transmitted (e.g., a pre-election speech or a scientific article). On the contrary, there are messages with a low information load, which have the opposite structure and which are often used together with non-verbal codes in the form of gestures (e.g., waving during a friendly conversation with a neighbor).

- **communication means;**

This aspect has code and signal formats. A code refers to a sign system that can transmit a message from one signal system to another. The primary code in the process of verbal communication is considered to be an ordinary language and a system of grammatical and pragmatic rules that can be applied to it. Further, it is important to distinguish between non-verbal and verbal codes of a non-linguistic sign system. The latter implies the use of gestures as a complementary unit of information transmission (e.g., to point at an object and say “This one"). At the same time, signals are considered to be the physical capabilities of each person using the senses to perceive information. For example, to recognize sound waves and identify meaningful speech (message) in them.

- **communication network;**

This aspect is expressed in the “speaker-listener” and “encoder-decoder" chains. To begin with, it is crucial to distinguish the medium (means) of transmitting a message from the channel used to do it. The term means of communication traditionally refers to verbal methods, which have two formats of speech presentation, namely oral or written. At the same time, a message transmission channel refers to a type of physical data transmission, namely sound vibrations (sound), smell, and others. Depending on its category, the type of contact between the two sides of the communication may vary. The latter can be direct

(live communication) or mediated (using electronic devices or other units as an intermediary) and a monologue (communication is considered to be passive and does not require a response, depending on the situation, the audience decoding the message may or may not be present) or a dialogue (communication occurs between two or more parties, which implies the presence of reaction from the listeners, as well as the mutual exchange of information).

- **communicative activity.**

This aspect implies creating a message by encoding it and only then transmitting it over a communication channel, as well as receiving the message and decoding it by the recipient. Based on this system of communicative activity, there is a theory that it is cyclical in its structure (this ends with the transmission of the message and begins with a decoding, followed by the production of a response to it). At the same time, it is added that verbal communication is a continuous process (i.e. only the recipient of the message changes, which makes it the basis of social life.

Developing the idea of the types of verbal communication mentioned above, there are two main approaches that are traditionally distinguished and which also have their own components (Sinelnikova, 2022):

1. *external speech* (occurs between people or groups of people);

- written;
- oral.

Both types of external speech can be either monologues or dialogues.

2. *inner speech* (communication takes place in a person's mind, is considered part of the thinking process).

Discovering oral verbal speech when interacting with other people, Mammadzada (2023) notes that it is divided into several types, depending on who is the addressee and who will decode it:

1. **Dyadic communication;**

Within the framework of this type of information transmission, communication takes place between two individuals. At the same time, participants can change their roles - speaker and listener.

2. **Small groups communication;**

Within the framework of this type of information transmission, communication occurs when more than two people are involved. Depending on the context, participants do not always have the opportunity to change their roles - speaker and listener. In such a situation, feedback occurs through the use of non-verbal methods of communication. For example, a weekly meeting in an organization to confirm a new content plan or product may have a discussion format, or it may have a “yes or no" voting form.

3. **Public communication.**

Within the framework of this type of information transmission, communication takes place only if there is a large audience (the number strongly contrasts with the small groups communication). The main difference is the communicative task, the formality of speech, and the means of interaction. Public communication is traditionally one-sided, so the roles of participants do not change regardless of the context. At the same time, there can be one speaker, as well as several of them, passing the word to each other in accordance with the established rules and program of the meeting or event. This type of verbal communication is most common in such manifestations of political discourse as pre-election and victory speeches of presidents, mayors and members of administration.

Developing the idea of a verbal way of transmitting data and its variability depending on the people and culture, Edward Hall notes the importance of considering the context where it occurs. By the latter, the author means additional information that is necessary to understand the essence of a particular culturally-loaded unit or occasion. It is often manifested in

comprehending the historical development of the nation, within the framework of which this event took place.

Taking into consideration all of the abovementioned, verbal communication is based on language as a system of signs and meanings, the use of which is aimed at expressing thoughts, ideas and emotions through a message. The medium and channel of transmission may vary depending on the communicative goal and who it is aimed at. Thus, verbal communication can be external, expressed in written and oral speech, as well as internal, in other words, a manifestation of a person's thought process. Moreover, this type of interaction also varies depending on the addressee or the decoder. Namely, it can be dyadic, among small groups, and public, each with its own components and peculiarities.

In addition to verbal means of transmitting information, Mammadzada (2023) highlights that human use of non-verbal methods is a natural and integral part of communication in general. For this reason, the study of these two concepts in the process of interaction between people can serve as a tool to gain deeper knowledge about human cognitive activity, the mutual influence of language and culture, as well as the structure and function of speech depending on the communicative task.

Moving on to the definition of non-verbal means of communication, Su Mon (2017) argues that they refer to the transmission of information without the use of language, including the use of body movements, gestures, facial expressions and other tools that do not represent the direct usage of words. Mammadzada (2023) adds that tone of voice, intonation, pitch, and other phonetic features are also an important part of non-verbal ways of conveying information. The author also emphasizes that such methods have a lot of hidden meanings that can say even more about the speaker than one’s words. Therefore, using a certain pose, facial expressions, and intonation can signal that the other person is tense, relaxed, or not at all interested in the conversation. At the same

time, the meaning of gestures is determined by culture and may vary depending on nationality. For this reason, it is worth using them with special attention and accuracy in cross-cultural communication (Mammadzada, 2023).

The variability of the meaning of gestures depending on culture is also emphasized by Aripova (2023) in a comparative analysis of non-verbal means such as gestures and human physiological movements. According to the author, the following aspects can be identified as the main criteria for the correct differentiation:

- **gesture has a signifier and a signified;**

The presence of these two aspects of a gesture, as opposed to just a movement, is key, despite the fact that the relationship between them is usually considered conditional (determined by cultural and social aspects).

- **gestures express meaning;**

Gestures, unlike accidental movements, have an information code embedded in them. It is crucial to take into account the context, as it is necessary for the correct decoding of a non-verbal message. For example, waving your hand while talking about the wind will make sense, but randomly raising one's hand on the way home because one got bored has no semantic function.

- **gestures can change meaning.**

This aspect is directly related to the previous two, since the meaning inherent in the gesture is traditionally culturally and socially conditioned. At the same time, as mentioned above, it can change its information load depending on geographical usage. For example, the "OK" gesture has the meaning of agreeing to something in the USA, but at the same time it is considered to be offensive within the framework of French culture.

Manusov (2016) proposes a different classification, arguing that it is more correct to characterize non-verbal communication methods based on neurological factors. The author emphasizes that each communication system

has a direct connection with the physical abilities of representatives of certain nationalities. Thus, there are 3 key types of non-verbal communication:

- **spontaneous communication;**

This aspect implies the idea that there is a certain code of physiological reaction (biological heritage) that is inherent in humans and that manifests itself in various (not necessarily critical) situations. For example, scratch a place that itches, or yawn when one wants to sleep. It is essential to identify that spontaneous communication can be decoded by representatives of different cultures, regardless of their background.

- **pseudo-spontaneous communication;**

This aspect implies the idea that there can be a targeted use of unified physiological gestures or actions in order to achieve a desired result. For example, yawn during a long conversation with a friend to end it quickly.

- **symbolic communication.**

This aspect is different from the previous ones and implies the presence of a communication system that only representatives of one culture can decode in the correct way. This means that symbolic communication, as it was already established within the framework of the abovementioned classifications, can vary depending on nationality and culture in general.

The theory of the correct use of non-verbal methods of communication is proposed by Avazova (2024), emphasizing that knowledge of how to correctly encode and decode a message of this type is a skill that needs to be developed. Based on this, the concept of “non-verbal sensitivity” was created. It is used to denote the ability to detect the use of non-verbal signals by a speaker and interpret them correctly, taking into account the context of the message being transmitted. It is also important to note that the development of such a skill as “non-verbal sensitivity" should take place in a narrowly focused environment, for example, with an orientation on gestures, intonation or facial expressions. Revealing the essence of encoding, Avazova (2024) notes that the

ability to formulate information correctly using non-verbal means of communication at the right moment of speech is no less difficult. It is applicable to both spontaneous actions and premeditated or rehearsed ones. According to the author, it is crucial to identify that traditionally a person's ability to correctly encode non-verbal units is directly related to the cultural background and the expressivity of emotions inherent in one’s nationality. At the same time, Manusov (2016) notes that having a well-developed skill in decoding non-verbal messages does not mean that a person can also encode such units properly (and vice versa).

Taking into consideration all of the abovementioned, it is possible to make a conclusion that non-verbal communication is based on the transmission of a message without using language, and with a focus on gestures, facial expressions, phonetic features, and others. At the same time, it is crucial to distinguish between physiological movements and information-loaded ones, i.e. gestures. The latter also vary in their meaning, but are traditionally associated with a person's culture and nationality. Moreover, non-verbal interaction may differ depending on the communicative goal, namely, it can be spontaneous, pseudo-spontaneous and symbolic. Further, the correct encoding and decoding of a transmitted message of this type is a skill, the development of which is also related to the cultural background of a person. However, the ability to correctly interpret non-verbally transmitted information does not imply that the same person can also expressively use emotionally-loaded units oneself. Overall, such communication methods are the most powerful tools that can be used in order to influence and manipulation an auditory, and which are based on the literate use of a system of non-verbal signs (Avazova, 2024; Aripova, 2023; Mammadzada, 2023; Manusov, 2016; Su Mon, 2017).

The combination of verbal and non-verbal communication methods adds emotionality and expressivity to speech (both written and oral) and allows for a greater impact on the listener or audience (Mammadzada, 2023). Aripova

(2023), developing the idea of the importance of synthesizing these two approaches, argues that only their joint study makes it possible to determine the communicative intention set by the speaker, as well as to correctly interpret the embedded message.

According to Mammadzada (2023), verbal and non-verbal communication methods are complementary to each other and possess the following functions:

- *regulation;*

This aspect is related to the possibility of non-verbal methods to coordinate the interaction process by expressing internal tension, as well as other emotions and feelings during communication for its successful completion.

- *completion;*

This aspect is related to the correlation of verbal and non-verbal means for the completion and integrity of the transmitted message by filling it with expressive units. The primary aim of it is to achieve a specific communicative goal.

- *substitution;*

This aspect is related to the fact that in certain situations and contexts, verbal and non-verbal methods are considered to be not only complementary, but also interchangeable. Thus, one gesture can replace an entire phrase, while words reveal the meaning of a message better than a specific gesture.

- *refusal.*

This aspect is related to the fact that sometimes a person experiences dissonance during communication, and due to this reason, verbal and non-verbal methods may contradict each other. For example, when a person nods, supporting an expressed idea, and at the same time says “No, of course, such an act is unacceptable, I agree”.

Sobirova (2021) identifies these functions as methods, and adds that non-verbal ways of transmitting information are more emotionally loaded and traditionally convey additional meaning that is important for the context. In

addition to the aspects proposed by Mammadzada (2023), the author also highlights the following methods:

- *repetition;*

This aspect is related to the fact that non-verbal tools usually repeat verbal text and thus make it more expressive and easy to understand. For example, when using the word “extension", the gesture of spreading the arms to the sides is used.

- *emphasis.*

This aspect is related to the fact that non-verbal units are traditionally aimed at highlighting individual words and ideas in verbal speech, thereby focusing listeners' attention on specific ideas.

Expressivity and emotionality, according to Safina (2017), are an integral part of verbal and non-verbal communication. This is due to the fact that these approaches are types of communicative influence. Therefore, the main purpose of each of them is to transmit and then inculcate certain messages or ideas to decoders. At the same time, the author emphasizes that achieving a manipulative goal is possible only with the synthesis of verbal and non-verbal means, since the first aspect is the basis for communication, while the second one is considered as an impulse to project emotions.

1.4. The use of culturally-loaded linguistic devices in political discourse.

Having examined the nature of political discourse and approaches to its analysis in this research, namely linguo-culturology and cultural linguistics frameworks, as well as outlined their main functions and classifications, it is necessary to focus on the tools that are subjects of the study’s examination and that can be used by politicians in their speeches in order to make the utterances more persuasive and effective.

Political speeches are strong tools of persuasion where language, culture, and power converge, shaping public perception and reinforcing ideological paradigms (Bystrov, 2024). Language serves as the primary medium through which political ideas are communicated. It shapes perceptions and can manipulate public opinion. According to Chilton (2004, pp. 38), 'language creates politics', without it, political activities would not exist. By integrating linguistic and cultural approach to the analysis of presidential speeches, this research underscores the role of political leaders as representatives of particular cultural backgrounds and emphasises the importance of decoding cultural connotations transmitted through the use of linguistic features within the political discourse.

To begin with, it is necessary to state that this research pays close attention to all verbal and non-verbal peculiarities presented in the analysed presidential speeches. It is explained by the fact that the chosen linguistic and cultural approach to analysis by its nature is aimed at providing a holistic and all-encompassing representation of all key linguistic and cultural features inherent in a person as a representative of a particular culture and nation, and as future leader, whose linguistic choices directly influence public opinions and decisions. As it has been stated by Fanani et al. (2019), the distinct feature of presidential speeches is structured and thoroughly constructed narrative and storytelling techniques, the main purpose of which is to affect the audience and manipulate listeners' perception. This is achieved by employing specific verbal and non-verbal tools that frame ideologies and hidden meanings, as well as help establish a close emotional connection between the speaker and the audience. Thus, this chapter provides a comprehensive theoretical overview of the devices and features, conveying the peculiar use of language and cultural connotations implemented to enhance the effectiveness, emotional density and credibility of

political speeches, including stylistic devices, expressive means of language, rhetorical strategies, and non-verbal cues.

First, it is crucial to note that within current research, the terms “stylistic devices” and “expressive means of language” are often utilised interchangeably. Nevertheless, although both serve to enhance speech efficiency and influence audience perception, several key distinctions exist between them that should be pointed out as this study’s practical section treats these two categories separately.

Stylistic devices, often referred to as rhetorical devices or figures of speech, are linguistic tools used to enhance the effectiveness, clarity, and expressiveness of language (Umurzakova, 2022). They encompass a wide range of tools that serve various functions in political communication, such as emphasising key points, evoking emotional responses, persuading listeners or framing issues to correspond to particular agendas.

By expressive means of language, Skrebnev (1994), who introduced the unique approach on the classification of expressive means and stylistic devices combining paradigmatic and syntagmatic concepts, implies such morphological, syntactic, and word-formative language forms that serve for emotional or logical strengthening of the speech. Expressive means, according to Skrebnev’s classification, refer to a broad category of language tools that help express thoughts, feelings, and emotions by implementing certain phonetic features (for instance, specific intonation or rhythm patterns), use of effective word ordering, syntax (i.e. peculiar grammatical structures and choices), and others. Gurevich (2022) states that expressive means are often employed in political speeches for the purpose of adding emotional, evaluative or logical emphasis in communication.

Stylistic devices, on the other hand, add expressive, structural and aesthetic power, enhancing the persuasive impact of discourse and creating

memorable phrases (slogans) that can be further reflected in people' minds (Samatullaev & Fayziyeva, 2024). In general, stylistic devices are a subset of expressive means, focusing on a narrower, whilst more deliberate linguistic techniques (e.g., metaphors, allusions, rhetorical questions, hyperboles, irony, and others) that are utilised to accomplish a variety of communicative goals, including persuasion and manipulation of public opinion in the first place. Despite the differences in terms and functions, the scholars (Dellagnelo et al., 2014) that apply Political Discourse Theory to the analysis of linguistic units highlight that both expressive means and stylistic devices are deeply intertwined with cultural conceptualisations and serve as manipulative tools that reflect and reinforce cultural ideologies.

Further on, it is necessary to analyse the expressive means and stylistic devices that are employed specifically within political discourse, since in accordance with the above mentioned theoretical principles, they fall into the category of culture-specific items that resonate with particular cultural contexts or endow communication with a high extent of emotionality or manipulativeness, that are subjects of analysis of cultural and linguistic approach. In their work on specifics of political communication, Gennaro & Ash (2022) define emotionality as a degree to which emotional content or effect is expressed in discourse. The authors highlight that this aspect plays a crucial role in political persuasion and is manifested through diverse linguistic levels (i.e. phonological, lexical, syntactic, and others), by employing specific lexical choices, rhetorical devices, and figures of speech that can be analysed through various methodological approaches.

The expressive means, as a broader category of linguistic elements, are to be discussed first. According to Lungu's (2020) study on the use of the linguistic techniques in presidential speeches, the expressive means utilised in the realm of political communication can be classified into four main types: morphological, lexical, phraseological, syntactic, and phonetic.

At the morphological level, the author highlights the use of such word-building means that serve to make the speech more expressive or to intensify the meaning (e.g., diminutives and augmentatives or particular affixes characteristic to a political utterance, e.g., '-ism'; '-ology'). Another peculiar feature of this layer of expressive means that is often employed in political communication is the use of Present Indefinite instead of the Past Indefinite. Borysov and Vasylieva (2021) call this technique 'historical Present' and describe it as an act of using present tense to describe past events, therefore providing a more vivid picturisation of what was going on in the past during the speech. In political communication, speakers use present tenses instead of past ones to intensify past achievements or highlight the strengths of their decisions and actions (Podoliuc, 2018). Khajavi and Rasti (2020) add that this technique is also used to trigger the urgency or essential decision making in cases when the speaker wants to highlight that the cause of a particular social problem is in the past, and the attempts to tackle the issue are made right now. This adds credibility to the actions of the political figure or future leader.

Moving on to the lexical level, it comprises all words with inner expressive or emotive meaning (Borysov and Vasylieva, 2021). For example, political speeches often include interjections (e.g., 'Wow!') that have only emotive meaning or qualitative adjectives (e.g., 'revolutionary' and 'impossible') that have both referential and emotive implications that are also implemented for emotional intensification. Borysov and Vasylieva (2021) add intensifiers (e.g., 'very' and 'extremely'), words that are used to amplify meaning, to this list outlining their function of emphasising key points of the utterance.

At the phraseological layer, Borysov and Vasylieva (2021) identify specific collocations, idioms, proverbs and sayings, which constitute a group of phraseological units, as subjects of analysis. These are a category of fixed, non-motivated set expressions whose meanings cannot be freely deduced from

the literal meanings of their individual components (Malinovschi, 2020). According to Vinogradov's traditional classification of phraseological units (1997), they are divided into three main types:

- **Phraseological fusions (idioms, sayings, proverbs)** – semantically indivisible phraseological units (expressions) whose meanings cannot be deduced from their parts or the literal meaning of the separate words (e.g., "*once in a blue moon*").
- **Phraseological unities** – semantically indivisible phraseological units, the overall meanings of which can be partially deduced from their literal meanings (e.g., "*to fall into a rage"*).
- **Phraseological combinations (collocations)** – special word combinations, in which one word has a bound meaning (figurative only in combination with another word) and the other has an independent one (is used literally). For example, "*the golden rule"* meaning "the important rule."

It is crucial to highlight that these linguistic units are always culturally-loaded, as they encapsulate and reflect unique values, beliefs, traditions, historical experiences, and social norms of the communities that produce and use them. Their meanings often go beyond the literal interpretation of the words and are embedded in the cultural context, making them difficult to fully understand without knowledge of that culture (Glonti, 2020). Additionally, Glonti (2020), in her work on the use of phraseological units in political discourse, considers idioms and proverbs as supporting socio-cultural tools of persuasion that are utilised by political leaders to strengthen their ideas and resonate with the listeners' minds. As an example, Donald John Trump, who sometimes employs proverbs (e.g., "The harder I work, the luckier I get"), idioms ("the golden age of America") and set expressions (e.g., "think big" or "get even") in his speeches, can be cited. These expressive means are used in such cases to connect the speaker with the audience through familiar

expressions of wisdom or culturally resonant language. Moreover, the study of these units is a subject of linguistic and cultural analysis, which examines the relationship between language and culture with a focus on how language both reflects and influences cultural concepts.

Next, based on the classification provided by Borysov and Vasylieva (2021), the expressive means analysed **at the syntactic level include:**

- **Ellipsis** – an intentional omission of one or more words from a sentence, as their meaning is implied by context (e.g., "*To the best campaign team and volunteers in the history of politics. The best* [the collocation 'campaign team' is omitted, since it is implied by the context of the first sentence]. *The best ever."* – taken from Barack Obama's victory speech). Ellipsis is usually employed in political speeches for conciseness and rhythm. It encourages the audience to actively engage by filling in the gaps mentally, which can increase attention and involvement (Musurmanova and Kirgizbayeva, 2019).
- **Inversion –** a grammatical technique in which the usual word order is reversed in order to put emphasis on particular elements. Two main types of inversion are identified in the classification by Borysov and Vasylieva (2021): complete (when the predicate is displaced) and partial (when the secondary members of the sentence are displaced). In political communication, both kinds can be implemented to highlight particular ideas in the utterance (e.g., "*Tonight, in this election, you, the American people, reminded us..."* – the case of a partial inversion taken from Barack Obama's victory speech). In this example, the phrase "you, the American people" is inserted for emotional emphasis, breaking the usual subject-verb-object order.
- **Parcellation –** a construction of expressive syntax that represents the intentional division of a coherent text into several isolated parts (segments), separated with the use of pauses in speeches or punctuation

signs in texts (e.g., "*Thank you. Thank you. Thank you so much.*" Each "Thank you" is a separate sentence, creating a parcellated effect – taken from Barack Obama's victory speech). Such pauses create dramatic effect, emphasise key points and make the speeches' narrative more sincere and emotional.

- **Enumeration –** a grammatical technique, in which several elements (not necessarily homogeneous) in a row are listed to reinforce argumentation (e.g., "*... to the furniture worker's child in North Carolina who wants to become a doctor or a scientist, an engineer or an entrepreneur, a diplomat or even a president*" – taken from Barack Obama's victory speech). The main function of enumeration in such cases is highlighting important moments in the speech (the given example illustrates the emphasis that is put on the given opportunities, provided by the government towards various groups of people).
- **Repetition –** the repetition of the same word or phrase to add emphasis or emotional influence. It is crucial to point out that repetition is considered to be an expressive means language when it is used by the speaker under the stress of strong emotion (Skrebnev, 1994). In such cases, it shows the state of mind of the speaker that is always conveyed with the use of intonation and is therefore an expressive unit transmitted through grammatical and phonetic features. However, repetition is at the same time a stylistic device when acquiring different functions in communication, namely when it is not utilised primarily for an emotional impact (though it always has emotive connotations), but logical emphasis which sheds light on the major semantic parts of the utterance and draws attention of the listeners towards these parts.

The examples provided for each of the techniques are based on the cultural and linguistic analysis of the pre-election and victory speeches of Donald John Trump, Barack Hussein Obama, and George Walker Bush. The in-depth

examination of all culturally-loaded linguistic features, including expressive means of language, stylistic devices and rhetorical strategies is presented in the practical part of the given research.

Last but not least, **the phonetic layer** is to be discussed. According to Galperin (1981) and his fundamental study on the field of language stylistics, phonetic features are the most outstanding and powerful expressive means within any kinds of discourses. As it has been outlined earlier (see part 1.3), the linguistic and cultural analysis in the given research is applied to both verbal and non-verbal clues in order to provide a holistic representation of the speaker's characteristics. Thus, at this level, such expressive means as diverse intonation patterns, pitch, stress, pausation, manner of speech are also paid close attention to in the practical part of the study, as they all can be used in political discourse to enhance the speeches' logical and emotional impacts. For example, the analysis of Donald Trump's pre-election speech, initially presented in the video format, has shown the extensive use of regular, exaggerated pauses and emphatic stress that in combination with thoroughly structured rhetoric create a stronger and more powerful emotional effect on the listener. Some scholars, including Galperin (1981) and Skrebnev (1994), even claim that such peculiarities are more effective than any other means in terms of creating vivid, persuasive utterances.

Having explored the nature and particular kinds of expressive means in political discourse, it is now essential to proceed to stylistic devices, which play a paramount role in shaping the rhetorical power of political utterances. While expressive means primarily enhance emotional and evaluative coloring of the speech, stylistic devices employ figurative and structural techniques to create and reinforce persuasion impact and manipulate the audience's views. The following theoretical overview focuses on the key stylistic devices commonly used by politicians, presenting their classifications and influence on political communication.

As it has been already outlined, stylistic devices are linguistic tools with the marked rhetorical and figurative meanings that politicians use to create emotional and cognitive effects, making their messages more compelling and memorable. They can be classified into several major types (Lungu, 2020): figures of speech (tropes), syntactic stylistic features (schemes), phonetic and morphological devices. However, the stylistic use of morphological tools (namely, morphological repetitions) are not examined in this study. It is due to the fact that morphological repetition (successive recurrence of the same morpheme, e.g., suffixes or prefixes, within a sentence or a text) is considered to be a stylistic device only when it is used deliberately to achieve a rhetorical effect and is hence more relevant in the analysis of the written texts. In political discourse and oral speeches in general, this is rather achieved by root repetition (described later in the chapter as a type of syntactical repetition) or lexical repetition of the word forms. Thus, morphological repetition in the context of this study can be related to expressive means of language in case of its occurrence, because it is most often utilised unintentionally within the speeches.

In the context of political discourse, the authors (Lungu, 2020; Maqsudova, 2024; Samatullaev and Fayziyeva, 2024; et al.) identify the following types of **figures of speech (tropes)** that are capable of constructing convincing and conceptual messages:

- **Metaphor** – a speech expression based on comparison, transferring the meaning of a word to another object or phenomenon (Semino, 2008).

According to the author, metaphors are used in discourse to convey meaning through comparison (often with the concept/object that is more familiar and close to the minds of the audience), to frame principles and ideas, emphasise analogies or contrasts between two different objects or concepts. George Lakoff and Mark Johnson's (1992) conceptual metaphor theory, based on which metaphors significantly influence communication, behavior, social norms, decision making and relationship building, identifies such kinds as orientational,

ontological and structural metaphors. The former is a metaphor that includes spatial relationships (such as up/down, in/out, on/off, front/back, etc.) to frame policies (e.g., *'Progress is upward'* – Barack Obama's victory speech). The next frequently employed type, ontological metaphor, is the one that transfers something concrete or complicated into something abstract or easy to comprehend (e.g., *'The government is a machine'* – Donald Trump's pre-election speech). The latter kind, on the contrary, is a metaphor in which a complex concept (typically abstract) is transferred into something concrete (e.g., *'Time is money*' – Donald Trump's pre-election speech). While some metaphors are universal due to shared human experiences, there can be specific comparisons that are rooted in the unique social customs, history, values or objects of a particular culture, making them conceptual. According to Hu (2024), this kind of metaphor is based on the understanding of one concept (domain of experience) in terms of another (target domain). For instance, Barack Obama, in his victory speech, employed the metaphor – "*...the task of perfecting our union moves forward*" referring in the context of the utterance to American people as a "our union that moves forward" to symbolise common national unity and present the president as a member of this unity, which connects him closer with the audience. In addition, this example also demonstrates the case of a personification in combination with the orientational type of metaphor ("*the task ... moves forward"*), giving an abstract political process a dynamic, almost physical quality.

- **Personification** – a type (variety) of metaphor that implies portraying inanimate objects (concepts) as though they were capable of performing the human actions, such as expressing thoughts and feelings, thinking or doing physical activities (Vestermark, 2007).

In her study on metaphors in politics, Vestermark states that personification is one of the tools that are used alongside with other kinds of metaphors and rhetorical devices to manipulate emotional engagement, transforming

impersonal concepts into relatable narratives (e.g., "*The spirit that has triumphed over war and depression"* – Barack Obama's victory speech).

- **Simile –** a figure of speech that directly compares two concepts using such words as "like", "as", or "than" to emphasise a particular trait of one thing by associating it with another (Ofori et al., 2021).

According to the authors of the study dedicated to the use of simile and metaphor in political discourse, both devices are implemented in communication to help the audience visualise and understand abstract or complex ideas by comparing them to concrete, relatable objects or everyday experiences, therefore making a political leader seem closer to the people (e.g., "On the open plains of Texas, I first learned the character of our country: sturdy and honest, and as hopeful as the break of day" – taken from George Bush's victory speech).

- **Allusion –** a figure of speech that contains a clear or hidden indication to a literary, historical, mythological or political fact, a famous quotation, aphorism, recorded in written or oral speech (Litvinov and V. Ubiyko, 2017).

The authors identify several types of allusions, including cultural, historical, biblical and mythological references, as well as the references to political slogans, ideologies, agendas, quotes of famous people, customs, traditions, masterpieces of art, and phenomena of mass culture. It is necessary to affirm that all types of allusion are highly culturally-loaded, as they always rely on shared knowledge without which the listeners could miss the intended meaning and emotional resonance. Analysing the effects of linguistic tools on the perception of political speeches, Bystrov (2024) confirms that by referencing familiar events or ideals, allusions inspire pride, hope and reinforce emotional appeal. Therefore, this trope is implemented very frequently in victory speeches in particular to celebrate 'shared achievement' (e.g., "*...more than 200 years*

after a former colony won the right to determine its own destiny" – Barack Obama's victory speech).

- **Metonymy –** a trope in which one word is replaced by another (usually a larger concept), based on their contiguity (Amanda, 2017).

The political speakers employ metonymy as a way of symbolic and recogniseable representation of complicated political realities, systems or institutions, facilitating quick understanding and associations (e.g., "The White House announced" – Donald Trump's pre-election speech, in which "The White House" refers to the whole presidential administration apparatus).

- **Synecdoche –** a special case (variety) of metonymy that uses a part to represent the whole, simplifying communication and making messages more concrete and clear (Amanda, 2017).

This device has a similar effect on the utterance, personalising broad categories by focusing on smaller, yet more relatable elements (e.g., "*...the chance to cast their ballots like we did today"* – "ballots" as a 'part' in the context of the Barack Obama's victory speech stand for the act of voting or 'the whole' process).

- **Antonomasia –** another case (variety) of metonymy that consists of replacing a title or name with an indication of some essential feature of an object or its relationship to something else (Poghosyan and Gumashyan, 2021).

According to the authors, in political speeches such replacement is most often achieved using epithets or descriptive phrases instead of proper names. Most importantly, within the discourse, these descriptions are based on shared knowledge about the person or object, since they otherwise may lose meaning outside the cultural context or require explanation (e.g., "*America's happy warrior"* – this phrase stands for a description of Joe Biden as "the best vice-president" in the Barack Obama's victory speech).

- **Epithet –** a qualitative adjective or descriptive phrase that characterises a person, place, or thing, often carrying figurative colouring and reflecting subjective perception or evaluative attitude (Monakhova, 2019).

In general, epithets are mostly universal as descriptive adjectives or phrases, though the connotations of certain epithets can vary culturally. Lungu (2020) reports that this device adds vividness, intensifying the impressions with emotive language and guiding audience evaluation by emphasising positive or negative qualities, therefore framing the political agendas (e.g., "*hard-fought campaign", "incredible work", "strongest military"* – Barack Obama's victory speech)

- **Hyperbole –** a trope that involves an exaggeration used for emphasis, usually not intended to be taken literally but to stress the significance of a situation, element or characteristic (Monakhova, 2019).

Lungu (2020) asserts that by highlighting the successes, political actors convince audiences of the effectiveness of something, often motivating public support or action ("*... the best troops this world has ever known"* – Barack Obama's victory speech). In addition, even though the majority of hyperboles are universal exaggerations, there are cases when particular set expressions specific to a particular language, country or nation obtain similar meaning and become culture-specific (e.g., "*Everything is gigantic in Texas"* which is used to reflect a cultural stereotype and pride associated with Texas). According to Golubeva (2019), hyperbole can be expressed in speech by a variety of forms, including adjectives (e.g., "*extravagant price*"); verbs (e.g., "*to die of curiosity")*; pronouns, especially negative pronouns (e.g., nobody, nothing) and determiners (e.g., each, every, everybody, everything), which act as intensifiers; numerals (e.g., "thousands of"); adverbs of frequency (e.g., always, never, ever), manner (e.g., inconceivably, infinitely), time (e.g., at any time, whenever), place (e.g., anywhere, nowhere, everywhere); idiomatic expressions (e.g., "hit the ceiling"); and nouns (e.g., "giant"). As for litotes, which is a form

of understatement, it is rarely implemented in political discourse and are mainly employed in debates or interviews by the speakers to subtly downplay the policies of the opponent parties and candidates, or as a form of sarcasm (Salih & Braim, 2014).

- **Irony** – a rhetorical device in which the intended meaning differs from the literal meaning or when expectations and reality diverge (Gornostayeva, 2016). According to Musolff (2017), irony is a relevant tool presented in the modern political discourse, often used as a strategic strategy aimed at delivering complex messages indirectly and making an emotional appeal. It is crucial to mention that politicians often use irony to ridicule opponents or policies without overtly attacking them (usually in parties' debates and interviews capturing political representatives). Moreover, irony can be used to build emotional connection with the audience and reduce tension. It is important to differentiate the terms 'humour' and 'irony', since humour itself is not typically classified as a single stylistic device but rather as a broader communicative strategy that can be achieved through various stylistic devices, including irony, satire, parody, hyperbole, and others. For instance, in his victory speech, Barack Obama produced a humorous effect using irony when referring to his daughters and their desire to have dogs "*And I am so proud of you guys. But I will say that, for now, one dog's probably enough* (laughter, applause)."

It is essential to mention that the above mentioned overview of lexical stylistic devices concentrates mainly on those figures of speech that have been identified as the most frequent and efficient ones in the context of political discourse. Moreover, the presented units have exceptional persuasive and emotional power, which is of paramount importance to be taken into account when examining the presidential speeches with the use of cultural and linguistic approach to acquire a full and representative analysis.

Further, it is equally important to explore **syntactic stylistic features,** which contribute significantly to the structure and persuasive power of political communication. In contrast with lexical devices that enrich political language with vivid meanings, grammatical peculiarities focus on how the speeches are organised independently of the lexical meanings of the utilised components, hence influencing the logical effectiveness of the messages transmitted. Zhang et al. (2017) outline **a rhetorical question** as one of the most prominent syntactic devices. The authors define it as a statement presented in the form of a question not to obtain an answer but to emphasise a point, gain a particular effect or engage the audience (e.g., "*Look what happened, is this crazy?"* – taken from Donald Trump's victory speech). The majority of other syntactic stylistic devices represent diverse types of grammatical repetition that are crucial to be outlined in this chapter since many scholars (Khdair, 2016; Sallomi & Chiad, 2019; Shah and Ahmad, 2020; et al.) confirm that they are very frequently employed in the domain of political speeches to intensify the manipulative aspect of communication, as well as to make the storytelling more structured and logical. Kemertelidze and Manjavidze (2013) define and describe such types of syntactic repetition as:

- **Anaphora (anaphoric repetition)** – repetition of a word or phrase at the beginning of two or more successive sentences (e.g., "*Whether you voted for the very first time … Whether you pounded the pavement or picked up the phone. Whether you held an Obama sign or a Romney sign …"* – taken from Barack Obama's victory speech)
- **Epiphora (epiphoric repetition)** – repetition of a word or phrase at the end of two or more successive sentences ("*This country has more wealth than any nation, but that's not what makes us rich. We have the most powerful military in history, but that's not what makes us strong"* – taken from Barack Obama's victory speech).

- **Anadiplosis –** repetition of the last word or phrase of the sentence at the beginning of the next one (e.g., "*... the task of perfecting our union moves forward. Moves forward because of you."* – taken from Barack Obama's victory speech). Chain repetition, a subtype of anadiplosis, that is used for a smooth development of logical and/or emotional reasoning may rarely be met in political discourse, usually in the form of repetition of collocations where one element stays unchanged, and the other replaced with another word for a further development of the idea ("*And when we go through tough times, when we make big decisions as a country, it necessarily stirs passions, stirs up controversy."* – taken from Barack Obama's victory speech)
- **Framing –** repetition of a word or phrase at the beginning of a sentence or paragraph and at the end of this syntactic unit to 'frame' the idea ("*That's what we want – that's the future we hope for. That's the vision we share. That's where we need to go – forward. That's where we need to go. That's what we want."* – taken from Barack Obama's victory speech**)**. This kind of repetition is used to frame any part of the speech – sentence, paragraph or the whole utterance. For example, when the same statement is said at the start and the end for emotional impact.
- **Root repetition –** repetition of the words that have one root but differ in their prefixes, suffixes or grammatical form. Root repetition amplifies the emotional resonance by augmenting the symbolic significance of the stressed (key) words of the statement (e.g., "*I've never been more hopeful about our future. I have never been more hopeful about America. And I ask you to sustain that hope."* – taken from Barack Obama's victory speech).
- **Antithesis –** a stylistic device that involves posing two contrasting or opposing concepts, usually within parallel grammatical constructions (Gimranova et al., 2019). According to the authors, this syntactic

technique can be manifested in the form of two words or two groups of words that are contrasted for the purpose of strengthening the statement by emphasising positive and negative options and leading audiences to a preferred conclusion. Analysing the functions of antithesis in political discourse, Gimranova et al. (2019) highlights that there are diverse forms of opposition (i.e. 'friend-or-foe', "correct and incorrect', 'right and wrong', and others) that are implemented intentionally to frame issues, manipulate, and persuade the audience (e.g., *"Here buildings fell, and here a nation rose."* – taken from George Bush's pre-election speech)

- **Parallelism (parallel constructions)** – stylistic repetition of similar grammatical structures (words, phrases, clauses) to create rhythm, clarity, and emphasis (e.g., "*We will continue our economic progress. We'll reform our outdated tax code. We'll strengthen Social Security for the next generation. We'll make public schools all they can be…"* – the repetition of the same structure 'We will + verb + object - phrase, taken from George Bush's victory speech). According to Al-Ameedi & Mukhef (2017), a successive repetition of the clauses in political speeches is utilised to persuade and manipulate the listeners for particular aims of the campaign, agenda or policy.
- **Chiasmus (reversed parallelism)** – rhetorical device in which the grammatical structures of clauses or phrases are mirrored in reverse order (e.g., "*America's never been about what can be done for us; it's about what can be done by us together."* – the reversal here emphasises call to action over passive reception, taken from Barack Obama's victory speech). Chiasmus is a technique that is utilised rarer than parallelism in political discourse, however, it still has significant impacts on communication, including the emphasis on relationships or contrast between two ideas, and the creation of thought-provoking effect on a listener (Al-Ameedi & Mukhef, 2017).

- **Polysyndeton** – the deliberate use of repeated conjunctions in close succession (usually between several clauses or within one extended clause). Babayev (2024) states that this device serves a variety of functions, comprising the creation of emotionally - coloured effect or force, drawing attention to each item in a list and showing the scale of importance of what is being enumerated (e.g., "*...many Americans have fought for and died for come with responsibilities as well as rights, and among those are love and charity and duty and patriotism"*). In addition to that, polysyndeton influences the non-verbal aspect of communication, namely the pace of the speech, allowing the audience to carefully think about and concentrate on each of the elements (Babayev, 2024).
- **Asyndeton** – a kind of syntactical connection with the omission of conjunctions between elements (parts) of a sentence (e.g., "*We have taken back control of the Senate. The Senate races in Montana, Nevada, Texas, Ohio, Michigan, Wisconsin ... were all won by the MAGA movement."* – taken from Donald Trump's victory speech). Babayev (2024) elaborates on the peculiar use of asyndeton in political speeches as well, claiming that this technique is employed for different purposes, among which the most relevant in the context of political discourse are the acceleration of rhythm and pace of the speech, conveying excitement and urgency and the elimination of unnecessary words, sharpening the focus on the major points and making the message more direct.

The discussion of syntactical repetition provides a foundation for understanding how repetition shapes narrative techniques within political discourse. Building on this, the next part of the chapter focuses on phonetic repetition, which represent a distinct category of stylistic devices with their own characteristic features and expressive potential.

As Kemertelidze and Manjavidze (2013) explain that repetition can be manifested not only in the forms of words, phrases and clauses, but also sounds.

In such cases, repetition belongs to the category of phonetic stylistic devices that comprise two main types – alliteration and assonance. Despite the fact that some authors (Harris, 2017; Nizomova, 2021; et al.) associate these two tools with the literary techniques used primarily in poetry or other writings, the studies that focus on Political Discourse Theory by Dellagnelo et al. (2014) confirm that alliteration and assonance are not limited to written texts, they are useful tools in oral delivery, especially in those types of speeches, where memorability and emotional resonance are crucial.

Alliteration, according to Nizomova (2021), is a repetition of the same consonant sounds in a sequence of words or syllables (e.g., "*We are not a collection of red **s**ta**t**es and blue **st**a**t**es; we are the Uni**t**ed **St**ates of America"* – repetition of 's' and 't' sounds, taken from Barack Obama's victory speech). In political discourse, the cases of phonetic techniques implemented in speeches are mild and not very frequent, but in combination with other linguistic devices they fulfill their functions, adding musicality and rhythm, making the utterance more memorable.

Assonance, in contrast, is a repetition of the same vowel sounds within nearby words, especially in stressed syllables (Nizomova, 2021). This technique can be noticed in the identical grammatical structures (parallel constructions), accompanied with the repetition of the same sounds (e.g., "*I w**a**nt to thank you f**o**r y**ou**r hugs **o**n the r**o**pe l**i**nes. I w**a**nt to thank you f**o**r your prayers **o**n the r**o**pe l**i**nes. I w**a**nt to thank you f**o**r your kind w**o**rds **o**n the r**o**pe lines.*" – taken from Barack Obama's victory speech).

To summarise the overview of expressive means and stylistic devices, it is important to highlight that they all are essential attributes of political discourse, serving multiple communicative and pragmatic functions. First of all, both categories of features are employed for persuasive and emotional impacts, enhancing the speaker's ability to convince the audience by appealing to reason and common values (Lungu, 2020). For instance, metaphors and metonymies

frame complex political and cultural realities in accessible terms, focusing attention on selected aspects and obscuring others. Second of all, the use of culturally - loaded language (e.g., allusions, phraseological units, metaphors, etc.) helps evoke the feeling of the state's or presidency's proximity to the people (Liu & Guo, 2016). This is equal to manipulation of public opinion which helps to improve the speaker's credibility and authority. Third of all, memorability, rhythm, and emotional density are intensified with the use of various stylistic devices, such as repetition or parallelism, and expressive means, including ellipsis or inversion, which make speeches memorable and more structured and logical (Kuriata & Kasatkina-Kubyshkina, 2022). Overall, through the use of such tools political speakers construct identities and ideological policies that are aimed at particular social groups and are thus subjects of cultural and linguistic analysis.

Rhetorical strategies are another crucial and effective techniques in political communication. Their implementation helps political figures deliver compelling narratives and create a credible image that makes audiences feel confident in what they are listening to (Khajavi and Rasti, 2020). These classical rhetorical appeals, originally identified by Aristotle, continue to influence the ways of how politicians construct arguments, engage audiences, and impact public opinion (Raissouni, 2020). When it comes to the language functions that should be taken into account in political discourse, Khajavi and Rasti (2020) indicate that presidential candidates are expected to speak persuasively about their proposals and ideological perspectives in order to defeat their political rivals and gain the highest number of votes. This explains why politicians in general utilize persuasive rhetoric so frequently.

In accordance with Raissouni's work (2020), **ethos** refers to the credibility or ethical appeal of the speaker. It focuses on the trustworthiness and authority of the politician delivering the message. Ethos is established through the speaker's reputation, tone, demonstration of knowledge, and surely through

the use of language, which collectively build the audience's confidence in the speaker's reliability. For example, politicians often use a personal pronoun ("we") to create a sense of connection and responsibility, thereby enhancing their ethos.

The second strategy, **pathos**, is an emotional appeal aimed at influencing the audience's feelings and beliefs (Raissouni, 2020). It is most often used intentionally to trigger the listeners' empathy, pride, hope and other emotions to motivate action or agreement. In political discourse, pathos is also achieved through the combination of verbal (expressive means, stylistic devices and emotive language primarily) and non-verbal features. As an example, in his victory speech from the second term, Barack Obama employed a great number of personal examples and stories which served as powerful tools of evoking emotions beneficial for fostering intimacy with the public.

Moving to the next technique, **logos** refers to the logical appeal or reasoning in the utterance (Raissouni, 2020). It involves the use of facts, statistics, evidence and clear, coherent argumentation to persuade the audience through rationality (e.g., "We are now winning in Michigan, Arizona, Nevada and Alaska, which would result in us carrying at least three-hundred-and-fifteen electoral votes." – clear facts and statistics, provided by Donald Trump in his victory speech). In political speeches, logical appeals are implemented through the use of syntactical stylistic devices, since the construction of a logical and structured narrative is one of their main functions, and other figures of speech, such as allusions that can make strong references to historical and cultural events (e.g., "In four historic years, America has been given great tasks and faced them with strength and courage" – allusion to past achievements in George Bush's victory speech).

Last but not least, there is the fourth rhetorical strategy, also outlined in Aristotle's rhetoric theory and recognised as a separate technique that has a valuable impact especially in the sphere of public discourses, which is called

kairos. It is an 'opportune' moment which implies choosing a correct rhetorical device to match the communicative goal of the utterance and correspond to the appropriateness of the arguments within ongoing circumstances and a broader political or social environment (Mohamad et al., 2022). Within the context of political speeches, kairos is most frequently employed for the purpose of call to action function or to align the message with the audience's concerns and current political climate (e.g., "And I ask you to sustain that hope" referring to the request to sustain hope beyond election in Barack Obama's victory speech).

Finally, this chapter is to discuss **non-verbal features** of communication that are also examined in this study, as they are crucial elements accompanying the whole utterance and verbal peculiarities presented in it, the combination of which allows to obtain a comprehensive analysis of all peculiarities presented in political communication. Non-verbal communication is generally defined as the process of transmission of messages without words, involving both vocal and nonvocal cues (Hasanova, 2019). Vocal nonverbal elements, known as paralanguage, include tone, pitch, volume, rate of speech, and other voice qualities that add emotional emphasis to spoken words. As it has been stated earlier, these non-verbal elements can be considered expressive means, as they convey emotionality and highlight certain elements of the speech. Nonvocal elements, according to Hasanova (2019), include body language – gestures, facial expressions, posture, eye contact, and the use of personal space that also complement the utterance, reinforcing or sometimes contradicting verbal communication.

What is more, it is necessary to denote that different cultures interpret non-verbal signals differently (Zyubina, 2023). Non-verbal behaviors such as tone of voice and facial expressions can amplify emotional appeals in political speeches. Particular studies show that voters often rely more on non-verbal cues than verbal content when assessing candidates since they create an overall picture of the speaker. However, it is also crucial to note that nonverbal

behavior can reflect cultural biases that influence public attitudes toward different social categories. For instance, Zyubina (2023) indicates that certain groups may elicit more positive or negative nonverbal responses based on societal norms regarding race, gender or body type.

In conclusion, the provided theoretical base that outlines the features of linguistic and cultural approach to the analysis of political discourse represents a comprehensive overview of the devices that have strong emotional and persuasive power and are hence essential to be examined in detail to acquire an in-depth understanding of cultural and linguistic constituents inherent in a speaker. It has been found out that politicians use a variety of linguistic means to persuade the audience, resonate with cultural norms, thoughts and beliefs of the audience. By decoding the emotional density and cultural connotations, ingrained in political speeches, this study aims to reveal how exactly linguistic choices align with or challenge dominant cultural narratives, thereby shaping public opinion and legitimising leadership. All presented culturally-loaded linguistic tools are analysed through the prism of victory and pre-election political speeches of George Walker Bush, Barack Hussein Obama and Donald John Trump using linguistic and cultural framework in the practical part of the study.

Practical Part

2.1 Research Design

The overall effectiveness of the analysis performed and the clarity of the results obtained depend not only on the correct establishment of the research methods but also on the use of relevant procedures that minimise errors and enhance the validity and reliability of the findings (Nascimento & Steinbruch, 2019). This is especially important in studies that involve complex and multifaceted materials, where subtle linguistic and cultural elements must be

carefully examined. Based on that, this chapter is dedicated to revealing the selected research design, methods and analytical procedures within the framework of cultural and linguistic approach. Additionally, it is crucial to emphasise that the units of analysis in this study are political speeches, a factor that significantly influences the choice and application of particular methodological strategies.

To begin with, this study employs a mixed research design, integrating both qualitative and quantitative methods to conduct a linguistic and cultural analysis of political discourse, specifically focusing on the victory and pre-election speeches of Donald John Trump, Barack Hussein Obama, and George Walker Bush during their second presidential terms. Before substantiating the practical significance of using their synthesis, it is necessary to consider each research design separately.

Starting with a qualitative approach, Cropley (2021) argues that this method is based on the study of how people build on and use their life experiences to form ideas and messages. Additionally, qualitative methods focus on the subjective meanings and interpretations people assign to events, messages, or phenomena. The received narrative is further analysed from the point of view of behavioral sciences, and decoded in accordance with the provided context, allowing to decode the underlying intentions and cultural nuances inherent in the discourse. Abuhamda et al. (2021) highlight that qualitative research is also implemented in order to identify a certain logical connection or pattern in the ideas and opinions expressed by people on certain topics. One of the key purposes of this research design is to identify the linguistic motives and reasons for using a particular way of expressing an idea. Therefore, its main units of research are such data sources as interviews, speeches, open-ended questions in surveys or questionnaires, and text materials (e.g., transcribed oral utterances and documents).

On the contrary, the quantitative research design focuses on the systematic collection and analysis of numerical data derived from measurable phenomena (Cropley, 2021). This approach is used to represent a number of items presented in a dataset for their further analysis and comparison. Implementation of quantitative methods makes it possible to obtain the most reliable, visualised and clear measurable results that can be statistically validated without requiring extensive subjective interpretation. According to Abuhamda et al. (2021), once numerical data are gathered, they are organised into tables, graphs, or other visual formats to facilitate statistical examination that allows analysing particular changes or existing trends, as well as to establish credible results in accordance with them. Consequently, the primary data sources within this research method are quantitative surveys with closed-ended questions, and numerical tables or graphs.

Having an overall understanding of each research design separately, it is possible to consider the relevance of their synthesis in the context of linguistic and cultural approach implemented in this study. Firstly, the use of a qualitative approach is determined by the fact that the chosen research units for analysis are political speeches and the language used in them as a reflection of cultural heritage and background. Accordingly, it implies the study of the interconnection not only between culture and language, but also cognitive processes (mindsets of the speakers). Secondly, to accurately identify and compare the frequency and distribution of specific linguistic structures (e.g., expressive means of language, figures of speech, rhetorical appeals, etc.) and techniques (syntactical devices, narrative constructions, storytelling strategies, etc.) used by different political leaders across various speech types, it is necessary to quantify and visualise these features using graphs and tables. In the framework of linguistic and cultural analysis, this quantification is particularly useful, since it helps to provide objective and representative numerical indicators that can be carefully examined in terms of their functions and impacts

on the effectiveness of communication. Thirdly, the synthesis of two contrasting research designs makes it possible to conduct a thorough analysis and obtain comprehensive results aimed at addressing the existing research gap by examining and identifying the full range of linguistic features that convey specific cultural connotations in the selected political speeches, thereby providing a holistic understanding of the distinctive language characteristics in political discourse. To achieve the primary goal and answer the research questions of the study, regarding which culturally-loaded linguistic elements are employed in political discourse and the key functions they fulfill, the following analytical methods are to be utilised:

- **Critical Discourse analysis;**
- **Content analysis;**
- **Comparative analysis.**

First, the essence of critical discourse analysis is to be examined, outlining its implications for the given research. Critical Discourse Analysis (CDA) is a qualitative analytical approach that is aimed at revealing and analysing the language, ideology and power (Sharififar & Rahimi, 2015). That means that CDA is a method that is used to uncover the ways speakers utilise language to frame ideologies, power relations and dominance in the social and political contexts. This analytical method is especially useful for political speeches, as it reveals how politicians construct social realities, confirm their authority, and influence public opinion through language (Fairclough & Fairclough, 2012). From this perspective, this approach relates to the study of discourse events and discourse practice, which includes the production, distribution, and consumption of texts or speeches by the audience. Norman Fairclough's core works on the application of CDA to text analysis influenced a further development of the theory that implies that the language used in public domains (political addresses, media communication, advertisement, etc.) always integrates hidden expressions of power and dominance. Furthermore, according

to these works, application of CDA in political discourse analysis includes the examination of social, political and cultural backgrounds of the speakers that are essential to be taken into account when explaining their linguistic choices and the contexts behind them. In this regard, Fairclough's approach is highly intertwined with the linguistic and cultural analytical method and complement it by fulfilling the function of decoding the subtle linguistic strategies through which cultural values and political ideologies are transmitted in the selected presidential speeches, relying on the thorough study of the presidents' backgrounds. In addition, it is used to identify other functions of the found techniques, influencing the perception of the overall message including persuasion and intensification of the emotional impact of the utterances.

Next, after the identification of the linguistic units that have certain cultural connotations and emotive power, content analysis is to be applied. It is a systematic quantitative and qualitative method used to identify, categorise, and quantify specific elements within texts (Talhadas et al., 2016). This technique involves transferring textual data into predefined categories to detect patterns, frequencies, and thematic trends, providing empirical evidence to support qualitative data. Therefore, content analysis is employed in this research in order to carry out the analysis and measurement of the linguo-cultural content of the speeches, which is manifested in how often particular manipulative linguistic devices, socio-cultural contexts, or cultural references appear in speeches. It is a crucial step of the practical analysis, without which it would not be possible to acquire representative visualisations (in the form of tables and graphs), which facilitate the comparison of linguistic peculiarities across different political leaders and types of speeches. Hence, content analysis supports the mixed-methods design of this study by offering objective data that complement the results gained based on CDA.

Finally, comparative analysis that is to be conducted using the tools of the above mentioned analytical methods is to be discussed. It is a method that is

implemented in order to compare and contrast different analysed units within each subgroup, according to the selected criteria and parameters (Bolbakov et al., 2020). Within the framework of political discourse, this method gives an opportunity to compare speeches by different political figures or across different time periods, thereby identifying diverse or shared linguistic patterns. In the context of this paper, the comparison is to be made upon the following parameters:

1. **Each speaker's linguistic choices, influenced by a unique cultural background.** This criterion for comparison is essential for the accomplishment of the main goals of the study. It is due to the fact that, based on the principles of linguistic and cultural approach, the social, political, and cultural background of the speaker defines and impacts the way a person utilises language as a tool of persuasion, manipulation, and emotional influence. Thus, it is methodologically grained that each of the presidents have their own unique socio-cultural backgrounds that have influenced their mindsets, as well as the language and rhetoric they utilise. This contrast allows the given research to identify how the differences acquired through personal experiences impact lexical choices, narrative techniques and persuasive appeals.
2. **Communicative situation and goal of the utterance**. The importance of this criterion lies in the fact that the selected units for analysis represent two different communicative situations, in particular, victory and election speeches. These two types of presidential addresses have their own distinctive features and communicative goals that in many ways define the choice of linguistic tools and rhetorical strategies employed. Thus, the practical part of the study aims to characterise the differences and similarities of the devices employed within two various kinds of speeches to identify whether culturally-specific units vary depending on the communicative goal, as well as to understand what cultural values,

societal attitudes, political and economic issues are transmitted within each of them.

Overall, the comparative method with the parameters identified is an indispensable tool of this study's analysis. Its importance lies in the fact that the linguistic and cultural paradigm, through which the speeches are examined, puts forward a fundamental theory that discourse cannot be separated from the speaker's socio-cultural peculiarities, making it important to contrast the speeches of three influential political discourse within the research that captures not only one but several representatives of diverse backgrounds.

As for the data preparation procedures used in the research, they mainly involve the selection of the speeches (which is described in-detail in part 2.2) and the transcription process. The latter is required as the primary data consisting of video recordings of the presidents' victory and pre-election speeches needs to be transferred to a textual format. This process follows a standard transcription approach. It is important to point out that a full-encompassing representation of non-verbal features requires the implementation of a different approach to transcribing speeches, namely, prosodic transcription type that is oriented particularly to the thorough study of phonological aspects of communication. However, due to the fact that this study focuses and puts the major emphasis on the use of culturally-loaded linguistic items, the practical analysis in conducted taking into account the peculiarities of intonation and pausing patterns only where relevant to outline the emotional and manipulative power of the messages conveyed by the combination of verbal and non-verbal cues (e.g., in such cases, when the particular lexical or syntax devices are used with explicit intonation without which they would not impact the perception that much). A more full-fledged analysis of the influence of phonological devices on persuasiveness of political communication is to be carried out as part of further research.

Last but not least, this part outlines the analytical procedures that are employed. In this research, a combination of qualitative and quantitative analytical procedures is implemented to ensure a comprehensive examination of political speeches within the linguistic and cultural framework. Firstly, qualitative procedures primarily imply the use of Critical Discourse Analysis that comprises a detailed, context-sensitive examination of the speeches aiming to find the techniques (stylistic devices, expressive means, cultural references, etc.) to reveal hidden meanings, ideological positions, and cultural implications transmitted through language. This step includes close reading of the texts to identify key themes, rhetorical strategies, and narrative structures. Secondly, qualitative content analysis is used to classify the types and relationships between the identified elements, focusing on how various kinds of one device influence the discourse in certain ways.

In parallel, quantitative procedures are utilised to make the tables with the categories of devices found, their types, number of occurrences and examples (see Appendix). After that, graphical visualisations in the form of pie charts are to be constructed in order to accurately depict the frequency and distribution of the specific linguistic and rhetorical features (e.g., metaphors, allusions, syntactic constructions) across the speeches. Finally, a qualitative comparison of the features is to be carried out on the basis of the visualised representative components and parameters outlined earlier in this section.

To sum up, the integration of the mixed research design with the chosen methods and identified analytical procedures guarantees the reliability and effectiveness of the results obtained based on the practical analysis. It is also important to state that the choice of the methods is closely interconnected with the needs and principles of the linguistic and cultural approach, which complement and not contradict each other.

2.2 Sampling

Having created a comprehensive theoretical base and identified the methods of analysis that are to be used in order to study the units of political discourse, it becomes possible to proceed to the establishment and description of sampling methods.

To begin with, it is necessary to identify that in order to obtain the most representative base for the analysis, in this paper, the types of speeches to be studied and the political figures who delivered them have the same sampling method, but different criteria. The stratified sampling is implemented. According to Jain & Shukla (2025), the use of this particular approach is traditionally determined by the necessity to improve the accuracy of evaluating sample units.

According to Parsons (2017), within the framework of the stratified sampling method, the main unit is divided into subgroups (blocks). Each such block consists of elements that correspond to it and have common characteristics. It is important to note that all the subgroups present clear differences from each other, but at the same time they belong to the same concept – the main divisional unit. Further, in accordance with the established criteria, a sample of suitable items is formed. The number of selected units is not pre-determined and depends entirely on meeting certain criteria. For this reason, not all blocks can be taken into account. The relevance of the stratified sampling method for use in this paper is also emphasized by Jain & Shukla (2025), who claim that it has wide application in humanitarian and political studies.

Starting to form a sample, it is necessary to identify criteria for determining the political leaders whose speeches are to be chosen and then analyzed. Compliance with the following characteristics is mandatory:

- **The president delivered speeches in the 21st century in the USA;**

The presence of this criterion is due to the need for research to meet the scientific interests formed in the current century. Further, the choice of political leaders who present their speeches precisely within the framework of their activities in the United States is determined by the fact that the culture of this country has historically been influenced by other nations (Eller, 2015). This process of mixing continues nowadays, which is often reflected in political discourse. Thus, the cultural background of the country's citizens is diverse, which affects the use of certain language structures.

- **The president held this position for two terms.**

The presence of this criterion is due to the fact that speeches presented in the second presidential race, and then in the presentation of the victory speech (during the second presidential term), traditionally have a greater number of cultural references (allusions) and culturally-loaded linguistic features. This aspect meets the goals set within the framework of this research.

Moreover, since this study focuses primarily on presidential speeches from the entire concept of political discourse, the overall sample includes only items from the blocks of this subtype (see Appendix). Namely, these are debates, pre-election, campaign, victory, concession, and policy speeches. The criteria for sampling political speeches are based not only on an established theoretical framework, but also on preliminary analysis. Within the framework of the latter, a comprehensive study of the transcribed text was performed, highlighting culturally-loaded linguistic units, rhetorical strategies, as well as expressive means. Based on this, generalized conclusions were made, tendencies were identified, and primary information was obtained. Thus, the units to be studied must necessarily have the following characteristics in order for the sample to be diverse and representative:

- **The presence of a significant number of culturally-loaded units and cultural references;**

The presence of this criterion is due to the fact that even though the main purpose of all speeches within the framework of political discourse is persuading and manipulating the audience, some of the types of presidential speeches do not have a wide number of culturally significant items (for example, policy speeches). It is also crucial to note that the presence of the above-mentioned criterion is determined on the basis of the preliminary analysis, the ideological structure of which is described above. Moreover, by highlighting the importance of cultural aspects in speeches, a correct sample is formed and is aimed at meeting the identified goals of the study.

- **The presence of emotional density in speech.**

The presence of this criterion is due to the fact that, despite the manipulative nature of speeches in political discourse, the level of emotional load can vary. Therefore, based on the established theoretical framework, as well as the preliminary analysis, it is possible to make a selection of those types of presidential speeches that have the highest emotional density. The latter is represented in presidential speeches with the use of verbal and non-verbal methods. However, the implementation of specific means is defined by the influence of the speaker's cultural background.

The criteria established for political leaders whose speeches are to be included in the sample and analyzed are met by three US presidents who have served two terms in the 21st century. Namely, these are George Walker Bush (George W. Bush – 2001-2005, 2005-2009), Barack Hussein Obama (Barack Obama – 2009-2013, 2013-2017) and Donald John Trump (Donald Trump - 2017-2021, 2025 - present moment). Further, there are two main types of speeches that correspond to the established criteria and that are to be added to the sample. Namely, the pre-election and victory speeches delivered during the

second presidential term of each of the political leaders and the corresponding pre-election races.

Overall, the established criteria and the sample obtained on their basis are aimed at receiving the most representative results, which can be used to create correct and relevant conclusions for the field. Moreover, they also aim to answer the identified research questions and gaps in existing research.

2.3 Content Analysis.

Pre-election speech by Georger W. Bush (2004).

- **Historical context:**

George W. Bush began his first presidential term in 2001, becoming the 43rd President of the United States. During the 4 years when he held this post, many events took place in the country that affected the economic and social well-being of the USA. Further, it all was reflected in the pre-election campaign in 2004. Namely, the terrorist attack in New York on September 9, 2001; the beginning of the anti-terrorist campaign and the start of military operations (wars) using American troops in Iraq and Afghanistan; the first signs of the beginning of the economic crisis in the country; the lack of social programs that would support citizens; the establishment of new political ties with countries such as Russia; disputes in the country over tax codes and the overall promotion of traditional values (rejection of LGBT movements) and the importance of family.

- **Topics emphasised in the message (speech):**

First and foremost, it is important to highlight that the choice of the main topics that are covered and put special emphasis on in the given speech are greatly influenced by the communicative situation and goals, as well as by cultural, social, and political events described above. As for the communicative situation, it is a highly formal, ceremonial political speech, transmitted in front

of the Republican National Convention. The style of the speech totally corresponds to the requirements and characteristic features of such communicative situations. The register is formal and authoritative, marked by numerous references to national values and collective achievements.

Regarding the communicative goals of this utterance, they include, first of all, persuasion for re-election by enumerating multiple accomplishments. Thus, one of the main messages highlighted by the president are the achievements reached during his first term, involving the topic of economic growth, Education and Health reform.

Second of all, the utterance aimed at presenting future policies in order to convince the audience of the benefits of the campaign. For this purpose, George Bush enumerated his principles (conservative values, faith, liberty, and family) and plans for the next four years, which comprise economic recovery (a better tax code, more career opportunities, free qualification traineeships, and others), energy independence, advancements in the systems of Health, Education (including the problem with racial discrimination in school and university education), and Social Security. These themes are framed throughout the speech to remind the listeners of the principled agendas for the next term.

Third of all, the communicative goals have indeed been impacted by the events happening in the country at that moment. Therefore, a special emphasis in the speech is put on the September 11th terrorist attack, the War on Terror in the Middle East, the invasions of Afghanistan and Iraq that are also repeated throughout the speech. Last but not least, another vivid topic of the speech is the contrast between his and opponent's policies, manifested in the critiques of John Kerry's agenda.

- **Cultural references and culturally-loaded linguistic units:**

The first aspect to consider is cultural references, which can also be addressed as **allusions.** In the pre-election speech of President George W. Bush,

their use is vivid and frequent, mentioning both recent events in the history of the United States and fundamental changes in various realms (i.e. economic, political, and social), as well as campaign policies of the president aimed at the development of the country.

The most common implementation of such a stylistic device in speech is due to the need to reinforce key aspects of a politician's pre-election campaign, frame ideologies, and establish a certain emotional connection with the audience. These purposes are achieved by referencing relevant historical situations, shared knowledge, famous slogans and other culture-specific concepts that emphasise the unity and represent the country as a whole.

In addition, cultural references, or allusions, serve the functions of manipulating public opinion and intensifying the emotional density of the speech, since they evoke familiar stories and situations that resonate with the audience's values and knowledge, thus influencing how people perceive issues or policies without explicitly stating them. It is crucial to emphasise that allusions have exceptional impact on the overall cultural load of the utterance, as they always align with accepted traditions or ideals, cultural symbols and familiar narratives that require shared knowledge to be decoded and perceived in a right way. Hence, allusions and other culture-specific linguistic units constitute a separate part of the content analysis within the framework of the linguistic and cultural approach in this research.

Some of the most striking examples of the use of this stylistic device in George W. Bush's pre-election speech in accordance with the topics emphasised are the following:

1. **The achievements of the first presidential term:**

- *"Now, because we have made, the hard journey, we can see the valley below";*

- *"Because we acted, children are making sustained progress in reading and math, America's schools are getting better, and nothing will hold us back";*
- *"I brought Republicans and Democrats together to strengthen Medicare. Now seniors are getting immediate help buying medicine"*

These are references to the accomplishments that George Bush and his Republican party have attained during his first term. The achievements in the domains of Health and education are alluded to and showcasted to justify him being elected for the second term and frame the idea of the significance of the results achieved.

2. **Underlying values and principles:**

- *"Our society rests on a foundation of responsibility and character and family commitment";*
- *Because family and work are sources of stability and dignity, I support welfare reform that strengthens family and requires work";*
- *"I believe in the transformational power of liberty: the wisest use of American strength is to advance freedom."*

In his speech, George Bush employs multiple allusions to the core American and his personal traditional values. The most notable of them comprise the ideals of freedom and liberty, family and duty commitment, faith and responsibility that appeal primarily to conservative voters and help establish a reliable image a future leader should have.

3. **Main policies of his election campaign:**

- *"We will make our country less dependent on foreign sources of energy…";*
- *"In a new term, I will lead a bipartisan effort to reform and simplify the federal tax code";*
- *"In northeast Georgia, Gainesville Elementary School is mostly Hispanic and 90 percent poor… We will leave no child behind."*

The provided examples demonstrate the deliberate use of references to the existing social and economic problems that negatively impact the living conditions of the citizens and require solutions promised by the president. In these cases, the significance of the policies is intentionally emphasised by alluding to the problem of the increased inflation and tax rates, influenced by the rising oil prices (partly linked to Iraq War instability) and a weakening dollar, the problems which require special knowledge of the country's economic indicators that helps to enhance the effect produced on the audience. In addition, the third example is not just a reference to the crisis and underfunding in Hispanic education, but also an allusion to a 'No Child Left Behind Act' that plays a role of a strong emotional and manipulative appeal in the overall passage related to the proposed Education reform.

4. **The September 11th terrorist attack:**

- *"And we know that September 11th requires our country to think differently…";*
- *"I stood where Americans died, in the ruins of the Twin Towers.";*
- *"Do I forget the lessons of September 11th and take the word of a madman…?"*

This topic stands out among other allusions to the events happening in the country and is hence pointed out as a separate category. It was especially important for George Bush to reference this terrific attack, since it happened during his first presidential term. The allusions to this tragedy appear throughout the speech and are frequently implemented to convey the idea of bravery and unity of Americans and inspire hope. He frames the last four years as a period of immense challenge and asserts that the country has become stronger and more powerful. The theme of security, both at home and abroad, is central, and these references help highlight Bush's desire to protect the people.

5. **Other historical events:**

- *"... the murderous regimes of Saddam Hussein and the Taliban are history…";*
- *"In Afghanistan, terrorists have done everything they can to intimidate people yet more than 10 million citizens have registered to vote in the October presidential election…" ;*
- *"Reformers, and political prisoners, and exiles will hear the message that their dream of freedom cannot be denied forever."*

Overall, a great number of extracts from the speech contains references to the notorious regimes of Saddam Hussein's government in Iraq and the Taliban regime in Afghanistan. By declaring these regimes "history," Bush frames the U.S. military interventions as successful and justified (mainly those emerging during his first term), reinforcing the concept of America being a liberator. The second example refers to the first democratic presidential election in Afghanistan (October 2004) and is used intentionally as an evidence to his statement, showing that U.S. actions have brought tangible progress and hope, not just regime change. Final statement once again alludes to the problems with the restriction of certain rights and freedom as a central value that he as a future leader protects and can guarantee to the citizens, framing the idea of his beneficial policies that correspond to the needs of the society.

Next, the linguistic and cultural analysis of George W. Bush' pre-election speech has also revealed the occurrence of other culturally-loaded linguistic units that reflect the overall linguo-cultural image of the speaker. As it has been already established in the theoretical part of the study (see section 1.3), a culture-specific unit refers to a word, phrase, or other linguistic expression that carries particular cultural connotations, meanings, or associations unique to a particular language community and culture.

Firstly, **phraseological units** that fall into that category are to be outlined, since their meanings often go beyond the literal meaning and are formed under the influence of the cultural, historical, and communicative contexts within a

certain language. The given speech contains a quite high number of set expressions, the main role of which in the framework of political discourse is to resonate with the audiences by utilising familiar phrases and notions. Further, some of the peculiar examples of phraseological units utilised in the speech are presented and commented on:

- "We have seen a shaken economy rise to its feet";
- "... because the lives of our citizens are at stake";
- "This will not happen on my watch."

These examples demonstrate the use of fixed expressions the meanings of which cannot be fully deduced without special knowledge. Utilising these devices, George Bush covers ideas succinctly and more vividly with emotional and evaluative connotations. In general phraseological units help to frame issues in ways that align with the political agenda, subtly shaping public opinion and guiding the audience's interpretation of events or policies. Regarding the influence on the perception of the message, the evaluative component of the fixed expressions employed in the formal discourse can reinforce emotional impact, thus manipulating audience attitudes.

Secondly, another crucial aspect that encompasses culture-specific elements is a **conceptual metaphor**. This type of metaphor is distinguished by its connection with the environment and context in which it is utilised. It is used in political speeches to make abstract or complex concepts become more concrete or visualised, making them easier for audiences to grasp and memorise. The examples of their use in the analysed pre-election speech include:

- *"And we have seen Americans in uniform storming mountain strongholds and charging through sandstorms";*
- *"We will extend the frontiers of freedom";*
- *"The story of America is the story of expanding liberty: an ever-widening circle, constantly growing to reach further and include more."*

By framing military action as "storming strongholds" and "charging through sandstorms" or "freedom as an expanding frontier," metaphors manipulate public opinion by figuratively describing policies as relevant, necessary, and aligned with national ideals. These examples represent culture-specific meanings that require either the knowledge of history or core ideologies of the president's campaigns.

Thirdly, the analysis of the speech has shown that the president utilised not only the devices that always embody cultural connotations (e.g., as allusion and phraseological units), but other stylistic means through which some of the references or concepts have been transmitted. For example, some instances when **personification** that contains the hidden narrative has been detected:

- *"We saw tragedy arrive on a quiet morning…";*
- *"...the bravery of rescuers grow with danger";*
- . *"... because ownership brings security, and dignity…"*

Most personifications in the speech are utilised by George Bush to express major cultural values that are framed and alluded throughout within his message. Additionally, some of them strongly align with Bush's rhetorical style, especially his emphasis on faith, patriotism, dignity, and America's global mission of 'expanding liberty'.

Further on, the theoretical overview of the culturally-loaded linguistic features in political discourse (see Section 1.4) has established that **metonymy, and its special cases (i.e. synecdoche and antonomasia)** can also denote specific connotations that need to be identified to be comprehended right. The following curious examples have been detected:

- *"And we have seen Americans in uniform storming mountain strongholds…";*
- *"That young man is right - our men and women in uniform are doing a superb job for America";*

- *"... and for that we can all thank the white-haired lady sitting right up there."*

As the statements above show, metonymy and its subtypes can be culture-specific because the associations they rely on depend on shared knowledge of institutions, symbols, famous people, and other factors. The first two examples evoke a particular image of the military forces with a uniform as their distinctive feature that is intertwined with America's cultural and national identity. Most importantly, Bush employs the notions of 'men and women in uniform' and other military-related terms (e.g., "I serve America"; "I serve the American people"), as this topic is highly interrelated with his cultural background, in particular his experience in the the Texas Air National Guard and position as a military pilot. Concerning the last example, it is antonomasia with the use of which the president refers to his mother, without clarifying that explicitly in the speech. Thus, this description greatly depends on the context without which the address is difficult to understand.

The first Bush's presidential term is characterised by his extensive attempts to recover economic indicators of the country, including his Economic Growth and Tax Relief Reconciliation Act of 2001 and Jobs and Growth Tax Relief Reconciliation Act of 2003. Therefore, in his speech for the re-election for the second time, the president used a variety of devices besides allusion to highlight his intentions to continue the fruitful work on the development of the country's economy. For example, the speech is marked by quite a high number of **hyperboles** that contain references to his future policies and are used to intensify their significance. The following examples demonstrate such an implementation:

- *"... one of the most dramatic economic shifts our society has seen";*
- *"I will ensure each and every poor county in America has...";*

- *"We're providing a record level of funding in the history of America."*

The hyperboles identified in Bush's speech serve a clear rhetorical purpose. They enhance the perceived impact and ambitions of his economic agenda, strengthening his appeal to voters. For instance, the use of "each and every poor county" employs an absolute qualifier, while the phrase "the most dramatic economic shifts our society has seen" consists of both the exaggeration in the form of superlative degree of comparison with an emotive by its nature adjective, and the verbal phrase that intensifies the overall meaning. In the paradigm of this speech, this device is aimed at convincing the audience of an 'unprecedented' support that George Bush, as a future leader, proposes to the citizens.

Finally, this part of the content analysis sheds light on the use of **irony** that has frequently occurred in Bush's speech. The main functions that this device performs in political communication are the emotional engagement of the audience and the manipulation of the public views in many ways, including an indirect delivery of criticism or debate, and interpretation of the implied meanings transmitted in a more informal, ironic tone. Some of the examples of such instances that contain clear underlying cultural connotations include:

- *"Again, my opponent takes a different approach. In the midst of war, he has called America's allies, quote, a "coalition of the coerced and the bribed." That would be nations like Great Britain, Poland,…, and others allies that deserve the respect of all Americans, not the scorn of a politician.";*
- *"Then he said he was "proud" of that vote. Then, when pressed, he said it was a "complicated" matter. There is nothing complicated about supporting our troops in combat.";*
- *"In the last four years, you and I have come to know each other… You may have noticed I have a few flaws, too. People sometimes have to*

correct my English. I knew I had a problem when Arnold Schwarzenegger started doing it."

Having a thorough understanding of the contexts in which irony has been utilised in the above mentioned examples, as well as the knowledge of the background of the speaker, it is possible to conclude that these examples are indeed culturally-loaded. The first two uses are cases of critical irony, in which George Bush highlights the opponent's disrespectful remarks and actions towards the U.S allies, contrasting them with the respect Bush believes they deserve. Furthermore, these implementations of the device also align with the president's military past and frame his political emphasis on lasting military support.

As for the last example, it showcases a self-deprecating irony that echoes the president's personal history, in particular, his Texas accent and the instances of using the informal speaking style. By ironically speaking about these "flaws," he humanises himself, builds a closer connection with the audience. In addition to that, the reference to Arnold Schwarzenegger, a former Republican and current celebrity, adds a culturally-specific aspect familiar to American audiences, especially in the early 2000s political environment.

- **Emotional density of the speech:**

Rhetorical strategies (pathos, logos, ethos, and kairos) are powerful linguistic tools used for emotional impact, as well as persuasion and proof of the correctness of the idea that is being broadcasted to the audience. In his pre-election speech, George W. Bush makes extensive use of only one of three key aspects, namely pathos. This may be due to the connection between emotional addressing and the use of cultural references, in other words, allusions. It is important to note that sometimes this technique can be implemented not only in separate sentences, but also in paragraphs as a whole. The latter can occur in George Bush's pre-election speech in two cases:

- when the President describes the personal story of a citizen of the country;
- when the President uses an extended description of cultural and historical events.

Proper use of **pathos** in political discourse is related to speech etiquette and the manipulation strategy built by the speaker. Namely, that excessive emotionality can lead to a backlash from the audience - disgust and rejection.

To begin with, the use of pathos in individual sentences, and what kind of emotional load it conveys is being considered:

- *"To stand with workers in poor communities and those that have lost manufacturing, textile, and other jobs we will create American opportunity zones…"*

In this example, George W. Bush uses emotional impact tactics by mentioning the difficult situation of certain groups of people, namely workers in poor communities and those who lost their jobs due to the economic crisis in the country. In addition, it is crucial to take into account that such addressing to citizens is combined with the idea of the importance of support by maintaining certain decisions and measures. This sentence conveys a positive attitude and ideology of cooperation, regardless of social status.

- *"...I will never relent in defending America whatever it takes."*

In this example, George W. Bush uses a different tactic of emotional impact, talking not about the citizens of the country, but about the sacrifices he is willing to make to protect the United States. In addition, the presence of an intensifier "never" in the sentence, as well as an idiom in the sense of complete dedication, fully affects the emotional perception of the transmitted idea. This sentence reflects the general attitude about the seriousness of the approach to problem solving and the desire to take all possible measures to protect the country.

- *"These changing times can be exciting times of expanded opportunity. And here, you face a choice. My opponent's policies are dramatically different from ours…"*

In this example, George W. Bush uses emotional influence tactics by describing the best prospect for the country's citizens, which can only be achieved if he becomes president. In addition, the presence of an intensifier "dramatically" emphasizes the polarity of the possible future, which also has a significant effect on the audience. It is also crucial to identify that the President establishes that these are the citizens who have to make this choice, and he only offers those most cherished opportunities. This sentence describes two possible ways for countries to develop in the future, emphasizing the positivity and success of only one of them, which emotionally attracts attention.

Before considering other devices, it is important to establish that mostly rhetorical strategies perform the function of provoking emotion to one degree or another. However, they vary from the communicative goal and and traditionally relate to various manifestations of feelings, such as authority, pity, reliability, and others. There are also those that do not have a strong connection with emotional aspects. but rather have a manipulative nature. Nevertheless, all of them are aimed at achieving the identified communicative goals. Based on this idea, it is possible to move on to the next rhetorical strategy to be analyzed in George W. Bush's election speech is **ethos.** This tool is used to create trust relations between the speaker and the audience, in other words, a call for credibility and authority. The most representative examples of this method of establishing an emotional connection are the following:

- *"I believe we have a moral responsibility to honor America's seniors so I brought Republicans and Democrats together to strengthen Medicare."*

In this example, George W. Bush uses the tactic of creating an emotional connection by mentioning responsibility to certain social groups, as well as ethical and ideological obligations to the entire nation. It is interesting to note

that the president is not talking about his duties caused by the position, but about the fact that it is shared by all citizens of the country. Nevertheless, George W. Bush is the only one who makes the final. In addition, the organisation of joint participation of two opposition parties in solving problems the subsequent mention of this increases the speaker's authority among the audience. The sentence aims to establish an emotional bond between the President and the listeners by using a sense of trustworthiness.

- *"In a new term, I will ensure every poor county in America has a community or rural health center."*

In this example, George W. Bush uses a slightly different tactic of creating an emotional connection, mentioning not national responsibility, but his personal obligations to the people. It is interesting to note that even just considering the problems of not even the middle class, but poor areas that do not even have all the basic necessities helps to establish a connection with ordinary citizens based on the manifestation of competencies and expertise. This sentence has a strong emotional impact, which is based on the President's expression of his authoritative attention to the lives of ordinary people.

- *"To create jobs, my plan will encourage investment and expansion by restraining federal spending, reducing regulation, and making tax relief permanent."*

In this example, George W. Bush uses the same tactic to create an emotional connection, mentioning his personal commitment to the people and his desire to improve their lives. It is interesting to note that this time the President describes in a broader format what measures he will take to address the shortage of jobs. However, the speaker does not identify the reason for such a problem to exist. Moreover, George Bush constantly touches on topics of national interest such as taxes and investments in society, which predisposes him to citizens, creating a feeling that he can control it. The sentence sets a very emotional burden

between the president and various segments of society, which is based on a sense of control by a representative of the government.

The third rhetorical strategy to study in the framework of the 43rd US president's pre-election speech is **logos.** This tool also creates a specific emotional correlation, but with the use of statistical data, facts, and strong semantic arguments. What is more, the deliberate use of logos can be determined by the manipulative tactics of transmitting information and influencing the audience by the President The most representative examples of its implementation by the speaker are the following:

- *"And most of those workers were men."*

In this example, George W. Bush uses the tactic of mentioning historical facts. It is interesting to note that the President does not provide specific numerical data, but speaks using generalization. However, this does not remove the manipulative nature of using this device. The sentence aims to add persuasiveness to the speech for further impact on listeners.

- *"Today, workers change jobs, even careers, many times during their lives, and in one of the most dramatic shifts our society has seen, two-thirds of all Moms also work outside the home."*

In this example, George W. Bush uses a different tactic, namely the presentation of statistical data. In addition, the President mentions the topic of the traditional social roles of women and men in the family, which, combined with the peculiar demonstration of the results of statistical analysis, have a greater impact on the audience. This synthesis also helps to navigate the interpretation of the transmitted information in such a way that the speaker can further influence the perception of other messages. The sentence, using statistical data, makes the speech more credible for the audience to perceive, which is used by the speaker in achieving the set results.

- *"Gainesville Elementary School is mostly Hispanic and 90 percent poor, and this year 90 percent of its students passed state tests in reading and math."*

In this example, George W. Bush uses the same statistical tactics, but in the format of intentionally mentioning percentage data. The President also once again touches on topics relevant to ordinary citizens, namely the level of education of non-indigenous people in poor areas. In addition, statistical data is presented to the listener from two related topics at once - the origin of children in impoverished schools in percentage, as well as the number of the same students who successfully passed certain exams. The sentenceis aimed not only at using statistical data to achieve manipulative goals identified by the speaker, but also at establishing an emotional connection with the audience by describing the problems and issues of concern to citizens.

The last rhetorical strategy that is often considered to be a separate technique is **kairos.** Its essence lies in properly determining the time, situational context, and audience's desires to correctly convey the message with the highest degree of manipulation. Despite the fact that this tool is very useful for influencing a wide audience, its use is not widespread in George W. Bush's pre-election speech. Based on this, the following examples can be highlighted:

- *"The freedom of many, and the future security of our Nation, now depend on us. And tonight, my fellow Americans, I ask you to stand with me."*

In this example, George W. Bush uses an interesting manipulative tactic, first covering the topics of freedom and security that are relevant to US citizens, and then claiming that everything depends not on him as president, but on every representative of this nation. Only after that, the speaker proceeds to convey the message he needs - vote for him in the presidential election. The sentence is formed according to kairos key principles: time, situational context, and audience opinion are taken into account. Moreover, it can be fully considered as convincing and influencing the listeners, and has a call to action.

- *"We must, and we will, confront threats to America before it is too late."*

In this example, George W. Bush uses another manipulative tactic, namely, drawing a parallel between what the nation needs to do and convincing the audience that its realisation is a part of his plans. Moreover, emphasizing the lack of time for decision-making enhances the effect. This synthesis leads the speaker to not only influencing listeners, but also predisposing them to further messages transmition. The sentence, using kairos, is not only a call to make certain decisions, but rather serves as a predisposition of the audience for further speech perception.

- *"I believe this Nation wants steady, consistent, principled leadership and that is why, with your help, we will win this election."*

In this example, George W. Bush uses another manipulative tactic, which involves mentioning the beliefs that thy Зpresident has about fellow Americans, and only then revealing the essence of what he wants. Moreover, a certain "acting" based on the wishes of local citizens, presented in the form of an enumeration, also creates a certain context and mood for the full disclosure of manipulative influence. The sentence predisposes the listener, and then broadcasts the speaker's desired idea, namely winning the presidential race.

Due to the fact that **victory speeches** are traditionally structured as an ideological and semantic continuation of themes, ideas and messages conveyed during pre-election campaigns, in the analysis, a separate consideration of the use of certain structures or strategies within this type of speech is to be made only if they represent a methodology or tactic that were not previously considered in other units.

Victory speech by George W. Bush (2004).

- **Topics emphasised in the message (speech):**

In the victory speech, George W. Bush creates a clear ideological connection with his pre-election speech and with the problems in the country that were identified during the political campaign and what measures could be taken to solve them. This justifies a large number of cultural references (allusions) not only to historical events related to the United States, but also to the ideas put forward in previously presented speeches. Based on all of the above-mentioned facts, the following topics can be identified as key to George W. Bush's victory speech:

1. Achievements and results of the pre-election campaign;
2. Gratitude to the family, the party and the citizens;
3. A promising new future for the country;
4. How the achievement of the citizens influenced the development of the country.

Throughout George W. Bush's speech, regardless of the topic, the importance of citizens of all ages and backgrounds for the existence, development and strengthening of the United States is emphasised. This choice of topics from the pre-election speech to be mentioned in the victory one may be due to the need to strengthen the national spirit after the tragic events of September 9, 2001. Thus, the disclosure of future plans for the country with a focus on the memory of the victims fully conveys the importance and relevance of using emotions as a method of manipulation.

- **Cultural references and culturally-loaded linguistic units:**

In his speech, George W. Bush uses a large number of culturally-loaded linguistic units that make the speech more emotional and manipulative. The speaker used cultural references (allusions) as the main means of conveying culturally specific ideologies, the implementation of which is conditioned by the need to reflect the needs of the audience. The following examples can be mentioned:

1. **Cultural references:**

- *"We'll reform our outdated tax code."*
- *"We will uphold our deepest values of family and faith."*
- *"Our military has brought justice to the enemy…"*

2. **Phraseological units:**

- *"Do not pray for tasks equal to your powers; pray for powers equal to your tasks"*
- *"...the vigor of this economy."*

3. **Metonymy:**

- *"I want to thank you for your prayers on the rope lines"*
- *"... for your kind words on the rope lines"*
- *'The vice president serves America…"*

4. **Hyperbole**

- *" Our nation served the freedom of all mankind"*
- *"We'll make public schools all they can be"*
- *"The voters turned out in record numbers and delivered an historic victory"*

- **Emotional density of the speech:**

George W. Bush makes extensive use of rhetorical strategies in his victory speech. This applies to both the main devices (namely, pathos, ethos and logos) and the additional one, which is kairos. Interestingly, the president often uses cultural references to create emotional density. In addition, when comparing the tactics used in the pre-election and victory speeches, it is possible to identify the interconnection between them. In some cases, the speaker even used identical lexical structures.

The first rhetorical strategy to be analyzed is **pathos**, which is traditionally used to create a certain connection between the speaker and the

audience. The most practically significant examples within the framework of George W. Bush's victory speech are the following:

- *"I'm humbled by the trust and the confidence of my fellow citizens"*
- *"We will fight this war on terror ... so our children can live in freedom and in peace"*
- *"I will always be grateful to the good people of my state"*

The second rhetorical strategy that should be studied within the framework of the victory speech is **ethos.** This device aims to create a certain connection between the speaker and the audience, evoking a sense of trust, authority and credibility. Some of the examples from George W. Bush's speech are the following:

- *"And I will do my best to fulfill that duty every day as your president."*
- *"I will do all I can do to deserve your trust."*
- *" I'm proud to lead such an amazing country, and I'm proud to lead it forward."*

Due to the established communicative goal of the victory speech, George W. Bush does not implement **logos and kairos**, and establishes emotional connection and density through other methods.

Pre-election speech by Barack Hussein Obama (2012).

- **Historical Context:**

Barack Hussein Obama began his presidential term in 2008, becoming the 44th president of the United States. The beginning of his duties in this position was not easy, as the country was in economic decline after the financial crisis of 2007-2008. For this reason, the new President made decisions quickly but radically: The Wall Street Reform and Consumer Protection Act was passed, the slowdown in outsourcing and the return of factories to the United States, the

development of the industry of renewable energy, as well as tax cuts for certain segments of society.

However, the problems that the 45th president had to solve did not end there: in 2010, the largest environmental disaster in the country's history occurred, namely, an explosion on the Deepwater Horizon oil production platform, which caused about 5 million barrels of oil to enter the water. Touching on the topic of US foreign policy, it is crucial to mention that in 2011, the president withdrew troops from Iraq, which marked the end of the war (it was launched by ex-presidents George W. Bush as part of an anti-terrorism campaign after the terrorist attack in New York on September 9, 2001).

In an attempt to improve relations with the countries of the Middle East, Barack Obama put forward a slogan calling for democratization of the internal structure of States. This led to the beginning of a number of revolutions in countries such as Algeria, Tunisia, Libya, Yemen, Egypt and other countries. This historical moment was called the Arab Spring. Despite all the president's attempts to improve both internal and external communications of the United States, other mistakes on the part of the Barack Obama administration continued to appear anyway, and they recognized this. The most striking example is the 2011 invasion of Libya by American troops, from which the country is still recovering.

- **Topics emphasised in the message (speech):**

To begin with, it is important to establish that the choice of topics for disclosure within the framework of the pre-election speech in the second presidential race of Barack Obama was determined by both the main directions of his campaign and the cultural, social and political needs of the nation. The communicative situation was undoubtedly taken into account. Namely, the speech was presented at the Democratic National Convention, and, accordingly, the audience shared the speaker's political views. Even taking this aspect into

account, Barack Obama did not neglect speech behaviour and etiquette, formal speech style and the establishment of a clear message, which is an integral part of political discourse.

The following topics can be identified as the main ideological messages of this pre-election speech:

- The achievements of the first presidential term;
- The revival of manufacturing in the country, creation of new jobs and trade relations;
- Reducing taxes and inflation for basic needs;
- The development of renewable energy and the reduction of U.S. dependence on imported sources;
- Reforms in the fields of education and healthcare.

The disclosure of all these themes is aimed at achieving the communicative goal of the speech, namely, confirming why Barack Obama, and not his Republican opponent, should become the next president. At the same time, each of these aspects is touched upon for the reason that it is an urgent topic of thought among representatives of the middle class and the poor, who at that time made up about 65% of the US population. Controlling the level of inflation and taxes, starting reforms in education and healthcare, as well as the creation of new jobs are things that can change the lives of ordinary citizens, which means they will attract their attention and force them to vote for the Democrat.

- **Cultural references and culturally-loaded linguistic units:**

To begin with, Barack Obama's 2012 pre-election speech contains a broad range of allusions and cultural references that enrich its rhetorical power and enhance its emotional density. Based on the critical discourse analysis, applied within the framework of linguistic and cultural approach, it has been identified that the most numerous **allusions** presented in this utterance represent

the references to the actions that the future president promises to undertake in the next term, including his plans to recover the economy of the country after the presidency of George W. Bush (i.e. tax and inflation rates, and energy sources) and to improve working and living conditions of the people. These topics are framed throughout Obama's speech, strengthening the overall impact of his speech, as well as fostering unity and motivating collective action.

1. **The accomplishments of the first presidential term:**

- *"Now, I've cut taxes for those who need it – middle-class families, small businesses…"*
- *"I've signed trade agreements that are helping our companies sell more goods to millions of new customers;"*
- *"For the first time in a generation, nearly every state has answered our call to raise their standards for teaching and learning."*

Taking into account the historical context accompanying this utterance, it becomes evident that these allusions function as evidence of effective governance, reinforcing Obama's image as a credible, results-driven leader. For example, the first statement refers to his policies during the first elections and presidency period, which have been justified, since Barack Obama managed to make the economy of the United States steady despite the fact that he governed right after the Great Recession economic crises. Therefore, cultural and historical references in this case also serve a legitimising role, reminding voters that his policies have provided measurable progress, thus justifying continued support and re-election.

2. **The proposed policies of the election campaign:**

- *"Over the next few years, big decisions will be made in Washington – on jobs, the economy, taxes and deficits, energy, education, war and peace;"*
- *"The path we offer may be harder but it leads to a better place;"*
- *"We can choose a future where we export more products and outsource fewer jobs."*

As it has been already stated, the allusions to this topic are the most numerous in Barack Obama's message. They are carefully and sometimes implicitly transmitted through the linguistic means to inspire confidence and persuade the voters by offering a clear, hopeful vision that is echoed in the politician's campaign. In addition, they also serve as strong appeals to emotions, since they include the enumeration of the relevant issues of the overwhelming majority of the citizens. The first example clearly demonstrates the spheres of life that Barack Obama promises to improve and hence, alludes to them very often within the utterance to highlight their significance.

3. **References to political opponents:**

- *"Our friends down in Tampa at the Republican convention were more than happy to talk about everything they think is wrong with America, but they didn't have much to say about how they'd make it right;"*
- *"I don't believe that another round of tax breaks for millionaires will bring good jobs to our shores;"*
- *"After all we've been through, I don't believe that rolling back regulations on Wall Street will help the small businesswoman expand, or the laid-off construction worker keep his home. We have been there. We've tried that. And we're not going back."*

These allusions serve multiple rhetorical functions, that are of utmost relevance in the paradigm of political discourse – they clarify ideological differences, manipulate the listeners to vote for the Democratic party by framing Republicans as those who do not keep their promises, persuading the uncertain voters through appeals to economic justice and stability. The first two examples demonstrate criticising references to the Republicans' policies, implying that their campaigns lack constructive and goal-oriented proposals. This is a manipulative tactic used to enhance the future president's credibility by intentionally comparing his actions to the drawbacks of the opponents. The third

statement evokes the 2008 financial crisis, positioning Obama as a protector of the middle class, since he was the one who put an effort into its recovery.

4. **References to current societal, political, or economic problems:**

- *"Eight years later, that hope has been tested – by the cost of war, by one of the worst economic crises in history…"*
- *"... political gridlock that's left us wondering whether it's still even possible to tackle the challenges of our time;"*
- *"Families struggled with costs that kept rising but paychecks that didn't, folks racking up more and more debt just to make the mortgage or pay tuition, put gas in the car or food on the table.*

Regarding the above mentioned references, their main function is to 'humanise' the formal political discourse, demonstrating that Barack Obama, as a future national leader, understands and shares the audience's concerns. Furthermore, they underline the urgency of his policy agenda and in some cases even act as call-to-action appeals by convincing the audience that the only way to solve the existing problems is to have him as a president.

5. **The president's and American core values:**

- *"Ours is a fight to restore the values that built the largest middle class and the strongest economy the world has ever known – the values my grandfather defended as a soldier in Patton's Army;"*
- *"... the values that drove my grandmother to work on a bomber assembly line."*
- *"We, the people, recognize that we have responsibilities as well as rights; that our destinies are bound together; that a freedom which asks only, what's in it for me, a freedom without a commitment to others, a freedom without love or charity or duty or patriotism, is unworthy of our founding ideals and those who died in their defense."*

It is worth emphasising the fact that these examples, as well as the majority of other instances of the use of this device to refer to core national

values, represent complex constructions that usually combine conceptual metaphors, repetition, and expressive enumeration that are intentionally utilised in combination to convey memorable, highly culturally-resonant ideas. The first two examples are powerful emotional appeals, since they encompass both personal stories and references to military notions (his grandfather's military service and the participation of his grandmother in WWII) that serve to connect Obama's campaign to patriotism, sacrifice, and historical American strength.

Moving on to the next aspect of analysis, **the phraseological units** that have been implemented by Barack Obama are to be discussed. Some of their prominent examples include:

- *"If you're sick of hearing me approve this message, believe me, so am I;"*
- *"... and fulfill the basic bargain at the heart of America's story: the promise that hard work will pay off;"*
- *"... everyone gets a fair shot, and everyone does their fair share."*

These are the unique examples demonstrating three different types of the bound culture-specific units, namely, an **idiom, a saying, and a proverbial expression.** Overall, they all are united by the main purpose of enhancing the relatability of the messages transmitted. Through the use of these expressive means, the speaker appears to be closer to the audience and strengthens the speech's persuasive power by connecting policy messages to familiar, conversational language that unites the listeners and the politician.

It is crucial to outline that Barack Obama has employed many other lexical and syntactic stylistic devices and expressive means of language that are identified in the detailed in-text analysis of the speeches (see Appendix, Transcribed and Analysed Speech 5.) and outlined in the Results Section. However, the most vivid examples of culturally-loaded language are manifested through the use of the above analysed linguistic techniques.

- **Emotional density of the speech:**

Barack Obama makes extensive use of rhetorical strategies in his speech. This applies to both the main aspects (namely, pathos, ethos and logos) and the additional one, which is kairos. It is interesting to note that the President often uses them in combination with **cultural references (allusions)** that strengthen the emotional connection between the speaker and the audience, as well as make the manipulative effect brighter in its manifestation. Revealing the essence of the latter, the regular creation of a context for influencing makes this process easier each time, as it predisposes the listener more and more.

The first rhetorical strategy for analysis is **pathos,** the use of which is accompanied by an exceptional emotionality aimed at creating a connection between the speaker and the listener. The most vivid examples within the framework of Barack Obama's pre-election speech are the following:

- *"... a nation where the most innovative businesses turned out the world's best products, and everyone shared in that pride and success…"*
- *"... the values my grandfather defended as a soldier in Patton's Army, the values that drove my grandmother to work on a bomber assembly line…"*
- *"If you're sick of hearing me approve this message, believe me, so am I."*

All three of the above-mentioned sentences use different tactics to appeal to emotions, but this does not make them any less successful in achieving their goals. The first example uses a unified appeal to the nation, each representative of which experiences rather loaded feelings of pride towards their country because of its global successes. The second example is based on the fact that Barack Obama implemented the description of the life difficulties that his grandparents went through defending the values of the nation and the United States. The third example also uses a distinctive tactic, which is founded on the fact that the President equates his feelings about a certain issue with what the citizens are experiencing. All these sentences have different emotional loads, but they still help the speaker to influence listeners and shape their perception of information to a certain extent.

The second rhetorical strategy to be studied within the framework of the pre-election speech is **ethos.** This technique is aimed at establishing a certain connection by provoking the sense of trust, authority and credibility between the speaker and the audience. Some of the examples from Barack Obama's speech are the following:

"I'm no longer just a candidate: I'm the President. And...that means I know what it means…"

"I refuse to go along with that, and as long as I'm President I never will."

"And yes, my plan will continue to reduce the carbon pollution that is heating our planet…"

In the case of these sentences, it is possible to identify only two tactics. Namely, the first two examples establish a sense of authority and the correctness of the actions taken by mentioning the current post of Barack Obama, who was serving his first term, being at that time the 44th President of the United States. Thus, by emphasizing the fact that a politician has already managed to gain the trust of citizens once, he predisposes the audience to perceive not only the current, but also the future message. At the same time, the third example has a different structure, which emphasizes that the plan described by the President is already being implemented, and will only continue to exist. This creates a sense of trust based on the fact that Barack Obama is actually taking action to solve certain problems. Overall, all three examples illustrate the masterful use of ethos in political discourse in order to influence and predispose listeners.

The third and last traditionally accepted rhetorical strategy is logos. This tool is based on providing facts, statistics, and any other reliable arguments to support the message idea in order to manipulate the audience's perception. Barack Obama uses **logos** vividly in his speech, as can be seen from the following examples:

"...the same rate we had when our economy created nearly 23 million new jobs…"

"... and asks the wealthiest households to pay higher taxes on incomes over 250,000 dollars…"

"Independent experts say that my plan would cut our deficit by four trillion dollars

In all three cases, numerical data is indicated, but the surrounding context affects and eventually changes the workload of each unit. In the first example, the President indicates the number of new jobs in order to reveal the essence of the problem and influence the way the audience perceives this information. However, the level of emotional density is reduced to a certain extent due to the use of the word "nearly" before numerical data. The second example, on the contrary, enhances the manipulative effect by creating a specific polarity with numerical data and using the word "over". At the same time, the third example has the highest density, as it includes both logos and ethos. Namely, the speaker first creates a sense of trust by indicating that experts have evaluated his plan, and then reinforces it by emphasizing a specific amount of money by which expenses will be reduced. Overall, such a significant difference in emotional and manipulative load can be justified by the fact that, depending on the speech section, Barack Obama may have different communicative goals.

An additional rhetorical strategy, which is not included in the generally accepted concept, is **kairos.** Barack Obama demonstrates superb skills at creating the context for using this technique. It is crucial to note that the implication of kairos is often veiled, which is not the traditional approach of its application. Therefore, it is relevant to consider different variations of the manifestation of this rhetorical strategy in Barack Obama's pre-election speech:

- *"...if you believe in a country where everyone gets a fair shot and everyone does their fair share and everyone plays by the same rules, then I need you to vote this November."*
- *"If you reject the notion that this nation's promise is reserved for the few, your voice must be heard in this election."*

- “You can choose the path where we control more of our own energy.”

Considering the examples mentioned above, it should be noted that each of them represents specific tactics that differ from each other. In the first example, Barack Obama uses emotional tension by describing a possible future, and then applying a direct and vivid call to action at the end of the sentence. Such a "context - kairos" structure is traditional in its application. The second example uses the method of opposition and the representation of a negative future, which is also a strong manipulative tactic. However, unlike the first case, this call to action has the form of a metaphor and is not that explicit. The last sentence also uses an analogy where future events that can happen in the country are positioned as a path that can be followed. At the same time, there are several possible paths, and the call to action is conveyed through the formulation of choosing a specific road. Overall, all three tactics are effective manipulative strategies, but they still have clear differences, which are primarily evident in the context provided by Barack Obama.

Victory speech by Barack Hussein Obama (2012)

- **Topics emphasised in the message (speech):**

To begin with, it is important to note that there is a logical correlation between the topics that Barack Obama covered in his pre-election speech and the ones he revealed in his victory speech. At the same time, the communicative goal is completely different and does not require clarifying details to gain authority and trust, but is more aimed at generalizing the future path of the country. An important structural element of the victory speech is the “thank-you” section, in which the newly elected president expresses his gratitude not only to the citizens of the country, but also to his fellow party members. Based on this idea, the following key themes can be identified in Barack Obama's victory speech:

- Achievements and results of the pre-election campaign;

- Gratitude to the family, the party and the citizens;
- Citizens are the driving force of the United States;
- A promising new future for the country.

By studying the above-mentioned topics in more detail, it can be determined that the basis of victory speech is a high emotional load, which is traditionally manifested in a moment of gratitude to all those who supported the speaker, highlighting what has already been achieved and what remains to be done. As a separate ideological element, Barack Obama emphasises the role of Americans, who shaped the country the way it is, as well as who are the driving force for further achievements. The unifying aspect throughout the speech is the creation of a synthesis between the key elements of the pre-election campaign, and how some of them have already been achieved simply by choosing Barack Obama as president.

- **Cultural references and culturally-loaded linguistic units:**

First of all, the victory speech, as well as the pre-election speech delivered by Barack Hussein Obama, contains a large number of diverse cultural references, which can also be called **allusions** to cultural, social and historical aspects of the formation of modern USA. Based on the critical discourse analysis, applied within the framework of linguistic and cultural approach to the study, certain culturally-loaded linguistic units were identified.

Barack Obama, presenting his victory speech on the results of the presidential election, used culturally-loaded units not only to create an emotional connection, but also to strengthen the messages conveyed. This is most often found in a combination with lexical stylistic devices.

Regarding the topics that the president highlights, it is, first of all, the importance of ending the war in the east, restoring the work of factories in the country, as well as reducing dependence on imports in all its forms. The

expression of all these ideas occurs through culturally-loaded units in different manifestations. Some of the examples are:

1. **Cultural references:**

"God bless you. God bless these United States."

"...despite all the frustrations of Washington, I've never been more hopeful about our future…"

"...to meet the challenges we can only solve together – reducing our deficit, reforming our tax code, fixing our immigration system, freeing ourselves from foreign oil."

2. **Phraseological units:**

"...you made a difference…"

"...the Romney family has chosen to give back to America…"

"...I also look forward to…"

3. **Metonymy:**

"...despite all the frustrations of Washington…"

"...who turned out at our rallies and crowded along a rope line…"

"... the task of perfecting our union."

4. **Hyperbole**

"...I have never loved you more…"

"I have never been prouder…"

"To the best campaign team and volunteers in the history of politics…"

- **Emotional density of the speeches:**

Studying the emotional impact of Barack Obama's victory speech, it is important to establish that the use of rhetorical strategies remains as vivid as it was in pre-election speech. However, the way each technique forms a connection between the speaker and the audience may be different. Moreover, it is relevant to take into account the fact that the time interval between the two studied units is about two months, and that is why the emotional load has

approximately the same level. The difference in the length of the spoken message is also to be considered.

To begin with, the rhetorical strategy of appealing to emotions, namely **pathos**, is to be analysed. Its use in Barack Obama's victory speech is extensive, as the speaker speaks to a significant extent about gratitude and a sense of responsibility to the entire nation. The most striking examples in this speech by the 44th President of the United States are the following:

- *"To the best campaign team and volunteers in the history of politics – the best – the best ever, some of you were new this time around, and some of you have been at my side since the very beginning."*
- *"I have never been prouder to watch the rest of America fall in love with you too as our nation's first lady."*
- *"I want to thank my friend and partner of the last four years, America's happy warrior, the best vice-president anybody could ever hope for, Joe Biden."*

The second rhetorical strategy that is being studied within the framework of this victory speech is **ethos.** Its application is aimed at establishing connection through feelings of trust, credibility and authority. Some of the examples from Barack Obama's victory speech are the following:

- *"The role of citizens in our democracy does not end with your vote."*
- *"I return to the White House more determined and more inspired than ever about the work there is to do and the future that lies ahead."*
- *"And you've made me a better president."*

The third and at the same time the last traditionally accepted rhetorical strategy is **logos.** Its use in speech is based on providing reliable information in the format of facts, statistics, and any other reliable arguments. In victory speech, the introduction of logos is not common, since the communicative goal is fundamentally different from the pre-election speech and is aimed at appealing to emotions, rather than manipulating them in order to achieve the

necessary results. There are only two examples of its application in the victory speech delivered by Barack Obama:

- *"...to meet the challenges we can only solve together – reducing our deficit, reforming our tax code, fixing our immigration system, freeing ourselves from foreign oil."*
- *"Democracy in a nation of 300 million…"*

The use of **kairos** is also worth paying attention to. Its widespread employment in victory speeches is not common, but Barack Obama still demonstrates excellent skills in creating a context for using this technique. Some examples of its use are the following:

"I believe we can seize this future together…"

"We've got more work to do."

"You can make it here in America if you're willing to try."

Pre-election speech by Donald John Trump (2024)

- **Historical context:**

In 2024, when Donald Trump delivered his speech at the Republican National Convention, the United States was experiencing a period marked by intense political, social, and economic challenges. The society remained sharply divided in terms of the political viewpoints following the 2020 presidential election, which Joe Biden won. This polarisation was influenced by the events of January 6, 2021, when Trump supporters violently stormed the U.S. Capitol. Their goal was to stop Congress from certifying Biden's victory by disrupting the session counting the electoral votes. The attack resulted in the growing tension between political parties and raised serious concerns about the stability of American democracy.

In addition to this, Donald Trump was involved in multiple legal investigations related to his possible efforts to change the 2020 election

outcome. The House of Representatives charged Trump with encouraging the attack, but the Senate acquitted him, intensifying partisan divisions. The political environment was further complicated by the fact that Trump was running for president again, despite these legal issues. The 2024 campaign period saw two assassination attempts against Trump, highlighting the extreme hostility present in the political environment.

Another important political factor is that President Joe Biden, who was initially strived to be re-elected, withdrew after a poor debate performance and concerns about his health. Vice President Kamala Harris became the Democratic nominee. On the Republican side, Trump proposed the nomination with JD Vance as his running mate.

As for the social domain, while challenges remained, there were efforts to improve living and working conditions. The Biden administration continued to expand access to healthcare and undertake incentives to fight the HIV epidemic, as well as education and social security benefits, aiming to support vulnerable groups of people. Besides that, Biden signed Executive Order 13988, which required all federal agencies to extend existing non-discrimination protections based on sex to include sexual orientation and gender identity.

Key issues during the campaign included immigration control and enhanced criminal level, economic crises (i.e. high tax code, inflation rates, rising energy and oil prices), and foreign conflicts such as the conflict between Ukraine and Russia and tensions in the Middle East and China. The midterm elections earlier that year resulted in Republicans regaining control of both the House of Representatives and the Senate, shifting the balance of power in Congress.

- **Topics emphasised in the message (speech):**

As it has been already highlighted the topics covered in the speech are highly dependent on the communicative goals of the pre-election speeches and the events happening in the country at that moment. A unique feature of this

particular speech is its immediate context – Trump is addressing the nation with his policies just a few days after surviving an assassination attempt, which becomes one of the central topics that is either expressed explicitly or framed with the use of the linguistic tools throughout the whole utterance.

The next major messages that stand out in the campaign are the idea of 'healing' the country and the criticism of Joe Biden's presidency. A significant portion of the speech focuses on the core American principles and beliefs, including patriotism, faith in God, and collective courage. Finally, Trump explicitly frames the 2024 election as a mission to "make America successful, safe, free and great again," directly invoking the core MAGA slogan, as well as his control policies over illegal immigrants.

- **Cultural references and culturally-loaded linguistic units:**

In his speech, Donald Trump also implements a wide variety of linguistic units that enhance its cultural load, making it more emotional and persuasive. The president employs **allusions** as the main tool to frame cultural ideologies that help him express his standpoints, outline future policies and implicitly underline their significance. The following examples can be cited:

1. **Assassination attempt:**

- *"Not supposed to be here;"*
- *"the assassination attempt at my rally on Saturday;"*
- *"I stand before you in this arena only by the grace of almighty God."*

These references are the important part of Trump's speech which are employed very frequently not only to appeal to a serious personal danger and highlight the significance of the moment of this interaction between him and the audience, but also frame the idea of courage and loyalty of his supportence, reinforcing the themes of heroism and solidarity promoted in his election campaign. Additionally, the examination of the narrative's structure of this speech has revealed that Trump deliberately and most extensively alluded to this

attack at the beginning and at the end of the utterance. This framing makes a powerful impact on the perception of the overall message, by humanising the speaker, dramatising the election efforts and the 'price' of these efforts, and also denoting his survival as 'providential.'

2. **Existing country's issues:**

- *"The discord and division in our society must be healed;"*
- *"I am running to be president for all of America, not half of America;"*
- *"Inflation has wiped out the life savings of our citizens , and forced the middle class into a state of depression and despair."*

By referencing these problems, Donald Trump frames the upcoming election as a crucial moment for solving them. As a future leader, he attempts to demonstrate the relevance of the promised policies by reinforcing his statements with the current cultural issues that resonate with the citizens of the country and thus enhance their reliability. Further on, it is crucial to emphasise that the most vivid issue that is referenced in the speech relates to the economic indicators of the country (i.e. tax code, increased inflation rate, oil and energy sources, small businesses' problems, and others), reflecting Trump's personal background, in particular his career as a businessman.

3. **Criticism of Joe Biden's administration:**

- *"The Democrat party should immediately stop weaponizing the justice system;"*
- *"We must first rescue our nation from failed and even incompetent leadership"*
- *"The current administration terminated every single one of those great Trump policies."*

Donald Trump's frequent allusions to Joe Biden's presidency and his own policies that he claims were "devastated" or "reversed" by the Biden administration are an intentional and strategic rhetorical device in his speech. Many of Trump's supporters have a negative attitude towards the direction of

the country under Biden. By repeatedly referencing Biden's presidency in negative terms and portraying himself as the only candidate capable of changing current problems, the speaker manipulates the voters, reinforcing the sense of shared purpose and viewpoints.

4. **'Make America Great Again' Movement:**

- *"... how to make America successful, safe, free and great again;"*
- *"He's going to be a great vice president, he's going to be great. He'll be with this country and with this movement;"*
- *"Under our leadership, the United States will be respected again."*

This is a separate important group of references that are implemented by Donald Trump throughout the speech to amplify the identity of his campaign. It is necessary to point out that MAGA is not just a slogan, it is a central rallying policy of Trump's political movement since 2016. The slogan itself is in the majority of cases transformed and does not represent the initial sounding, but rather hidden implications bound in the forms of consonant phrases that foster a sense of belonging and collective responsibility. What is more, such powerful slogans have a special impact on the minds of the audience during the times of crises or terrifying events (e.g., successive assimilation attacks), since the distinctive feature of all slogans is the ability to produce a memorable and highly emotional effect.

5. **Other major policies of the campaign:**

- *"... the great job my administration did on immigration at the southern border;"*
- *"We will drill, baby, drill;"*
- *"Because they're taking the jobs from our Black population, our Hispanic population."*

Trump's use of allusions in these policy statements is strategic and manipulative in the sense that it simplifies complex concepts, evokes strong emotions, and frames debates in ways that favor his candidacy. Among the references that fall

into this category, the allusions to his past and current plans to increase the control over the illegal immigrants and establish restrictions on their ability to take over the job and college places. These policies are also interrelated with the economic agenda that is put emphasis on in Trump's campaign.

Next, **phraseological units** that have been identified in the speech are worth paying attention to:

- *"I am a great believer in luck, and I find the harder I work, the more I have of it;"*
- *"We were beating every country, including China, by leaps and bounds;"*
- *"Third world countries would fight with sticks and stones not to let this happen."*

The number of the utilised set or idiomatic expressions is quite high in the analysed speech, making it even more culturally-loaded. As for the first phrase, it is one of the most peculiar examples of their use, since it represents a well-known American saying, often attributed to Thomas Jefferson and sometimes to other famous figures, that is utilised in order to evoke the emotions and engage the audience through the use of a familiar and resonant language. The last two examples illustrate the use of idioms implemented in the context of the utterance with the same purpose of appealing to the audience and affecting their perception.

Further on, the analysis has shown that Donald Trump utilised a great number of **conceptual metaphors** and certain metonymic expressions that are closely intertwined with the social and cultural background context. For instance:

- *"Our cities are flooded with illegal aliens;"*
- *"We will lead America to new heights of greatness"*
- *"Americans are being squeezed out of the labor force."*

The examples demonstrate a deliberate use of metaphor to frame one concept in terms of another. In the framework of linguistic and cultural approach, these

devices are of particular importance to be analysed, since their peculiarity is their dependence on the cultural context. A person that is isolated from that culture can miss the implied figurative meaning of this stylistic device.

Among the most vivid examples of the use of culture-specific **metonymy and its special cases (i.e. antonomasia, synecdoche),** the following instances can be outlined:

- *"They were serious Trumpsters;"*
- *"... because of this very foolish administration"*
- *"It's just some of the fools on top"*

Regarding the functions of these devices in Trump's speech, they also intensify the emotional density of the speech. In this context, they serve as the tools that personalise political identities, sharpen distinctions between supporters and opponents, and present the concepts or people being described in the desired way.

Finally, **hyperbole** as a frequently employed stylistic device appears to have cultural connotations or references in the context of Donald Trump's pre-election speech. By presenting his past political experiences, as well as future achievements and policies as 'unprecedented,' the speaker intents to convince the audience and make an impactful emotional appeal:

- *"We will lead America to new heights of greatness like the world has never seen before;"*
- *"We had an economy the likes of which nobody, no nation had ever seen;"*
- *"The entire world is pouring into our country."*

In these cases, hyperboles are indeed culture-specific as they are used to exaggerate particular concepts relevant only in the framework of this country's features. For instance, the first example is a hyperbole and allusion to the MAGA Movement at once, which in combination are utilised in order to

manipulate the listeners' perception by making the future promises seem greater or problems more severe, as in the last two examples.

- **Emotional density of the speech:**

Donald John Trump makes wide use of not only **rhetorical strategies**, but also **parcellation** in order to gain a specific emotional impact on the audience. The latter is considered to be an intentional division of one message into several compositional elements, and is traditionally perceived by listeners as a means of escalating tension, which makes the listener more receptive. The combination of these two approaches leads to the fact that the speaker can enhance the overall emotional and manipulative impact. Revealing the essence of this interaction, it is relevant to consider its application in Donald Trump's pre-election speech.

The first aspect to be analyzed in relation to **parcellation** is **pathos,** which is originally considered as an appeal to emotions and is aimed at establishing this kind of relationship between the speaker and the audience. The most striking examples of this combination are the following:

- *"I would not be here tonight. We would not be together."*
- *"I'm not supposed to be here tonight. Not supposed to be here."*
- *"Fight, fight, fight."*

All three of the above-mentioned examples have a common theme, namely, they reveal the essence and consequences of the attack on Donald Trump during one of his pre-election campaigns in Butler, Pennsylvania. Despite the fact that the events described have a strong emotional density (since at that moment not only the President got injured, but also one of the soldiers who defended him died), the speaker decides to strengthen it by parcellation. In the first two examples, one tactic is used to represent a hypothetical development of events where Donald John Trump would not be saved. The third example has the format of a slogan and is not only an appeal to emotions, but also a metaphorical call to action. Overall, the use of a combination of pathos and parcellation has a strong

influence on the audience and predisposes it to a possible increase in tension, which is what Donald Trump uses.

The next rhetorical strategy with which parcellation interacts is **ethos**, the use of which is aimed at provoking the sense of trust, credibility, and authority to the speaker. Its use is justified by the necessity to predispose the audience for further manipulation. The most prominent examples that demonstrate this kind of combination in the pre-election speech of the 45th President of the United States are the following:

- *“ We will press forward, and together, we will win, win, win.”*
- *“And we will do it right. We’re going to do it right.”*
- *“...I will never, ever let you down. I promise that. I will never let you down”*

In the case of these three demonstrations of ethos and parcellation, Donald Trump uses different communicative tactics. In the first example, the focus is on unifying the entire nation with the help of the pronoun "we", as well as emphasizing that they cannot give up and have to go forward in order to win, but do it together. It is precisely because of the parcelling of a single idea into several combinational units that this sentence provokes feelings of trust and reliability. In the second example, all citizens are also united by a pronoun, even though the goal is not victory, but the correctness of future decisions. The use of two grammatical constructions in subsequent sentences with the same message enhances the manipulative effect. The last third example utilises a new tactic of setting promises, which had not previously been used in the speech by this speaker. This structure of splitting up an idea and then repeating it serves as a reinforcement for establishing a trusting relationship with the audience. Overall, all three sentences fully reveal the practical significance of using a combination of ethos and parcellation, and also demonstrate their own peculiarities, which are expressed in such aspects as lexical repetition and a variety of grammatical structures.

To consider the following rhetorical strategy, namely **logos,** it is important to state that its use carries a strong semantic load, which in some cases can slow down the process of perception and processing of information. In addition, an extensive context is required for proper decoding of such a device. For this reason, the logo is not widely used in Donald Trump's pre-election speech and is not compatible with the parcellation. Some of the most striking manifestations of this technique within the framework of the analyzed pre-election speech conveyed by Donald Trump during his second presidential race are the following:

- *"We defeated 100 percent of ISIS in Syria and Iraq…"*
- *"In El Salvador, murders are down 70 percent."*
- *"One hundred and seven percent of those jobs are taken by illegal aliens."*

Based on these three examples, the idea that logos requires additional information in order to properly understand and interpret the message can be emphasised. Thus, in the first sentence, the use of numeric data is aimed at supporting the message that the US army is strong enough to defeat even such a historically severe opponent. In the second case, the percentage is also given, and it is interesting to note that the speaker points out how the number of murders has decreased, rather than emphasizing how much it is compared to last year. It can also be considered as a certain manipulative tactic and framing of the transmitted information. The third sentence is presented in the context of a discussion of how the large influx of immigrants into the country affects the basic ability of local residents to obtain decent jobs. The indication of statistical data once again underlines its effectiveness in the context of its impact on a wide audience. Overall, even though all three examples use the same tactic of predisposing and further manipulating the audience, this numerical approach remains effective in the context of this speech.

The use of the additional rhetorical strategy, namely **kairos**, in combination with **parcellation** is not widely used in Donald Trump's pre-election speech. This is due to the fact that this technique is a call to action and, like logos, requires proper timing, context, and an explicitly established communicative goal. Nevertheless, there are still several representative examples of this combination that are to be considered:

- *"With great humility, I am asking you to be excited about the future of our country. Be excited. Be excited."*
- *"...they want to raise your taxes four times. Think of it."*
- *"I want your vote. We're going to make our country great again."*

Kairos is a fairly strong rhetorical strategy, the excessive use of which only burdens the text. Based on the examples mentioned above, it can be stated that its use is not hidden and is traditionally found at the end of a sentence. It is interesting to note that in the first sentence, Donald Trump twice repeats the phrase (call to action), which is also used in describing the context and preparing the audience. This can be fully considered as a manifestation of parcellation and deliberate reinforcement of manipulative tactics. The second example utilises a different approach, namely that the speaker acts as a mentor who does not openly create opposition, but calls for action in relation to the issue. At the same time, the latter is syntactically highlighted, which, as in the first case, is a demonstration of the combination of kairos with parcellation. In the third case, the President directly voices the set communication task, and only then gives an explanation in the form of a promise to make America great again. Such manipulative tactics are not traditional in use, but they are no less effective. In general, the presence of ideological diversity and strengthening it by combining two tools to influence the audience has an effective application in Donald Trump's election speech.

Victory speech by Donald John Trump (2024)

- **Topics emphasised in the message (speech):**

To start with, it is crucial to note that Donald Trump, like other speakers, uses topics that were presented in the pre-election speech and then frames it in accordance with the structure of the victory speech. The 45th and 47th President of the United States, in order to achieve the set communicative goals, touched upon important topics of the development of the country's future and the measures that will be taken for this. It is essential to outline that the speaker also has a section where he thanks all those who supported him throughout the presidential race. Moreover, Donald Trump also gives the floor to his vice president, JD Vance. Based on all of the above-mentioned, the following thematic units can be identified in the victory speech under study:

1. Achievements and results of the pre-election campaign;
2. Gratitude to the family, the party and the citizens;
3. A promising new future for the country;
4. Make America Great Again (MAGA).

Based on the fact that all three presidents (whose speeches are analysed within this study) mention the topics of already closed pre-election campaigns, plans for the development of the country, and also express wide gratitude to all the people involved in their victory, it is possible to conclude that they are the fundamental section in the victory speech. It also implies their great manipulative nature, which each speaker adapts to their needs. Regarding the latter topic, namely the MAGA movement, Donald Trump's emphasis on it is logical, since this slogan has been used by the politician since the beginning of his first pre-election campaign in 2015. Every mention of it is considered to be a culturally-loaded unit.

- **Cultural references and culturally-loaded linguistic units:**

In revealing the main message of his victory speech, Donald Trump used a large number of cultural references to his last pre-election campaign and presidential term. This makes speech broader and more emotionally complex, since in order to decode it, it is necessary not only to share cultural background, but also to have narrowly focused knowledge. Overall, the use of culturally-loaded units is extensive. Some examples of their use are the following:

1. **Cultural references:**

- *"We also have won the popular vote."*
- *".... all won by the MAGA movement."*
- *"... we'll be keeping control of the House of Representatives"*

2. **Phraseological units:**

- *"This will truly be the golden age of America."*
- *"Beautiful inside and out"*
- *"... the only guy I've ever seen who really looks forward to it."*

3. **Metonymy:**

- *"...despite all the frustrations of Washington…"*
- *"...who turned out at our rallies and crowded along a rope line…"*
- *"... the task of perfecting our union."*

- **Emotional density of the speech:**

In his victory speech, Donald John Trump continues the widespread use of rhetorical strategies. The first rhetorical strategy to be analysed is **pathos,** the use of which is conditioned by exceptional emotionality aimed at creating a certain connection between the speaker and the audience. The most practically significant examples within the framework of Donald Trump's victory speech are the following:

- *"This was a movement like nobody's ever seen before."*
- *"We have a country that needs help, and it needs help very badly."*

- *"We made history for a reason tonight, and the reason is going to be just that."*

The second rhetorical strategy that should be explored as part of a victory speech is **ethos**. The use of this technique is traditionally done to establish a certain connection by creating a sense of trust, authority and persuasiveness towards the speaker, in this case the president. Some of the examples from Donald Trump's victory speech are the following:

- *" I will fight for you, for your family and your future. Every single day I will be fighting for ..."*
- *"I will not rest until we have delivered the strong, safe and prosperous America."*
- *"I will govern by a simple motto: promises made, promises kept."*

This is the end of the rhetorical strategies used by Donald Trump in his victory speech. Such a lack of **logos and kairos** can be justified by the fact that the communicative task of this type of discourse does not imply the presence of evidence-based arguments, and a call to action is optional.

To conclude, a comprehensive content analysis of the speeches through the framework of linguistic and cultural approach has demonstrated the extensive use of culturally-loaded linguistic units and rhetorical strategies that intensify the overall expressiveness, emotionality and manipulative impacts of the utterances and reflect the unique peculiarities of the speakers' rhetoric. It is essential to specify that this section has focused on the clarification of various linguistic means with the implied cultural connotations, which are showcased using an equal number of examples that illustrate their functions. However, the given research carries out a full-fledged examination of the presented linguistic and rhetorical peculiarities in the form of the tables and graphs (see Appendix.), featuring the categories, number of occurrences, and all the examples of their use in the pre-election and victory speeches of George Bush, Barack Obama and Donald Trump.

2.4 Comparative Analysis.

Having conducted an in-depth content analysis of the pre-election and victory speeches by Donald John Trump, Barack Hussein Obama, and George Walker Bush, using the framework of linguistic and cultural approach and the methods applied in this study, it is now possible to compare the analysed units on the basis of the outlined parameters (see Section 2.1). This chapter focuses on the identification of key differences in the use of culturally- and emotionally-loaded linguistic units by three presidents that have distinct cultural and personal backgrounds. Taking that into consideration, the comparative analysis in this research aims to reveal in what ways cultural backgrounds (see their descriptions in Appendix.) of the speakers influenced their linguistic choices within their political messages.

In addition, the second chosen parameter for comparison, namely, the reflection of the contrast between two types of speeches that have been examined through the lens of linguistic and cultural approach is also to be discussed. Both criteria are essential for the study since they correspond to the primary research questions and hypotheses of the study. In particular, the questions concerning, first of all, whether the speeches reflect the peculiarities of the speaker as a representative of a certain culture and unique background through the use of linguistic means, and, second of all, whether these linguistic means vary depending on the type and of the presidential speeches.

It is crucial to mention that all the findings provided in this section are based on the preliminary, all-encompassing critical discourse and quantitative content analyses that are provided in their full format in the Appendix of the study in the forms of the tables featuring all identified examples of the devices utilised by the speakers, their number of occurrences, graphs that visualise the results, and two subsequent comparative tables that concentrate on the

quantified percentages that facilitate the analysis of the most vivid, representative features.

First, **the varieties in the linguistic choices of the presidents** are to be presented. As far as the linguistic and cultural analytical approach is concerned, socio-cultural backgrounds of the speakers have a direct impact on their mindsets and the language they use. The latter can be manifested on the different levels, including the lexical and syntactic layers of the speech, each of which has been analysed to define the overall emotional density and manipulativeness of the effects produced by the utterances.

At the lexical level, the analysis shows that all three presidents extensively utilised various figures of speech, many of which are indeed culturally-loaded. **Allusions,** as one of the most prominent devices embodying cultural connotations, are the most frequent and powerful tools employed by the presidents, with George Bush standing out across the pre-election speeches and Barack Obama within the victory ones.

These tendencies are indeed impacted by the socio-cultural contexts and backgrounds of the speakers – George Bush's most references are related either to the terrorist attacks that were going on during his first presidency or his underlying traditional and conservative values (e.g., core principles of family and faith, or the opposing views towards same-sex marriage) the allusion to which is explained by the fact that he comes from a prominent political family with a strong Republican standpoints. His father, George H.W. Bush was the 41st president of the United States and a figure associated with conservative values. In addition to that, the fact that Bush was born and raised in Texas, one of the South American states with distinct strictness towards many social aspects, also contributes to the understanding of the logic behind the linguistic choices made in his political addresses.

Despite the fact that both George Bush and Barack Obama employed almost equal numbers of allusions to frame certain ideologies (27.7% against

30,6 respectively in the sum of two speeches), their essence is absolutely not the same. Barack Obama, as a representative of the Democrat party and absolutely different cultural background, on the contrary, uses various linguistic techniques to allude to principles of inclusivity, change, freedom of choice, and a broader social justice perspective. As the first African American president, Obama puts greater emphasis on the rights of minorities and calls to overcome the discrimination of any kind, which directly echoes his multicultural background (Kenyan father, American mother), upbringing in diverse cultural environments (Indonesia, Kenya, the United States), and his experience as a community organizer.

As for Donald Trump's use of **culture-specific references,** it is worth noting that their overall sum constitutes 18.8% overall, which stands behind a close percentage of this device's utilisation by the other two presidents. Despite this variation, the similarity of the topics alluded to has been identified in his and George Bush's speeches. Firstly, it allows one to draw the conclusion that belonging to a particular party greatly influences the rhetoric and manipulative techniques employed by the speakers. All the speakers have used allusions and other culture-specific lexical units to mobilise the votes towards their parties and policies and debate the opposing views. Secondly, it also reflects the cultural experiences of the speaker. Trump's commitment to the Republican viewpoints that are transmitted through the use of allusions, conceptual metaphors, and other means, is also the characteristic feature of his upbringing in a bustling, competitive urban setting and his deal-making skills as an influential businessman. His principles concentrate on economic nationalism, law, order, and cultural conservatism, often framed in terms of protecting American jobs and identity against globalisation and immigration.

Another peculiar distinction that is seen in the **lexical devices**, is Trump's extensive utilisation of **hyperbole and intensifiers** in his speech (15.6 % and 22.8 % respectively overall) in comparison to Bush and Obama (10.7 % and 2.8

% against 8.9 % and 4.4 % respectively). The analysis of Trump's pre-election speech revealed 56 instances of the use of such intensifiers, as 'really,' 'totally,' 'extremely,' and 'very' that are in some cases presented in a combination with incomplete sentences (i.e. ellipsis) that make some of the statements seem informal. Both Bush and Obama, on the contrary, coming from more conventional political and academic backgrounds, have just a few examples of their use.

Such a great difference indicates a certain tendency concerning the correlation of the career and education paths of the speakers and their rhetorical tactics. Trump's socio-cultural background as a New York businessman and reality TV personality fostered a communication style that is sometimes not very formal, but emphatic, and designed to capture attention quickly. In their speeches, Barack Obama and George Bush tend to use metaphors and phraseological units more than the above mentioned expressive and stylistic means. Using the sophisticated figurative comparisons and applying familiar fixed expressions to their ideas, they promote ideas more subtly, while also evoking the emotions in the minds of the audience.

The next features that are worth contrasting as they also reflect the cultural peculiarities of the presidents are the use of **irony and rhetorical questions.** In general, both of the devices are considered to be the indicators of the informal tone or register of the speech. However, as it has been clarified in the theoretical part of the research, in political discourse they can function as the tools to oppose someone's ideologies and to engage or distract the audience. Donald Trump, who has an economic background compared to George Bush's military and political experiences and Barack Obama's interconnection with Law and Politics studies and practices, utilised both of the devices the most. It is noteworthy that in almost all the cases of the utilisation of irony and rhetorical questions, Trump aims at positioning himself as an 'outsider' fighting against a corrupt establishment and explicitly undermining the opponents. As for Barack

Obama and George Bush, their few instances of the use of these techniques rather demonstrate the intentional desire to engage the audience and make them think of the proposed policies.

At the syntactic level, all presidents employ various types of **grammatical repetition and parallel constructions** to structure the ideas in a more efficient way. The most important aspect that is worth highlighting at this layer is that there is a visible difference between the narrative techniques of these three speakers. While George Bush and Barack Obama implement a great number of parallel constructions and antithesis to frame their ideas and make them more emotionally powerful, Donald Trump's distinct feature is a numerous utilisation of short, incomplete, parcellated sentences throughout the speech. Listening to the oral formats of the utterances, this peculiarity is the first to be noticed, since the intonation patterns utilised in the case of Trump's speech that is full of **ellipsis, deliberate parcellated pauses, and inversion** are very different from the long passages of identical and sometimes quite complicated grammatical structures frequently employed by Obama and Bush.

Both techniques contribute to the expressive, emotive and phonological power of the utterances but represent different narrative and storytelling methods. On the one hand, Trump's syntactic structures aim to be spontaneous and relatable, which contrasts with formal political oratory, making his speeches accessible and memorable. George Bush's parallel structures almost in every extract of his speech, on the other hand, are also of particular usefulness in the formal addresses of the political nominee as they present the speaker as highly literate and authoritative and create balanced and elevate arguments. Barack Obama's use of **parallel constructions** is also very extensive, but what is especially noteworthy, parallelism in his speeches is frequently manifested in the form of antithesis, the biggest number of which has been identified in his utterance (7.8 % against Bush's and Trump's 5.6 % and 3.6 % respectively). Obama utilised **antithesis** to clearly outline the differences between his policies

and those of his main political opponent, Mitt Romney, the Republican nominee in the 2012 presidential election. Its use is also explained by the values influenced by his socio-cultural background that drive his campaign and that vary from the opponent's side.

To sum up the comparison of the linguistic peculiarities of three representatives of distinct backgrounds, it is worth stating that despite the differences in views and experiences of the speakers, all the speeches are marked with the broad use of units that reflect the linguistic and cultural identities of the speakers. However, the comparative analysis carried out relying on the principles of linguistic and cultural approach shows clear tendencies in the use of certain techniques by the speakers that are influenced by their cultural perspectives.

Regarding **the second parameter for comparison,** it is aimed at revealing the characteristic features of two different communicative situations that are under the analysis of this study. Political utterances are inherently shaped by their communicative context and goals. In the realm of presidential addresses, pre-election and victory speeches represent two distinct genres, each serving unique purposes: the former aims to persuade and manipulate, while the latter is used to celebrate inauguration by highlighting shared achievement, as well as to unify and inspire the audience.

One of the most notable distinctions between pre-election and victory speeches is the frequency and function of emotional and evaluative devices, such as **epithets, intensifiers, and pathos.** In victory speeches, the use of epithets increases significantly across all speakers (e.g., from 11.4% to 19.8% in Trump's speeches). Similarly, the proportion of the appeal to emotion strategy rises in the victory speeches, most prominently in Bush's (from 5.4% to 15.2%) and Trump's (from 3.9% to 9.2%) utterances. This shift reflects the communicative goal of victory speeches – to evoke collective pride, gratitude, and unity after electoral success.

Further on, victory speeches also contain a greater number of **syntactic stylistic devices**, in particular, **parallelism and anaphora**. For instance, Obama's use of parallelism increases from 8.1% in pre-election speeches to 12.1% in victory speeches, while anaphora remains consistently high. These devices contribute to the rhythmic and memorable quality of victory speeches, while serving primarily to construct persuasive arguments and express future promises in the pre-election ones.

However, devices associated with **logical reasoning** and persuasion are more prevalent in the pre-election speeches. For example, the use of **logos** is generally higher in pre-election speeches (e.g., 2.3% against 0.6% in Obama's victory speech), as well as **allusions** (e.g. 9.6% against 6% in Trump's victory speech) that are more powerful in the framework of election campaigns, where they are strategically used to implicitly frame ideologies and the significance of their potential leadership, hence influencing the perception of the audience.

Metaphors show a notable shift in usage patterns, with Obama substantially increasing his metaphorical expressions from pre-election (10.5%) to victory speeches (17.9%), while Trump demonstrates the opposite tendency (7.4% to 4.6%). These shifts highlight that metaphors serve different functions in these contexts: in victory speeches, they help convey unifying messages and the idea of collective achievement, while in pre-election speeches, they may function more as persuasive tools to frame policy positions.

Last but not least, a particularly significant shift is observed in the use of **irony.** In the pre-election speeches, irony is employed more frequently (Trump – 2.4%; Bush – 2%; Obama – 1.4%) than in victory speeches (Trump – 0.6%; Bush – 0.6%; Obama – 0.3%). This downward shift is also explained by a change in communicative goals. In pre-election contexts, irony functions as a tool for critique, differentiation, or emotional appeal, as it is most vividly seen in Trump's utterances. In contrast, victory speeches minimise irony, as the focus

shifts from contest to celebration, in which this device can rather be utilised to foster a positive and engaging atmosphere.

To sum up, the most relevant devices that indicate certain shifts have been outlined. Their comparative analysis reveals that the way presidents use language cues changes a lot depending on the type of speech they give, as well as their cultural background and political affiliations.

2.5 Results

The results obtained on the basis of linguistic and cultural analysis of pre-election and victory speeches by Donald John Trump, Barack Hussein Obama, and George Walker Bush demonstrate a close interconnection between the language and socio-cultural backgrounds of the speakers. For the purposes of conducting a holistic representation of the speakers' linguistic choices and their impacts on the produced effects on communication, including the manipulativeness, emotional density and cultural load that together create powerful, persuasive messages and reflect the peculiarities of a person as a representative of a particular culture.

First of all, the findings that are based on the critical discourse analysis of the speeches reflect the major functions of the identified **expressive means, stylistic devices, and rhetorical strategies** employed by the presidents. Taking into account the distinctive features of the cultural backgrounds of the speakers and the political discourse, namely, high degree of formality, dependence of the topicality of the political addresses on the social, historical and cultural contexts in the life of the country, and certain communicative goals followed by the speakers, critical discourse analysis has been implemented in order to uncover implied ideologies, power relations, and policy framing in the chosen speeches. Then, having identified all the examples of peculiar use of language, a content analysis method has been applied to make calculations and visualisations to

acquire the representative data, featuring the number of occurrences, and all the examples of the tools that facilitated further comparisons of the features.

To begin with, it has been revealed that the central units of analysis, in particular, **culturally-loaded linguistic units,** serve as tools that allude to the highly resonant concepts, events, slogans, values, and shared knowledge and appear to be the most frequently-employed figures of speech by each of the presidents, constituting 11% in Trump's, 14.8% in Bush's, and 14% in Obama's pre-election addresses. The prevalence of allusions is similarly high in their victory speeches, with Obama reaching 16.6%, Bush 12.9%, and Trump 7.8%. This extensive use underscores the importance of culturally-loaded references in establishing shared values and resonating with the audience in the context of political discourse that is being constantly influenced by changing societal, economic and cultural tendencies.

Moving from allusions to other forms of figurative language, **metaphors** also play a significant role, though their distribution varies more notably between speakers and speech types. In the pre-election utterances, metaphors account for 7.4% in Trump's, 16% in Bush's, and 10.5% in Obama's rhetoric, while in the second type of speeches, Obama's use of metaphors rises sharply to 17.9%, while Bush's and Trump's decrease to 9.1% and 4.6%, respectively. This shift indicates a shared tendency for some speakers to intensify metaphorical language when addressing the nation before the actual election process to frame the ideas that succinctly benefit their campaign; and the opposite tendency of using metaphors after the inauguration to reinforce the themes of unity and progress, and highlight the fact that the citizens made the right decision.

In addition to metaphors, the linguistic and cultural analysis of **stylistic devices reveals that metonymy and its special cases** (synecdoche and antonomasia) are present in the speeches of all presidents, though with some fluctuation. In the pre-election addresses, metonymy appears in 2.1% (Trump), 3.6% (Bush), and 4.9% (Obama), while in victory speeches, its use is slightly

reduced, with 1.8% (Trump), 3.8% (Bush), and 1.3% (Obama). The presence of these devices demonstrates the speakers' tendency to use associative and representative language to reinforce key ideas and identities, and inspire the cognitive recognition of the popular concepts or people being described.

Further on, **the use of hyperbole** demonstrates both consistency and variation. In the pre-election speeches, Donald Trump employs hyperbole most frequently (9.6%), followed by Barack Obama (4.7%) and George Bush (3.1%). In victory speeches, Bush increases his use of hyperbole to 7.6%, while Trump and Obama use it less, at 6% and 4.2%, respectively.

However, it is crucial to point out that these shifts are partially explained by the fact that the content density of all three pre-election speeches is greater than the one of the victory ones. In particular, while the former contains 14-15 pages each, the latter consists of 4 pages in the case of George Bush and Donald Trump, and 8 pages in Barack Obama's speech. This variation is not solely a matter of quantitative difference but is also deeply impacted by the communicative goals of each speech type. Pre-election speeches are typically characterised by the extensive enumeration of policies, promises, and arguments aimed at persuading and manipulating the listeners. This requires a more detailed and comprehensive rhetorical approach, resulting in longer speeches and a higher density of certain devices, such as hyperbole, which serve to exaggerate the urgency of the need to vote for the speaker.

In contrast, victory speeches are generally more concise, reflecting a shift in communicative purpose from detailed argumentation to the celebration. The focus moves away from enumerating future plans toward expressing gratitude, which can be effectively conveyed in a shorter format that does not require extensive listing or justification.

Nevertheless, the case of Barack Obama's victory speech stands out as an exception to this trend. Despite being a victory address, its length (8 pages) exceeds that of Bush's and Trump's, a feature that can be attributed to Obama's

extensive use of **successive and numerous parallel constructions** that frame similar ideas of gratitude and common responsibility. This stylistic choice shows how structural devices can shape both the length and the communicative impact of a speech, adapting the usual conciseness of the victory addresses. Thus, the differences in how often hyperbole and other stylistic devices are utilised can be explained by both the length of the speeches and different goals of each speech type, as well as by the individual rhetorical strategies chosen by each president and influenced by their backgrounds and political affiliations.

Furthermore, the analysis reveals a noticeable increase in the use of **epithets and intensifiers** in victory speeches compared to pre-election addresses. For instance, Trump's use of epithets rises from 11.4% to 19.8%, Bush's from 4.8% to 9.1%, and Obama's from 2.1% to 5.1%. Similarly, intensifiers show an increase, especially for Trump (from 9% to 13.8%), whose use of these expressive means stands out dramatically, compared to the other presidents (only 0.5 % and 2.3 % by George Bush; 2.5 % and 1.9 % by Barack Obama), who tend to enhance the effectiveness of the speech by using figurative meanings (i.e. using metaphors, hyperboles, syntactic repetitions, and other figures of speech).

When examining the devices associated with implied critique, argumentation, and emotional engagement, such as **irony and rhetorical questions,** a clear decline is observed in victory speeches. Irony, for example, drops from 2.4% in Trump's, 2% in Bush's, and 1.4% in Obama's pre-election speeches to 0.6%, 0.6%, and 0.3% respectively in their victory speeches. Rhetorical questions, present in pre-election speeches (Trump – 2.4%; Bush – 0.8%; Obama – 0.4%), are almost entirely absent in the victory context, except for the 3 instances of their utilisation by Donald Trump. This reduction represents a shift from confrontation, debate, and persuasion towards affirmation.

Alongside these trends, the use of pathos, **an appeal to emotions** manipulative strategy generally increases in victory speeches. For instance, this rhetorical strategy rises from 5.4% to 15.2% in Bush's utterance, while Trump and Obama maintain high levels (3.9% to 9.2% and 8.8% to 9.3%, respectively). The appeals to emotion stand out among other rhetorical strategies employed by the presidents, and this can also be explained by the nature of such political addresses, both of which aim to persuade and effect the decision making of the potential voter.

In addition to pathos, the results also reveal shifts in the use of other classical rhetorical strategies. **Ethos,** representing appeals to the speaker's credibility and authority, is present in both pre-election and victory speeches, with a slight increase in the latter. For example, Bush's ethos rises from 3.1% to 4.5%, Trump's from 1.9% to 2.8%, and Obama's from 1.2% to 2.6%. This increase suggests that, in the context of victory, presidents are more likely to emphasise their legitimacy and moral standing, reinforcing their role as national leaders.

Conversely, the presence of **logical appeals and structured argumentation** shows an expected decline in victory speeches. Obama's use of evidence and statistics decreases from 2.3% to 0.6%, Bush's from 2.6% to 1.5%, and Trump's from 1.1% to 0.5%. This drop is also an indicator of the characteristic features of the two kinds of speeches: while pre-election speeches require logical reasoning and evidence to persuade undecided voters, victory speeches focus less on justification of the policies benefits and more on emotional resonance.

Finally, the utilisation of **kairos**, or the rhetorical appeal to timeliness or urgency of the implied action, also varies between the two speech types and presidents. In the pre-election speeches, call-to-action appeals appear at 1.4% for Trump, 0.8% for Bush, and 2.5% for Obama. In victory speeches, Bush increases his use of kairos to 2.3%, Obama's drops to 1.3%, and Trump's is

absent. These statistics suggest that the strategic framing of the need to undertake certain actions is more relevant in the paradigm of the messages delivered before elections, and thus is almost omitted in another kind of speeches. It is noteworthy that Barack Obama is the one who implements the strategy the most frequently (14 against 3 and 9 instances detected in Bush's and Trump's pre-election speeches respectively). The examples identified in Obama's utterance are most often hidden in the identical constructions ("If you choose this path… If you stand with us…") that are utilised in both his pre-election and victory speeches, thus making them more prolonged and cohesive.

Taken together, these results show that while **emotional appeals (pathos)** become more prominent in victory speeches, **appeals to logic (logos)** decrease, and **appeals to credibility (ethos) and collective action (kairos)** are adapted to fit the changing communicative aims.

In regard to syntactic devices, the data indicate that all three make use of a wide range of structures to enhance expressiveness and coherence of the delivered messages. In pre-election speeches, **parallelism** is particularly notable for Bush (8.7%) and Obama (8.1%), while Trump's use is drastically lower (1.9%). In victory speeches, **parallelism** becomes even more conspicuous, especially for Obama (12.1%), Bush (7.6%), and Trump (8.3%). Similarly, **anaphora** is employed in both contexts, with Obama using it most frequently in pre-election speeches (7.4%) and maintaining a high level in victory speeches (5.8%).

Furthermore, devices such as **epiphora** (Trump: 3.7% – in pre-election; 2.3% – in victory), anadiplosis (Trump: 2.6% – pre-election, 0.9% – victory), and antithesis (Obama: 6.2% – pre-election, 1.6% – victory) are also present, though generally at lower rates in victory speeches. Additionally, the analysis of Trump's rhetoric reveals exceptional features in terms of **ellipsis and parcellation.** In pre-election speeches, Trump employs **ellipsis** (5.1%) and

parcellation (5.5%) at significantly higher rates than Bush (0.3% and 0.5%) and Obama (0.4% and 0.4%). What is more, even in victory speeches, Trump continues to use these devices more frequently (ellipsis: 3.2%, parcellation: 2.3%) compared to the other presidents, whose usage remains below 1%. These findings suggest a distinctive syntactic fragmentation in Trump's style, contributing to a more dynamic and direct delivery, sometimes accompanied with a slight degree of informality.

In summary, the results of a mixed-methods linguistic and cultural analysis illustrate clear shifts in the frequency and selection of linguistic devices by the presidents. Despite the fact that culturally-loaded references, metaphors, and other expressive means are consistently important and present, their utilisation is adapted to the communicative goals of two kinds of speeches.

Discussion

In the framework of linguistic and cultural approach, based on which the outlined quantitative and qualitative data has been obtained, the results must be interpreted in terms of their interrelation with the speaker's socio-cultural backgrounds.

One of the most outstanding findings is the distinctive rhetorical style of Donald Trump, which is characterised by frequent use of ellipsis and parcellation, which are not the characteristic features of the formal and ceremonial register of the pre-election and victory speeches, alongside a numerous utilisation of hyperbole and epithets. These linguistic choices contribute to a fragmented and direct style that aligns with Trump's personal background, namely his initial career as a businessman. In particular, these tendencies of the use of short but still meaningful and catchy phrases reflect the common features associated with the economic discourse and business communication, the main goal of which is to catch the attention and persuade. Furthermore, the extensive use of hyperbole and intensifiers also aligns with

Trump's background as a businessman and media personality that is accustomed to engaging broad audiences through emotive and rhythmic tools.

In contrast, Barack Obama's speeches are characterised by a more formal, structured, and cohesive style, marked by the extensive use of parallelism, anaphora, epiphora, antithesis, and anadiplosis. These devices contribute to a narrative technique that is both elevated and manipulative, reflecting Obama's educational achievements (i.e. his Bachelor of Arts degree and later Law and International Relations degree), multicultural background, and oratorical practices. His frequent use of culturally-loaded metaphors and allusions, often referencing historical, religious, symbolic concepts help to persuade the audience through shared values and collective memory.

As for George Bush's rhetorical style, the results, featuring the topics that the presidents most often alludes to and the stylistic devices he tends to utilise the most, also reflect the interconnection of his socio-cultural experiences and belonging to a Republican party. For instance, the peculiar use of pathos and hyperbole in his victory speeches correlate with his Texas cultural background, including his upbringing in the family closely related to politics, and conservative political identity, which emphasise patriotism, moral standing, and traditional values.

Bush's rhetoric often invokes traditional American principles and historical symbolism, reinforcing his credibility and authority while appealing to socially resonant ideologies. His frequent use of such figures of speech as allusions and metaphors that prevail in contrast to hyperbole and intensifiers reflects a more restrained but authoritative style aimed at gaining support and framing his policies as the most promising ones.

Syntactically, George Bush employs such devices as parallelism and anaphora to structure his messages logically and effectively, though with less rhythmic complexity than Barack Obama. His rhetorical style reflects a preference for straightforwardness and formality, consistent with his political

affiliation, upbringing in the family of another influential republican politician, peculiarities of South America's traditions and culture, and the expectations of his core supporters.

It is worth stating that the analysis conducted in the given study has certain limitations in terms of the scope of the analysed layers of the expressive means of language. It is due to the fact that the initial aim of the study is related to the reflection of the most vivid and representative linguistic choices implemented by the politicians in their speaker with a focus on the verbal linguistic tools that have been utilised by the presidents. The analysis of the lexical and syntactic categories of expressive means and stylistic devices with a concentration on the peculiarities expressed verbally through the use of various linguistic features has allowed for a more thorough and in-depth examination of the figurative and structural components of the speech that enhance the overall effectiveness of the perception of the utterances.

Thus, the extension of the acquired results requires further research on the topic that would shed light on the peculiar, culture-specific use of non-verbal cues within the political discourse. Further investigations would contribute to a more comprehensive understanding of how verbal and non-verbal elements interact to shape persuasive political communication and cultural identity.

Conclusion

The given research aimed at identifying the interrelation between language and culture in shaping political discourse using the linguistic and cultural analytical framework, with a particular focus on the linguistic features and rhetorical strategies that are employed in 21st century U.S. presidential speeches. By analysing both pre-election and victory speeches of George W. Bush, Barack Obama, and Donald Trump from their second terms, the study' goal was to uncover how these linguistic choices reflect broader cultural and

societal dynamics, and how political leaders navigate cultural sensitivities to effectively resonate with their audiences.

The findings acquired with the use of mixed-methods research design have helped to answer the primary research questions of study and confirmed that the presidents' use of culture-specific linguistic devices is deeply intertwined with their personal backgrounds, cultural identities, and political affiliations. Critical discourse and content analyses carried out in the study demonstrated that each president employs a distinct set of stylistic devices, expressive means of language and rhetorical strategies, ranging from Trump's fragmented and emphatic style to Obama's complex and rhythmically cohesive oratory, and Bush's balanced, traditional rhetoric – all reflecting their unique cultural experiences and the features of communicative goals of two types of the examined speeches. Furthermore, the research has revealed that the frequency and functions of these devices vary between pre-election and victory speeches, aligning with the distinct communicative situations of the utterances.

Importantly, the initial hypothesis that culturally-loaded linguistic features and rhetorical strategies are strategically used by political leaders to enhance message effectiveness and audience perception has been supported and proved by the analysis. The study's results emphasise that the language used in political discourse is not only a tool for persuasion and manipulation, but also a reflection of cultural identity and societal values.

The practical implications of this study are multifaceted. Firstly, the study contributes to the existing research field focusing on cultural linguistics by providing empirical data featuring the examination of the correlation between language and culture and its manifestation in the linguistic choices of three U.S. presidents that represent unique cultural backgrounds.

Secondly, the findings provide valuable insights for other studies related to the manipulativeness and emotionality of political discourse, since these aspects are paid close attention in the study and are thoroughly discussed in the

Content Analysis Section. Finally, the study provides a comprehensive groundwork for further interdisciplinary research, suggesting that future investigations could expand to include non-verbal communication analysis within the framework of political communication.

In conclusion, this research highlights the significance of the implementation of linguistic and cultural analysis in the study of the peculiarities of political discourse, since it is a domain that is greatly influenced by the cultural aspects of the country's life. Furthermore, the findings clearly illustrate that the linguistic and cultural identities of the speakers indeed impact the expressiveness, and the effects produced within the utterances delivered by these speakers.

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Appendix

Table 1.

Trump's pre-election speech

Graph 1.

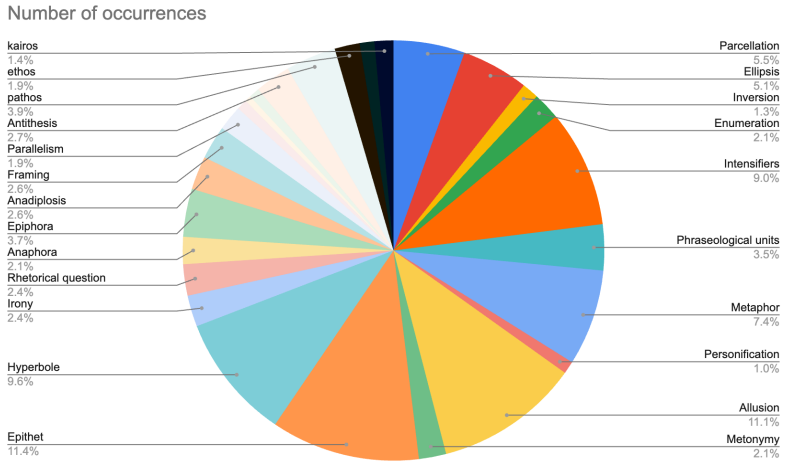

Table 2.

Trump's victory speech

Graph 2.

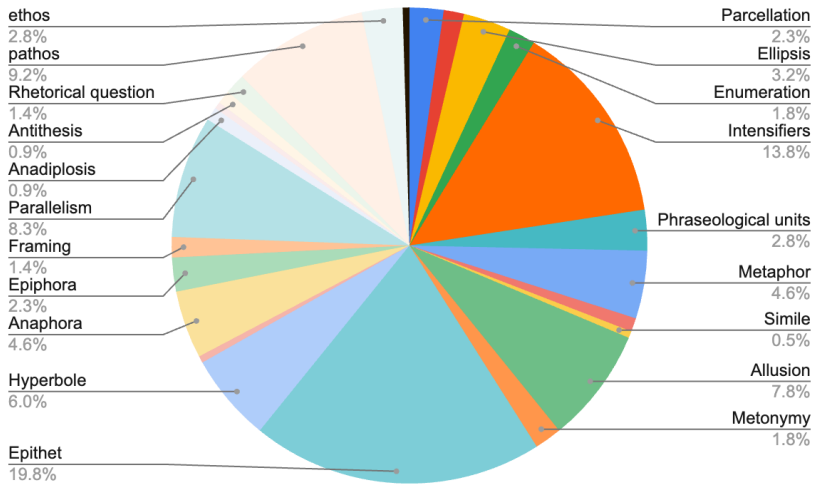

Table 3.

Bush's pre-election speech

Graph 3.

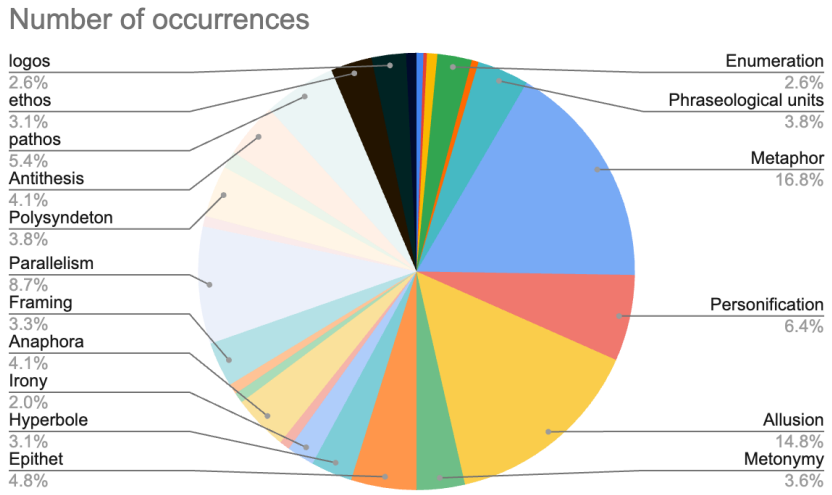

Table 4.

[Bush's victory speech]

Graph 4.

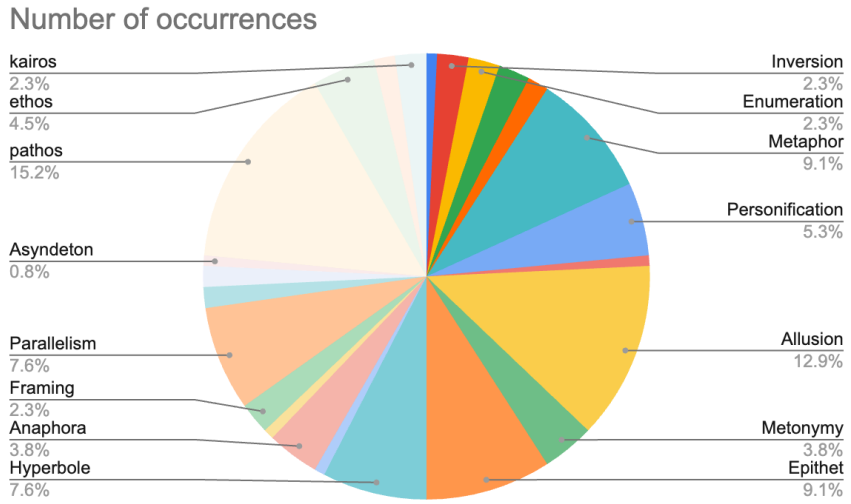

Table 5.

[Obama's pre-election speech]

Graph 5.

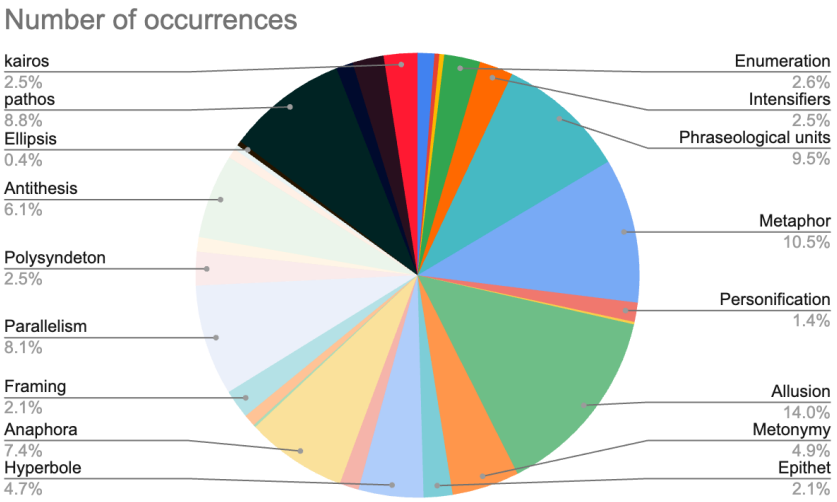

Table 6.

[Obama's victory speech]

Graph 6.

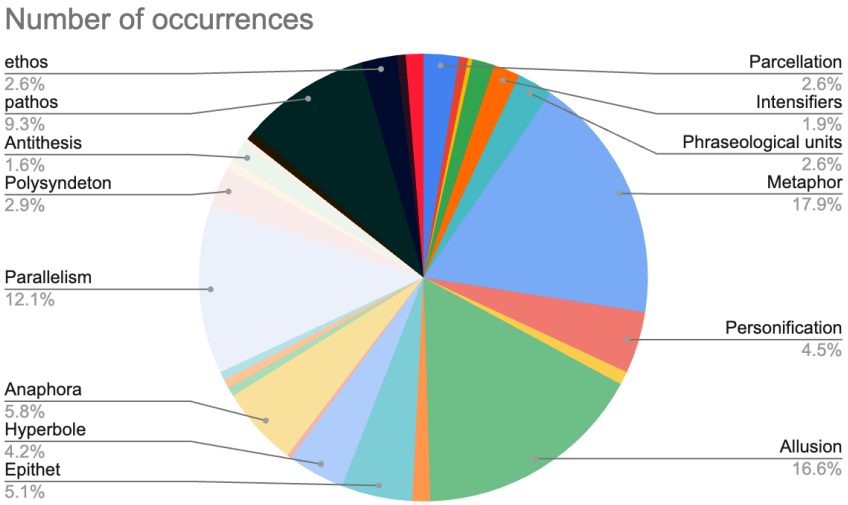

Table 7.

Pre-election Speeches

Identified device	Donald Trump	George Bush	Barack Obama
Parcellation	5.5 %	0.5 %	0.4 %
Ellipsis	5.1 %	0.3 %	0.4 %
Inversion (complete and partial)	1.3 %	0.8%	0.4 %
Enumeration	2.1 %	2.6 %	2.6 %
Intensifiers	9 %	0.5 %	2.5 %
Phraseological units (fusions, unities, combinations)	3.5 %	3.8 %	9.5 %
Metaphor (conceptual, orientational, ontological, structural)	7. 4%	16 %	10.5 %
Personification	1 %	6.4 %	1.4 %
Allusion (cultural, historical, political, and other	11 %	14.8 %	14 %

references)			
Metonymy and its special cases (synecdoche and antonomasia)	2.1 %	3.6%	4.9 %
Epithet	11.4 %	4.8 %	2.1 %
Hyperbole	9.6 %	3.1 %	4.7 %
Irony	2.4 %	2 %	1.4%
Rhetorical question	2.4 %	0.8 %	0.4 %
Anaphora	2.1 %	4.1 %	7.4 %
Epiphora	3.7 %	0.8%	0.2 %
Anadiplosis	2.6 %	0.8 %	0.9 %
Framing (slogans that have been repeated at the beginning and at the end of a sentence. paragraph or	2.6 %	3.3 %	2.1 %

throughout the speech)			
Parallelism (partial and complete)	1.9 %	8.7 %	8.1 %
Chiasmus	0.8 %	0.8 %	0.7 %
Antithesis	2.7%	4.1 %	6.2 %
Polysyndeton	0.5 %	3.8 %	2.5 %
Asyndeton	0.8 %	0.8 %	1.1 %
pathos	3.9 %	5.4 %	8.8 %
ethos	1.9 %	3.1 %	1.2 %
logos	1.1 %	2.6 %	2.3 %
kairos	1. 4%	0.8%	2.5 %

Table 8.

Victory Speeches

Identified device	Donald Trump	George Bush	Barack Obama
Parcellation	2.3 %	0.8 %	2.6 %
Ellipsis	3.2 %	0 %	0.6 %
Inversion (complete and partial)	1.4 %	2.3 %	0.3 %

Enumeration	1.8 %	2.3 %	1.6 %
Intensifiers	13.8 %	2.3 %	1.9 %
Phraseological units (fusions, unities, combinations)	2.8 %	1.5 %	2.6%
Metaphor (conceptual, orientational, ontological, structural)	4.6 %	9.1 %	17.9 %
Personification	0.9 %	5.3 %	4.5 %
Allusion (cultural, historical, political, and other references)	7.8 %	12.9 %	16.6 %
Metonymy and its special cases (synecdoche and antonomasia)	1.8 %	3.8%	1.3 %
Epithet	19.8 %	9.1 %	5.1 %
Hyperbole	6 %	7.6 %	4.2 %
Irony	0.6 %	0.6 %	0.3%
Rhetorical question	1.4 %	0 %	0 %

Anaphora	4.6 %	3.8 %	5.8 %
Epiphora	2.3 %	0.8%	0.6 %
Anadiplosis	0.9 %	0 %	0.6 %
Framing (slogans that have been repeated at the beginning and at the end of a sentence. paragraph or throughout the speech)	1.4 %	2.3 %	0.6%
Parallelism (partial and complete)	8.3 %	7.6 %	12.1 %
Chiasmus	0 %	0%	0.6 %
Antithesis	0.9 %	1.5 %	1.6 %
Polysyndeton	0 %	1.5 %	2.9 %
Asyndeton	0.5 %	0.8 %	0.6 %
pathos	9.2 %	15.2%	9.3 %
ethos	2.8 %	4.5 %	2.6 %
logos	0.5 %	1.5 %	0.6 %
kairos	0 %	2.3 %	1.3 %

Transcribed and analysed speech 1.

Bush's pre-election speech

Transcribed and analysed speech 2.

Bush's victory speech

Transcribed and analysed speech 3.

Trump's pre- election speech

Transcribed and analysed speech 4.

Trump's victory speech

Transcribed and analysed speech 5.

Obama's pre-election speech

Transcribed and analysed speech 6.

Obama's victory speech

Backgrounds of the speakers.

Description of all three speakers' cultural backgrounds

Table 9
Comparative Analysis of Linguo-culturology and Cultural Linguistics.

Criteria	Linguo-Culturology	Cultural Linguistics
Aim	Linguo-Culturology studies language as a cultural phenomenon (Maslova, 2001). It is aimed at studying the speech, mental and cultural	Cultural Linguistics explores interconnection between language, culture and conceptualisation. It is aimed at improving the overall

	characteristics of different ethnicities, as well as revealing the meaning of culturally-loaded linguistic units (Vorobyov, 2006; Maslova, 2001; Urayimova, 2020). Linguo-Culturology also focuses on the systematic study of both the relationship and the interaction of culture and language in the process of their functioning and implementation (Vorobyov, 2006).	understanding of the cultural conceptualization of human experience. The main purpose of cultural linguistics is the systematic and detailed analysis of cultural conceptualizations using methods such as cultural schemas and cultural categories that are directly related to cognitive sciences and cognitive linguistics (Sharifian, 2017).
Subject of the study (verbal / non-verbal)	Linguo-Culturology focuses on the verbal aspects of speech communication (i.e. phraseological units, metaphors, non-equivalent phrases and others) and also examines how non-verbal cues (i.e. intonation, pitch, tempo and others) can complement transmission of the message in regard with cultural norms of a particular nationality or ethnicity.	Cultural Linguistics focuses on cognitive and conceptual components, also paying attention to the underlying mental processes. Despite the fact that it studies the language, this scientific discipline cannot be fully attributed to either verbal or non-verbal methods of transmitting information.
Field of research	Language as a cultural phenomenon implies the research of such aspects as: - Culturally-loaded words and expressions;	The study of conceptualization and cognition of the world through the concepts of language and culture as interrelated phenomena. Further, as an approach to working with a person's

	- Mythologized linguistic units Paremiological fund of language; - Phraseological fund of language; - Standards, stereotypes, symbols; - Metaphors and images of language; - Stylistic structure of language; - Speech behavior (verbal behaviour); - Speech etiquette.	mentality and reality, it is able to reveal the full ideological component of existing words and terms that are mental categories. The model presented by Sharifian (2017) visualizes the field of research of this scientific discipline and the relationship of its main components: - cultural cognition -> - cultural conceptualization (cultural schemas, cultural categories, and cultural metaphors) -> - language (morphosyntax, semantics, and pragmatics).
Terminology	Language, culture, cultural studies, philology, linguistics, nation, ethnicity, culturally-loaded units, phraseological units, speech behaviour, image, interpretation.	Conceptualization, language, culture, categorization, cognitive sciences, cognitive linguistics, cultural schemas, cultural categories, cognition, mentality.

Table 10.
Comparative analysis of verbal and non-verbal means of communication.

Criteria	Verbal communication	Non-verbal communication

Aim	Verbal communication is based on the perception of language as a system of signs and meanings, the use of which is aimed at expressing thoughts, ideas and emotions through a message (Khasanova, 2024; Sinelnikova, 2022). The medium and channel of transmission may vary depending on the communicative goal and who it is aimed at. Moreover, this type of interaction also varies depending on the recipient or decoder, so that it is necessary for the speaker to take this aspect into account (Razgonova, ?)	Non-verbal communication is based on the transmission of a message without using language, and with a focus on gestures, facial expressions, phonetic features, and others (Su Mon, 2017; Mammadzada, 2023). At the same time, it is crucial to distinguish between physiological movements and information-loaded ones, i.e. gestures. The latter also vary in their meaning, but are traditionally associated with a person's culture and nationality.
Subject of the study	Traditionally, scholars distinguish two main approaches to speech classification (Sinelnikova, 2022): 1. external speech (occurs between people or groups of people); - written; - oral. Both types of external speech can be either monologues or dialogues. 2. inner speech (communication takes place in a person's mind,	Kamola (2023) emphasizes the importance of differentiating between gestures and natural human physiological movements. The main criteria for successful division are the following: - gesture has a signifier and a signified; - gestures express meaning; - gestures can change meaning. Manusov (2016) proposes a classification of non-verbal means of communication based on neurological factors. The author highlights its connection with the physical abilities of representatives

	is considered part of the thinking process). According to Mammadzada (2023), there are 3 main manifestations of verbal means of information transmission: 1. Dyadic communication; 2. Small groups communication; 3. Public communication.	of certain nationalities. Thus, there are three key types of non-verbal ways of interaction: - spontaneous communication; - pseudo-spontaneous communication; - symbolic communication.
Field of research	Verbal communication model identifies the basic units of oral interaction that are studied within the framework of this approach (Razgonova, ?): - information; - communication means; - communication network; - communicative activity. It possesses various manifestations and features, many of which have a culturally determined meaning and can be considered as a reflection of existing norms of behavior specific to a particular nation (Jiang, 2024; Hui, 2017; Touaoula, 2017).	Avazova (2024) proposes a theory regarding the correct use of non-verbal communication methods, within the framework of which the term “non-verbal sensitivity” was formed. It is used to denote the ability to recognize the speaker's use of non-verbal signals and interpret them correctly, taking into account the context of the message being conveyed. Thus, the following units that are studied within the framework of this approach can be distinguished: - encoder; - cultural context; - communicative situation; - decoder. At the same time, Manusov (2016) notes that having a well-developed skill in decoding non-verbal messages does not mean that a person can also correctly encode such units (and vice versa).

Terminology	Verbal communication, means of transmitting information, medium, channel, language, emotionality, culturally-loaded units, speech, encoder, decoder, communicative means, communicative goal.	Non-verbal communication, means of transmitting information, non-verbal sensitivity, encoder, decoder, gesture, cultural background, emotionally-loaded units, communication system, cultural context, communicative goal.